

India, Before and After 2014

What changed.

What the numbers mean.

Who did better, and on what basis.

Six evidence volumes and the final comparison of Congress-led UPA and BJP-led NDA, collected in one place.

Written by Lovepreet Singh

MisterLove · misterlove.in

204 pages · Seven volumes · Linked sources and contents

Evidence checked 2–3 October 2026.

Master edition assembled 4 October 2026.

Every statistical figure keeps its own reporting date.

One question. The whole record together.

I wanted the full report in one file so that you can read it, keep it and check it without jumping between downloads. The six evidence volumes come first. The final comparison follows them. The original numbers, tables, explanations and source notes are all here.

My overall judgment gives the BJP-led NDA a qualified advantage when infrastructure execution, basic-service reach and financial inclusion receive the greatest weight. Congress-led UPA has the stronger observed full-decade growth record in the common historical series, and a stronger case on the independent freedom assessments examined. The last volume explains that choice of priorities and the objections to it.

For the political comparison, UPA means the Congress-led coalition in office from 2004 to 2014. NDA means the BJP-led coalition from 2014 onward. India before 2014 was not governed by Congress alone. Longer historical baselines in the evidence chapters are labelled with their actual years.

A larger number does not automatically mean a better life. More installed power is not the same as reliable supply. More recorded crime can reflect more reporting. A survey conducted in 2024 is not a 2026 measurement just because its report was released in 2026. Read the dates and definitions beside each comparison.

The original volumes are reproduced as issued. Early references to planned parts describe the project at that stage; all six volumes and the final comparison are now included. Their printed page numbers restart in each volume. The next page gives the page positions in this master file, and the bookmarks let you jump straight to a chapter.

This is a collected report on the subjects examined, not a claim to have checked every post on The Matrix India or every fact about India. Missing and unmatched data stay visible. COVID and the other major shocks are considered in the final comparison. Complete calendar-year 2026 results are not assumed.

Lovepreet Singh

MisterLove · 4 October 2026

The complete report, in order.

Select a volume below, or open the bookmarks in your PDF reader. Page ranges refer to this master file.

PART 1 4–31

Money, Work and the Economy

Economy, income, prices, jobs, banks, debt and trade.

PART 2 32–59

The Networks of Everyday Life

Roads, railways, airports, power, water, housing and digital access.

PART 3 60–91

Health, Learning and Living Conditions

Health, nutrition, schooling, poverty and household living conditions.

PART 4 92–115

Making, Growing and Building

Farming, industry, business, science, space and defence.

PART 5 116–143

Safety, Institutions and the Environment

Recorded crime, public safety, institutions and the environment.

PART 6 144–171

States, Rankings and the Original Charts

State differences, international rankings and checks of the starting claims.

FINAL COMPARISON 172–204

Who Did Better: UPA or NDA?

The judgment, its priorities, the strongest objections and the major shocks.

Each volume includes its own author's note, explanations and bibliography. Source numbers and printed page numbers belong to that volume. The statistical cutoffs vary by topic and are stated in the text.

A REPORT CARD IN PLAIN ENGLISH

India, before and after 2014

Money, work and the economy

*What changed. What the numbers mean.
What still needs a closer look.*

PART ONE OF SIX

Written by Lovepreet Singh

misterlove.in / Research cut-off: 2 October 2026

A NOTE FROM ME

Why I wanted this report

An author's note

I wanted to sit down with one question: what actually changed in India after 2014? It sounds simple until you start reading the numbers. One chart talks about roads. Another talks about jobs. Both may be telling you something real, while leaving out the part you need to understand it.

I write at MisterLove because I like taking a difficult subject apart until it becomes clear. This report follows that approach. I want someone who normally closes a long article after two paragraphs to be able to follow the whole thing. You should not need an economics degree to understand what is happening around you.

The comparisons shared by The Matrix India gave this project a starting point. I have treated those charts as questions to investigate. Wherever possible, the numbers here lead back to the organisation that collected or published them. A figure can be correct and still give the wrong impression when its date, definition or starting point is missing.

I have kept the improvements, the problems and the awkward gaps. If a survey began after 2014, I say so. If a figure is a forecast or a budget plan, I name it as one. If two numbers cannot fairly be compared, I explain why.

There is no final grade for the country here. I want you to finish with a clearer understanding of income, work, prices and public money, and enough information to form your own view.

For readers meeting me here: I'm Lovepreet Singh, a researcher and writer, founder of Lovelace, and an MBA student in Business Strategy and Analysis. My work at MisterLove brings together questions about society, history, public policy and technology. Clear writing is the thread running through it.

Lovepreet Singh

MisterLove · 2 October 2026

Sources: 01, 32, 35, 36. Full references on pages 26-28.

THE SERIES

Six parts. One country.

This volume starts with money and work.

India is too large a subject for one crowded document. These six parts follow the same approach: show the earlier number, show the recent number, explain what changed, and make the limits visible.

Part	What it covers	Planned pages
1	Economy, income, prices, jobs, banking, public money and trade	28
2	Roads, railways, airports, power, water, housing and digital access	28
3	Health, nutrition, education, poverty and living conditions	32
4	Farming, industry, business, science, space and defence	24
5	Crime, safety, institutions and the environment	28
6	State differences, international rankings and the original charts	28

The full series is planned at about 168 pages, including notes and sources. This is the completed first volume. The other five are planned volumes, not included in this file. Page targets may change when the material needs more or less room.

Inside Part 1

Pages 4-8 explain the numbers, GDP, income, prices and wages. Pages 9-14 cover work, women, spending, poverty and inequality. Pages 15-20 examine borrowing, public spending and banking. Pages 21-23 cover trade, external debt and investment. Pages 24-25 revisit the economic chart. Sources are on pages 26-28.

Start at the beginning if the terms are new. If one subject matters more to you, go straight to that page. Every topic explains its own main terms.

READ THIS FIRST

What does “before and after” mean?

The dates are part of the number.

For a yearly figure, 2013-14 is usually the nearest full financial year before the change of Union government in May 2014. A financial year runs from 1 April to 31 March. So 2025-26 means April 2025 through March 2026. It is already a completed year at this report's cut-off.

A survey labelled 2023-24 may follow a different calendar. The consumption survey ran from August 2023 to July 2024. The older labour survey used July to June. Its 2025 edition uses January to December. The period is written wherever it matters.

The word	What it means
Nominal	The amount in the money of that year. Prices have not been removed.
Real	Adjusted for changing prices, using a specified base year.
Per capita	Per person: the total divided by the population.
Percentage point	The gap between two percentages. From 10% to 15% is 5 points, or a 50% relative rise.
Provisional / estimate	A figure that can be revised as better information arrives.
BE / RE	Budget Estimate is a plan. Revised Estimate is an updated plan. Neither is automatically the final amount spent.

One lakh is 100,000. One crore is 10 million. One lakh crore is one trillion rupees. A billion dollars is 100 crore dollars; it is not a billion rupees. The currency matters.

“Latest” here means a release checked by 2 October 2026. It does not mean every measure describes October 2026. Some reliable surveys take years to appear. Blank evidence is left blank; a future target is never counted as an achieved result.

Sources: 05, 09, 12, 18, 19. Full references on pages 26-28.

01 / THE SIZE OF THE ECONOMY

A bigger economy. How much bigger?

GDP counts production across the country.

GDP, or gross domestic product, adds up the value of final goods and services produced inside India. A finished shirt counts; adding the full price of its cotton again would count the same production twice. Shops, farms, factories, software and many other activities contribute to the total.

Historical comparison	2013-14	2024-25
Nominal GDP, 2011-12 series	₹112.34 lakh crore	₹330.68 lakh crore
Real GDP growth, same base series	6.4%	6.5%

In that historical series, the money value of annual output was about 2.94 times the earlier level. That does not mean India produced 2.94 times as much. Part of the increase reflects higher prices. Nor does it mean each household received 2.94 times as much income.

The newer 2026 reading

MoSPI introduced a new GDP series with base year 2022-23 and updated it again in August 2026. In the latest released quarter, April-June 2026, nominal GDP was ₹88.27 lakh crore and real GDP growth was 7.8% over April-June 2025. Both sides of that quarterly calculation use the new series.

The historical table above deliberately retains the older series for its long comparison. Its 2024-25 number is no longer the latest revised GDP level. The 2026 quarterly figure is shown separately because a quarter is not a full year and the statistical method changed. Dividing the two would produce a misleading answer.

Production tells us what the country can generate. The next question is how much of that reaches a person, and how much that person's money can buy.

Historical series and current quarter are separate comparisons; no cross-series growth rate is calculated. Sources: 02, 03, 05, 06. Full references on pages 26-28.

02 / PRICES

Why lower inflation still feels expensive

A slower price rise is still a price rise.

Measure and period	Reported rate
Average consumer inflation, FY 2013-14	9.5%
Consumer inflation, August 2026, year on year	4.82%
Food inflation, August 2026, year on year	5.95%

The first number is a whole-year average. The later two compare one month with the same month a year earlier. They are useful dated readings, but they are not a matched pair of annual averages. August 2026 uses the new CPI base of 2024=100 and is provisional.

Imagine the same basket costs ₹100, then rises to ₹110. Inflation was 10%. If it next rises to ₹115.50, inflation has fallen to 5%. The basket has still become dearer. That is why “inflation is lower” can be true while a family is still struggling with the bill.

CPI means Consumer Price Index. It follows a weighted basket of household purchases. Food, rent, transport and other items do not receive equal weight. A family spending most of its income on food can feel a different squeeze from one spending more on travel or services.

The new basket is meant to reflect newer spending patterns. This also means a long comparison needs the official treatment of the series change. Simply taking an old index number and dividing it by a new one will not tell you the rise in prices since 2014.

The Matrix chart's 2.1% is not the latest monthly CPI reading at this report's cut-off. Whatever period a chart uses, it needs to name that period. For your own budget, compare the prices you pay with the growth in your take-home income. That is where the pressure shows up.

Sources: 07, 08, 32. Full references on pages 26-28.

03 / INCOME PER PERSON

The average Indian is not an average

A national average is a useful starting point, not a payslip.

Per capita net national income	2013-14	2024-25
At the prices of each year	₹79,118	₹2,05,324
At constant 2011-12 prices	₹68,572	₹1,14,710

These figures come from the same historical national-accounts series in the January 2026 Economic Survey. They are annual amounts per person. The later figure was provisional. This table is a consistent older-series comparison, not a claim to show the latest rebased income estimate.

The nominal figure rose by about 160%. The real figure rose by about 67%. The smaller real increase removes the price changes built into the national accounts. Over eleven years, that real increase works out to roughly 4.8% a year when compounded. These percentages are calculations from the table.

Net national income allows for the wearing out of productive assets and includes residents' income from abroad, net of income going abroad. Dividing it by the population gives per capita income. Children and people without earnings are in that population too.

Now imagine five people earning ₹10,000, ₹10,000, ₹10,000, ₹10,000 and ₹1,00,000 a month. Their average is ₹28,000. Four of the five receive much less. Their median, the middle person's income, is ₹10,000. This is an illustration, not an estimate of Indian incomes.

A rise in average income matters. It tells us the economy generated more income per person on this measure. To understand everyday life, we also need wages, job stability, consumption and the distribution of the gains. None of those can be read straight from the average.

Sources: 04, 05. Full references on pages 26-28.

04 / WAGES

What did workers actually earn?

Monthly salary, business earnings and daily wages are different measures.

Average earnings	2024	2025
Regular wage / salaried men, per month	₹22,891	₹24,217
Regular wage / salaried women, per month	₹17,126	₹18,353
Self-employed men, per month	₹16,893	₹17,914
Self-employed women, per month	₹5,861	₹6,374
Male casual labour, per day	₹456	₹455
Female casual labour, per day	₹299	₹315

These PLFS annual averages use workers' current weekly status. Salary covers the preceding calendar month; self-employment earnings cover the last 30 days. Casual pay is daily and excludes public works. Amounts are nominal. Sampling changed in 2025, so the years are not strictly comparable. This is a recent picture, not a wage series from 2014.

The rows show why a single statement about “wages” can be too broad. The reported male salary average increased; the male casual daily average was almost unchanged. Workers can face very different outcomes inside the same growing economy.

These averages do not follow the same individual over time. A change in who enters a job category can move the average. Nor is a daily wage a monthly income: someone paid ₹455 for ten days receives much less than someone finding work on twenty-six days.

To test buying power, pay must be adjusted for a price index covering the same period. Comparing a 2025 annual wage rise with August 2026 inflation would be a date mismatch. For example, a 6% pay rise with 5% inflation gives a real rise of about 0.95%, calculated as 1.06 divided by 1.05, minus one.

The useful questions are therefore about the pay rate, the number of days worked, prices, and how predictable the next payment is.

Sources: 09, 10. Full references on pages 26-28.

05 / EMPLOYMENT

What counts as having a job?

The headline unemployment rate leaves out part of the story.

Age 15+, usual status	2017-18	2023-24
In the labour force, as a share of adults	49.8%	60.1%
Working, as a share of adults	46.8%	58.2%
Unemployed, as a share of the labour force	6.0%	3.2%

These PLFS annual periods run from July to June. The starting point is 2017-18 because that is when this survey series began. It must not be relabelled “2014”. A longer employment history needs the older surveys and a careful explanation of differences.

The labour force means people working or seeking and available for work. Its share of the population is called LFPR. The worker population ratio, or WPR, counts only the people working. The unemployment rate asks what share of the labour force is without work. Its denominator is smaller than the whole population.

Consider 100 adults. If 60 are in the labour force and three of those are unemployed, the unemployment rate is 5%, not 3%. The other 40 can include students, people doing household work and others outside the labour force. They are not all recorded as unemployed.

A worker may have a monthly salary, run a shop, do casual labour or help without a separate wage in a family enterprise. “Employed” does not promise good pay, full-time hours or a secure contract. The usual-status measure looks mainly across the preceding year; weekly measures capture a shorter window.

The old survey series records both higher participation and lower unemployment over the period shown. That is useful evidence. The next step is to examine the type of work and earnings, rather than treating every counted worker as someone with a comfortable salaried job.

Sources: 11, 10. Full references on pages 26-28.

06 / THE RECENT JOB PICTURE

Work is widespread. Secure work is another question.

The complete 2025 annual survey is the recent reference here.

PLFS 2025, usual status	Share
Labour force participation, adults aged 15+	59.3%
Worker population ratio, adults aged 15+	57.4%
Unemployment, adults aged 15+ in the labour force	3.1%
Unemployment among young people aged 15-29	9.9%
Workers who are self-employed	56.2%
Workers with regular wage / salaried work	23.6%
Workers in casual labour	20.2%

The first four rows use different populations from the last three. The job-type rows divide employed people into groups and add to 100%. The youth unemployment figure is for young people in the labour force; it does not mean 9.9% of all young people are unemployed.

The survey's sample design changed from January 2025. The ministry explicitly says the results are not strictly comparable with earlier annual PLFS reports. A line drawn through 2017, 2024 and 2025 without marking that break would look more certain than the evidence permits.

Self-employment can mean a successful business, a small farm or work taken up because better options are scarce. Regular salary also does not automatically mean a written contract, paid leave or pension cover. The categories tell us the form of work; they do not measure its whole quality.

For a young person trying to begin a career, the youth figure is often more relevant than the all-age average. For a household trying to pay rent every month, steady earnings and reliable hours can matter more than the simple fact of being counted as employed.

Sources: 09, 10. Full references on pages 26-28.

07 / WOMEN AND WORK

Participation and independence are different questions

More recorded work needs to be read alongside pay and control over money.

Female labour force participation, age 15+	Rate
2017-18, older PLFS design, July-June	23.3%
2023-24, older PLFS design, July-June	41.7%
2025, new design, January-December	40.0%

Within the older survey design, women's participation increased by 18.4 percentage points. That is a substantial rise in the share of women recorded as working or looking for work. The 2025 row belongs to the revised survey and should not be read as a clean 1.7-point fall from 2023-24.

A woman helping on a family farm or in a family shop can count as employed without receiving a separate salary. That work contributes to production, but it does not automatically give her an independent income she controls. Unpaid household care is also economically valuable, although it is treated differently in these employment statistics.

The 2025 survey places 64.2% of employed women in self-employment and 18.2% in regular wage or salaried work. Its reported average monthly salary for women is ₹18,353, compared with ₹24,217 for men. These broad averages are not a comparison of men and women doing exactly the same job for the same hours.

Differences in occupation, hours, seniority and location all matter. So can barriers such as childcare, safety, transport and access to suitable work. The figures alone cannot say how much of the pay gap each factor causes.

The practical question is whether a woman can choose worthwhile work, receive a fair income and decide how to use it. Participation is one part of that picture. Pay, time and freedom of choice complete much more of it.

Sources: 09, 10, 11. Full references on pages 26-28.

08 / HOUSEHOLD SPENDING

How much does daily life consume?

Spending per person brings the discussion closer to the kitchen table.

Monthly spending per person	Rural	Urban
2011-12, at that year's prices	₹1,430	₹2,630
2023-24, at that year's prices	₹4,122	₹6,996
2023-24, adjusted to 2011-12 prices	₹2,079	₹3,632

These HCES figures exclude the imputed value of specified free items received through welfare programmes. Imputation means adding an estimated money value for something received without payment. Mixing a series that includes those values with one that excludes them changes the comparison.

At current prices, the rural amount is about 2.88 times its earlier level and the urban amount about 2.66 times. After the published price adjustment, the increases are about 45% and 38%. These are changes over roughly twelve years, not one year.

Monthly per capita consumption expenditure, or MPCE, divides household consumption by household members. A five-person household with MPCE of ₹4,122 has about ₹20,610 of measured monthly household consumption. That multiplication is an illustration. It does not say every rural family spends that amount or has five members.

The surveys changed their questionnaires, coverage of items and interviewing approach between 2011-12 and 2023-24. The table is the published comparison, with those limits. It should not be treated as a perfectly unchanged measuring instrument.

Consumption is not the same as salary. A household can use savings, borrowing, transfers or goods it produces itself. Higher measured consumption is relevant to living standards, but it does not by itself tell us whether the household is financially secure. The next page asks how many people remain below specific spending thresholds.

Sources: 12, 13. Full references on pages 26-28.

09 / MONETARY POVERTY

Fewer people below the line. Which line?

A poverty rate only makes sense when the threshold is visible.

World Bank poverty line, 2021 PPP	2011-12	2023-24
\$3.00 per person per day	27.1%	2.6%
\$4.20 per person per day	57.7%	16.1%

The April 2026 India Development Update reports these estimates using consumption surveys. The \$3 line is the international extreme-poverty threshold. The \$4.20 line is commonly used for lower-middle-income economies. Raising the threshold captures a larger group with limited resources.

PPP means purchasing power parity. It adjusts for differences in what money buys across countries. These are international dollars at 2021 purchasing power. Multiplying \$3 by today's dollar-rupee exchange rate would give the wrong local threshold.

On these measures, the reduction is large: 24.5 percentage points at the extreme-poverty line and 41.6 points at the higher line. The World Bank estimates about 35 million people were still below the extreme-poverty line in 2023-24. That is about 3.5 crore people.

Moving just above a line does not make a person comfortably middle class. A family may still be one illness, crop loss or lost job away from difficulty. The threshold is a way to count a defined deprivation; it is not a complete description of a decent life.

These estimates also span 2011-12 to 2023-24, including years before 2014. They cannot assign the whole fall to one administration. Changes in survey methods and the construction of comparable consumption measures affect the estimate. Monetary poverty, multidimensional poverty and hunger measure different things. Part 3 will examine those differences in detail.

Sources: 14, 13. Full references on pages 26-28.

10 / WHO RECEIVES THE GAINS

Poverty and inequality can move in different directions

Income is money received. Wealth is what is owned, minus what is owed.

Suppose one person earns ₹10,000 and another ₹1,00,000. Later they earn ₹15,000 and ₹2,00,000. Both have more money. The poorer person's position has improved, yet the income gap has widened. Falling poverty and rising concentration at the top can therefore happen together.

World Inequality Lab estimate, 2022-23**Top 1% share**

Share of total income

22.6%

Share of total wealth

40.1%

These are research estimates, not a direct government census of every person's income and assets. The researchers combine surveys, tax information, national accounts and information on very wealthy people. The World Inequality Report 2026 also discusses India's high concentration of income and wealth.

The date matters: a report published in 2026 does not automatically turn every underlying observation into 2026 data. The table here deliberately keeps the 2022-23 observation year attached to the values. It does not invent a matched 2014 observation from a different source.

Consumption surveys answer another question: how much households consume. A wealthy household can save a large part of its income. Its spending share can therefore be much smaller than its income or wealth share. A consumption-inequality measure cannot simply replace an income-inequality measure.

The exact concentration estimates depend on how missing or under-recorded income at the top is handled. That deserves scrutiny. It also deserves to be read alongside the evidence of falling poverty, rather than assuming one cancels the other.

For everyday life, the issue is access: who can absorb an emergency, buy a home, fund education or take a business risk? Average income alone leaves those differences almost completely hidden.

Sources: 15, 16, 14. Full references on pages 26-28.

11 / GOVERNMENT BORROWING

The gap between receipts and spending

The fiscal deficit measures a year's financing gap.

Central Government fiscal deficit	Reported share of GDP
2013-14, contemporary provisional outcome	4.5%
2025-26, CGA provisional accounts	4.40%
2026-27, Budget Estimate	4.3%

The fiscal deficit is total government spending minus its receipts other than new borrowing. It is a flow over a year. GDP is the whole economy's annual output, so 4.4% of GDP does not mean 4.4% of the government's budget.

CGA's provisional 2025-26 accounts show ₹49.05 lakh crore of spending and ₹33.86 lakh crore of non-debt receipts. The gap is about ₹15.19 lakh crore. Figures are rounded here from the accounts; the source reports a 4.40% deficit ratio. These are unaudited provisional actuals, not the earlier Budget Estimate.

The 2026-27 figure is a plan for a year still in progress. The historical and current ratios also reflect the GDP estimates used by their publishers. GDP revisions can change a ratio even when the rupee borrowing amount stays the same. Do not read the tiny difference between 4.5 and 4.4 as a perfectly precise measure of performance.

Borrowing can help pay for useful long-lived assets or support activity in a downturn. It also creates future interest costs. The amount, purpose, financing cost and future income all matter.

The two endpoints hide the years in between, including the pandemic. A fair assessment needs that path as well as the endpoints. These figures cover the Centre. State finances must be added with care to assess government as a whole, without double-counting transfers between governments.

Sources: 17, 18, 19. Full references on pages 26-28.

12 / DEBT AND INTEREST

The old bills travel with the new budget

Debt is the outstanding stock. A deficit adds to the financing need.

Central Government, Budget 2026-27 vintage	Debt / GDP
2025-26 Revised Estimate	56.1%
2026-27 Budget Estimate	55.6%

These ratios describe central government debt in the Budget's framework. They are not the combined debt of the Centre and every state, and they are not India's external debt. The GDP assumptions are those of the February 2026 Budget, before the later national-accounts rebasing.

The Matrix chart uses 51.6% for 2013-14 and 56.1% later. I have not established a common debt definition and GDP vintage for that pair. I therefore do not use it to calculate a precise change. Historical liabilities figures can differ because of exchange-rate valuation and which liabilities are included.

Debt is what remains to be repaid at a point in time. The fiscal deficit is a year's gap. A government can reduce its annual deficit and still add to its debt. A debt-to-GDP ratio can fall while the rupee debt rises, if nominal GDP grows faster.

The provisional 2025-26 accounts put central interest payments at ₹12.43 lakh crore. Against revenue receipts of ₹33.02 lakh crore, that is about 37.6%, calculated from CGA's figures. In plain language, a large part of recurring receipts is already committed to interest before other uses are considered.

A government is not identical to a household: it can tax, refinance debt and shape economic activity. It still faces choices. More money committed to interest can leave less room for other priorities unless revenue grows, borrowing rises or spending changes.

The useful question is whether debt can be serviced while maintaining essential services and productive investment. One debt ratio, read alone, cannot answer it.

Sources: 19, 18, 32. Full references on pages 26-28.

13 / PUBLIC INVESTMENT

More spending on assets. Then comes delivery.

Capital expenditure is a budget category, not a completed-project count.

Central capital expenditure	Amount
2013-14, actual accounts	₹1.88 lakh crore
2025-26, provisional actual accounts	₹10.69 lakh crore
2026-27, Budget Estimate	₹12.22 lakh crore

The first amount is ₹1,87,675 crore in the Budget's historical account. The second is ₹10,69,119 crore in CGA's provisional accounts. The cash amount is about 5.70 times the earlier level. That is a nominal increase across twelve years, before adjusting for construction and other costs.

Capital spending includes acquiring or creating assets and certain loans or investments. Roads, railway works and equipment are familiar examples. The Centre can also give grants that create assets elsewhere; those grants are not all booked under its own capital-expenditure heading.

For 2025-26, direct capital spending was about 21.8% of total central expenditure, calculated as ₹10.69 lakh crore divided by ₹49.05 lakh crore. The Matrix chart's 22.1% corresponds closely to revised budget amounts. Actual spending and revised plans should keep their labels.

It is tempting to call every capital rupee good and every recurring rupee wasteful. That misses how services work. A new hospital needs doctors, nurses, medicines and maintenance. A school needs teachers. Many useful costs recur each year.

The more demanding test is what the spending delivered: a functioning asset, the people using it, the time or cost saved, and the upkeep it needs. Announced allocations, money spent and completed projects are three different stages. Part 2 will follow that distinction through physical infrastructure.

Sources: 21, 18, 20, 32. Full references on pages 26-28.

14 / TAXES AND SUPPORT

Where the money comes from, and who it helps

Gross tax, net tax and subsidies answer different questions.

Central Government figure	Amount / status
Gross tax receipts, 2013-14	₹11.34 lakh crore, provisional at the time
Gross tax receipts, 2026-27	₹44.04 lakh crore, Budget Estimate
Tax revenue retained by Centre, 2025-26	₹26.23 lakh crore, provisional actual
Major subsidies, 2025-26	₹4.54 lakh crore, provisional actual

Gross central tax receipts are counted before the states' share is transferred. Net tax revenue is what remains for the Centre after the relevant deductions and transfers. Placing gross receipts in one year beside net receipts in another produces a false comparison.

The 2026-27 gross number is a budget plan, not money already collected. A larger cash total over a long period can reflect a bigger economy, rising prices, tax changes and better collection. It does not by itself measure the tax burden on a typical household.

CGA's 2025-26 major-subsidy total includes about ₹2.28 lakh crore for food, ₹2.11 lakh crore for fertilisers and ₹0.14 lakh crore for petroleum. The displayed components are rounded. This heading is narrower than all welfare spending: pensions, health programmes and many other forms of support appear elsewhere.

A subsidy can reduce a price or support access to a basic need. Its effect depends on who receives it, whether it reaches them and what it costs to deliver. Spending less is not automatically better; spending more is not automatically more effective.

The same care applies to GST. A total GST collection series begins after the 2017 introduction of the system. Writing “zero GST in 2014” would not mean there were zero indirect taxes then. A serious comparison must include the taxes that GST replaced.

Sources: 17, 18, 20. Full references on pages 26-28.

15 / BANKS

Bad loans became a smaller share of lending

The improvement matters. So does the route taken.

Gross non-performing loans, scheduled commercial banks	Share
March 2014	4.1%
March 2026	1.8%

An NPA is a loan classified as non-performing under banking rules, generally because required payments have remained overdue beyond the applicable limit. The gross NPA ratio compares these bad loans with total gross advances. “Gross” is before deducting provisions, the amounts banks set aside for possible losses.

The later ratio is lower by 2.3 percentage points. In simple terms, a smaller share of the recorded loan book was classified as bad at that date. That supports a healthier banking system, but it is not a measure of how many borrowers are debt-free.

The path was not a steady fall from 2014. Recognition of stressed loans changed during the clean-up, including RBI's Asset Quality Review in 2015. Banks can reduce NPAs through repayment, recovery, restructuring that meets the rules, sales and write-offs. A growing total loan book can also lower the ratio.

A write-off changes the bank's accounting. It does not automatically cancel the borrower's obligation or mean that the full amount was recovered. Those outcomes need separate evidence. Likewise, a low bad-loan ratio today does not guarantee that every new loan will be repaid.

RBI's June 2026 report also records strong lending growth and examines banks' ability to handle stress. Its stress scenarios are tests of possible future conditions, not forecasts that a crisis will occur. For a borrower, the further questions are whether credit is accessible, affordable and suited to the income that must repay it.

Sources: 22, 23, 24. Full references on pages 26-28.

16 / FINANCIAL ACCESS

A bank account became much more common

Access is a real gain. Use and control are the next questions.

Adults aged 15+ with an account	2014	2024
All adults	53.1%	89.0%
Women	43.1%	89.2%
Men	62.8%	88.8%

These Global Findex figures count ownership of an account at a financial institution or with a mobile-money provider. They are survey estimates for adults, not the number of accounts. One person can own several accounts, so an administrative account total cannot simply be divided by the population to measure access.

Overall ownership rose by 35.9 percentage points between the two survey years. The large gap between women and men in 2014 had almost disappeared in the 2024 estimates. Small differences such as the later 0.4-point female lead should not be overinterpreted without considering sampling uncertainty.

An account can make it easier to receive wages or transfers, store money and make payments. But an account with no balance, one controlled by somebody else, or one that is difficult to access is a different experience from a regularly used personal account.

To judge financial inclusion more fully, look at activity, independent control, savings, affordable borrowing, service costs and the ability to resolve problems. Having the doorway is valuable; it does not tell us everything about using the room.

The later figures were collected in 2024 and published in the 2025 Findex edition. They are not observations from 2026. The 2014 survey is also a calendar-year observation, not a clean measurement taken just before the May change of government. This is a strong decade-long comparison of access, with those dates kept visible.

Sources: 25. Full references on pages 26-28.

17 / SELLING TO THE WORLD

Exports grew. Goods and services both matter.

Keep the basket and currency the same.

Combined goods and services exports	US dollars
2013-14	\$466.22 billion
2025-26, later rounded ministry estimate	About \$863 billion

The later combined total is about 85% above the earlier one in dollar terms. Spread over twelve years, that works out to roughly 5.3% a year when compounded. These are calculations using the displayed, partly rounded values; they are not inflation-adjusted export-volume growth.

The ministry's later 2025-26 estimate separates roughly \$442 billion of goods from \$421 billion of services. Goods include physical products. Services can include software, business services and other activities sold to customers abroad. Comparing old goods-only exports with a new goods-plus-services total exaggerates the change.

The original April 2026 combined estimate was about \$860.09 billion. Services data were then partly estimated and were updated later. This volume uses the later rounded \$863 billion figure and retains its estimate label. Extra decimal places would imply precision that the selected release does not provide.

The latest partial-year release reports combined exports of \$399.27 billion during April-August 2026, against \$345.55 billion in the same months of 2025. That is a like-period increase of 15.55%. Five months must be compared with five months, not with a whole year's exports.

Export earnings can support firms, jobs and foreign-currency receipts. Gross exports are not the same as domestic value added: producing an exported item may require imported parts, fuel or services. Imports also need to be considered before drawing a conclusion about the country's external balance.

US dollars throughout. Nominal values; services estimates may be revised. Sources: 26, 27, 28. Full references on pages 26-28.

18 / THE OUTSIDE BALANCE SHEET

More foreign debt can coexist with a lower debt ratio

External debt covers money owed to non-residents by several sectors.

RBI external-debt indicators	March 2014	June 2026
Outstanding external debt	\$446.2 billion	\$778.2 billion
External debt as a share of GDP	23.9%	20.8%
Foreign-exchange reserves / external debt	68.2%	85.9%

The September 2026 RBI release provides these historical and recent figures in the same table. The dollar debt stock increased by about 74%. Its share of GDP was lower. Those statements can both be true because the economy is larger. The chart's earlier 23.3% is not the March 2014 ratio in this RBI table.

External debt is not just the Union government's borrowing. Companies, banks and other borrowers are included. Nor must every external loan be denominated in dollars: “external” refers to the creditor being a non-resident.

Reserves are foreign-currency assets and other reserve assets held by the monetary authorities. They provide a buffer, but they are not an unlimited fund for meeting every private debt. The reserve-to-debt ratio is also different from import cover, which asks how many months of imports reserves could pay for at a specified import rate.

A current account deficit is a flow, not this debt stock. It combines trade in goods and services with income and transfers across borders. The 2013-14 deficit was reported as 1.7% of GDP. This volume does not certify the chart's later 0.6% without a matched balance-of-payments release and revision date.

The timing of repayment matters as much as the total. Debt falling due soon, currency changes and the ability to refinance can create pressure. A single external-debt ratio cannot capture all of that risk.

Sources: 29, 33, 32. Full references on pages 26-28.

19 / FOREIGN INVESTMENT

Money entering the country is only one side

Gross FDI is different from net FDI.

Total inward foreign direct investment	US dollars
2013-14	\$36.05 billion
2024-25, updated series in the fact sheet	\$80.615 billion
2025-26, provisional	\$94.527 billion

These are total FDI inflows, not just equity inflows. DPIIT's March 2026 fact sheet includes equity, estimated reinvested earnings and other capital. The latest annual total is about 2.62 times the 2013-14 level, an increase of roughly 162% in nominal dollar terms.

FDI, or foreign direct investment, generally involves a lasting ownership interest in an enterprise. It can bring money, technology, management links and access to markets. Its effects depend on the investment's form and what the business actually does.

Gross inflow counts the inward side. Net measures also deduct specified outward flows, such as investor exits or repatriation; broader net direct-investment balances also account for residents' investment abroad. Always check the definition in the source. A strong gross total can coexist with a weak net figure.

Buying an existing business and building a new factory are both capable of attracting FDI. They do not create the same amount of new productive capacity at the moment of the transaction. Reinvested profits can count even when fresh money does not cross the border that month.

The fact sheet marks components as estimates and the recent data as provisional. The total is useful evidence of the scale of inward investment. It is not a direct count of factories built, jobs created or money permanently staying in India. Those outcomes need their own evidence.

Sources: 30, 31. Full references on pages 26-28.

20 / READING THE MATRIX CHART

Where the economic comparison needs care

First eight rows of the fifteen-indicator chart.

The chart is a starting list of claims. The notes below explain what this volume established, changed or left unresolved. A “before” and “after” pair needs the same concept, period and source treatment.

Chart row and displayed pair	What to read beside it
Real growth: 4.7% to 7.6%	The old 4.7% used the 2004-05 factor-cost framework. The 2011-12 GDP series reports 6.4% for 2013-14. New 2026 data use another base. Do not treat the pair as unchanged measurement.
Inflation: 9.5% to 2.1%	The old figure is an annual average. The latest monthly CPI reading checked is 4.82% for August 2026. A whole-year / one-month mix needs explicit labels.
Fiscal deficit: 4.5% to 4.4%	Broadly matches the reported endpoint ratios here. Keep Centre-only scope, GDP vintage and provisional status visible.
Capital spending share: 11.7% to 22.1%	22.1% matches revised budget amounts closely; the provisional actual share is about 21.8%. The older 11.7% denominator was not independently established here.
Current account: -1.7% to -0.6%	The earlier annual deficit is sourced. The later number remains unconfirmed in this volume against a matched primary release.
Gross NPA: 4.1% to 1.8%	The endpoint figures are supported. The intervening recognition and clean-up process matters; falling NPAs are not all cash recoveries.
Revenue deficit: 3.2% to 1.5%	CGA reports 1.55% for provisional 2025-26. The 2026-27 Budget target is 1.5%. These are different dates and statuses.
Government debt: 51.6% to 56.1%	56.1% is a central-debt revised Budget estimate. A common definition and GDP vintage for the older 51.6% was not established.

The original 4.7% figure is a historical vintage, not a fabricated number. The issue is comparability. Sources: 06, 07, 08, 17, 18, 19, 20, 22, 23, 32, 33, 34. Full references on pages 26-28.

21 / WHAT THE CHART CANNOT SETTLE

The remaining rows, and the question of credit

A change after 2014 does not, by itself, identify its cause.

Remaining chart row	What is still needed
External debt: 23.3% to 20.8%	RBI's current historical table gives 23.9% for March 2014 and 20.8% for June 2026. State the dates and revision vintage.
Import cover: 8 to 10 months	Reserve date and import denominator: past imports or projected imports? Not independently certified here.
Bank credit growth: 14% to 15.9%	Bank coverage, observation dates and adjustment for mergers. One annual rate is not the growth rate for an entire era.
Subsidies / GDP: 2.2% to 1.2%	Specify which subsidies, actuals or estimates, and GDP vintage. "Major subsidies" is narrower than all welfare spending.
Global growth: 3.2% to 3.0%	Name the IMF or other release and whether the later value is observed or forecast. It is not an Indian government output.
Contribution to world growth: 11% to 17.5%	A PPP-weighted contribution needs a published calculation and year. It is not India's share of world income.
Growth rank among major economies: 3 to 1	Define "major", the countries, period and forecast status. Ranking is separate from income per person.

Several chart rows remain unresolved here; they are not promoted into verified facts. Part 6 is planned to extend the chart and ranking audit. The two posts originally supplied, covering infrastructure and Scheduled Tribe crime, belong to Parts 2 and 5 respectively.

For responsibility, timing is a starting clue. A result can reflect Union policy, state policy, earlier investment, private effort, technology and world conditions. Establishing how much one policy caused requires evidence beyond two endpoints. Recognising that does not erase an achievement or a failure; it makes the explanation more accurate.

Sources: 18, 21, 23, 29, 32, 35, 36. Full references on pages 26-28.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

01 Lovepreet Singh / MisterLove

Public author profile and editorial theme

Accessed 2 October 2026. Used for the byline and short biography.

02 Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

National income: historical GDP tables, 2011-12 series

31 January 2018 release. Statement 1.1: 2013-14 nominal GDP.

03 Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

Provisional national income estimates, 2024-25

30 May 2025. Historical 2011-12 series; superseded for current levels.

04 Ministry of Finance / Economic Survey 2025-26

Statistical Appendix, Table 1.1: national and per capita income

January 2026 publication, before the 2022-23 GDP rebasing. Page 3.

05 Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

GDP estimates for April-June 2026

31 August 2026. New base year 2022-23; latest released quarter at this cut-off.

06 Government of India / Lok Sabha

Historical real GDP growth: parliamentary answer

2011-12 series. Table reports 6.4% growth in 2013-14.

07 Ministry of Finance

Historical CPI inflation and fiscal indicators

22 May 2017 release. Reports annual CPI inflation of 9.5% in 2013-14.

08 Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

Consumer Price Index, August 2026

14 September 2026. Base 2024=100. August figures provisional.

09 Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

Periodic Labour Force Survey: Annual Report 2025

27 March 2026 release. Calendar-year results and explicit survey-design caveat.

10 Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

PLFS Annual Report 2025, revised publication

Revised 29 May 2026. Detailed employment, earnings and definition tables.

11 Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

PLFS Annual Report, July 2023-June 2024

23 September 2024. Contains the 2017-18 to 2023-24 comparison.

12 Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

Household Consumption Expenditure Survey 2023-24

27 December 2024 release. MPCE with and without welfare imputation.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

13 Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

[HCES 2023-24: survey methods and supporting documents](#)

Survey covers August 2023-July 2024; resources updated in 2026.

14 World Bank

[India Development Update, April 2026](#)

Poverty discussion and Figures 2.6-2.7. Uses 2021 PPP poverty lines.

15 World Inequality Lab

[Income and Wealth Inequality in India, 1922-2023](#)

Working Paper 2024/09. Tables 2-3; estimates for 2022-23.

16 World Inequality Lab

[World Inequality Report 2026](#)

Latest report edition consulted. India profile; see methodology for dates and estimates.

17 Ministry of Finance

[Fiscal outcome of the Central Government in 2013-14](#)

9 July 2014. Fiscal and revenue deficits as reported at that time.

18 Controller General of Accounts

[Union Government Accounts at a Glance, 2025-26](#)

Full-year provisional, unaudited accounts. Includes major subsidies and deficit ratios.

19 Ministry of Finance

[Union Budget 2026-27: deficit and debt estimates](#)

1 February 2026. Budget estimates and revised estimates; GDP vintage predates rebasing.

20 Ministry of Finance

[Union Budget 2026-27: expenditure and receipts](#)

1 February 2026. Gross tax, capital spending and revenue deficit estimates.

21 Ministry of Finance

[Medium Term Fiscal Policy Statement, Budget 2015-16](#)

Paragraph 48: 2013-14 actual capital expenditure; paragraph 47: major subsidies.

22 Ministry of Finance

[Banking-sector reform and asset-quality figures](#)

27 February 2015 release. Scheduled commercial banks: March 2014 gross NPA ratio.

23 Reserve Bank of India

[Financial Stability Report, June 2026: Chapter II](#)

30 June 2026. Paragraphs 2.4-2.8: lending, deposits and asset quality.

24 Ministry of Finance

[Gross NPAs of scheduled commercial banks](#)

9 February 2026. Explains the 2015 Asset Quality Review and subsequent reforms.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

25 World Bank / Global Index

Account ownership, population aged 15 and above

India survey years 2011, 2014, 2017, 2021 and 2024. 2025 database edition.

26 Ministry of Information and Broadcasting

New India Samachar, 1-15 July 2025

Historical chart: combined goods and services exports in 2013-14, \$466.22 billion.

27 Ministry of Commerce and Industry

India export performance, FY 2025-26

June 2026 release. Rounded estimates: total \$863bn, goods \$442bn, services \$421bn.

28 Ministry of Commerce and Industry

Trade estimates, August 2026

15 September 2026. April-August comparison; services estimates subject to revision.

29 Reserve Bank of India

External debt at end-June 2026

30 September 2026. Table 5 includes historical end-March 2014 data.

30 Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade

FDI quarterly fact sheet, March 2026

June 2026 publication. Table 2: total inflows, including reinvested earnings.

31 Ministry of Commerce and Industry

Historical and recent FDI inflows

10 December 2025. Reports the 2013-14 total of \$36.05 billion.

32 The Matrix India

Fifteen economic indicators: 2013-14 and 2025-26

13 August 2026 post. Starting claim list, not an independent statistical authority.

33 Ministry of Finance

Balance of payments in 2013-14

9 July 2014. Current account deficit \$32.4bn, or 1.7% of GDP.

34 Ministry of Finance

Projected Growth in GDP During 2013-14

18 July 2014. Historical 4.7% provisional GDP growth, 2004-05 price framework.

35 The Matrix India

Infrastructure comparison supplied by the reader

4 August 2026. Reserved for Part 2 and the later chart audit.

36 The Matrix India

Scheduled Tribe crime comparison supplied by the reader

1 October 2026. Reserved for Part 5 and the later chart audit.

A REPORT CARD IN PLAIN ENGLISH

India, before and after 2014

Infrastructure and everyday services

*What changed. What the numbers mean.
What still needs a closer look.*

PART TWO OF SIX

Written by Lovepreet Singh

misterlove.in / Research cut-off: 2 October 2026

A NOTE FROM ME

A country is also the things that work.

An author's note

Part 1 began with money, work and prices. This part starts closer to the front door. Is there a road you can use in the rain? Does the tap run? Can you reach a hospital, make a payment or get home without losing half your day? These are ordinary questions. Together, they tell us a lot about a country.

I wanted this volume to explain infrastructure without making it sound like an engineering textbook. A gigawatt should mean something to the person paying an electricity bill. A kilometre of metro should mean something to the person trying to get to work.

The chart shared by The Matrix India made a striking claim about how much was added after 2014. Some of its comparisons hold up well. Others need a different starting date, a clearer definition or a newer figure. I have kept the original claims visible so you can see where the report agrees and where it changes the comparison.

I also want to keep two things in view at the same time: building something and making it useful. A house on a sanction list is still a promise. A house completed is a physical result. A house that a family can safely live in is the reason for doing the work.

At MisterLove, I write about society, history, public policy and technology in plain language. I'm Lovepreet Singh, founder of Lovelace and an MBA student in Business Strategy and Analysis, working toward doctoral research. This report follows the same habit: take the claim apart, explain it, and leave the evidence where the reader can find it.

I am not asking you to memorise these numbers. I want you to understand them well enough that the next dramatic chart takes a little less effort to read.

Lovepreet Singh

MisterLove · 2 October 2026

Sources: 01, 02. Full references on pages 26-28.

YOUR WAY THROUGH THIS VOLUME

From the highway to the kitchen tap

Part 2 of the six-part India report card.

Pages	What you will find
4	How to read the figures and the chart percentages
5-7	National highways, faster roads and rural roads
8-10	Electric trains, passenger and freight use, dedicated freight corridors
11-14	Metro, airports, ports and inland waterways
15-18	Power capacity, renewable energy, electricity supply and cooking gas
19-21	Rural taps, sanitation and housing
22-23	Internet access, digital payments and who can use them
24-25	Checks on every row of the Matrix infrastructure chart
26-28	Sources: clickable links and dates

The figures are organised by what the service does. Transport moves people and goods. Power and gas supply energy. Water, sanitation and housing support daily life. Digital networks help people communicate, pay and use services.

Most earlier observations are from March 2014 or 2013-14. Some programmes and surveys began later. Those dates remain visible. The recent column means the latest suitable figure checked for that comparison, not a measurement of everything on the same day.

Part 1 is complete. This is Part 2. The remaining planned volumes cover health and education; farming and industry; crime, institutions and environment; and state differences and international rankings. Their figures are not silently folded into this volume.

The research cut-off is 2 October 2026. A 2026 publication may describe 2025 activity. A target for 2028 is still a target. Each table tells you which kind of date you are reading.

Sources: 02. Full references on pages 26-28.

HOW TO READ THE COMPARISON

A bigger number needs a clear meaning.

The unit, the date and the stage of delivery come first.

A stock is what exists at a date, such as railway length or tap connections. A flow is activity during a period, such as annual cargo or monthly payments. A change in stock is not automatically entirely new construction. A financial year such as 2013-14 runs from April 2013 to March 2014.

One lakh is 1,00,000. One crore is 1,00,00,000, or ten million. MMT means million metric tonnes. MTPA means million tonnes per year of handling capacity. A port able to handle 100 MTPA has capacity; it may actually handle much less cargo that year.

A gigawatt, written GW, is 1,000 megawatts of power capacity. It describes how much power equipment can produce under the relevant conditions. A kilowatt-hour, or one electricity unit on a bill, measures energy used over time. Capacity and annual electricity generation are different.

The Matrix chart's percentage uses the later total as its denominator. If a network goes from 100 km to 200 km, the extra 100 km is 50% of the new total. The usual growth rate is 100%, because the increase is divided by the earlier 100 km. Both calculations are valid; they answer different questions.

That chart formula works best for a consistently measured stock. Annual coal production or defence exports are flows. Their increases are not the share of a physical network built. Recognised startups are an administrative category, and tap-water coverage is a household percentage.

Sanctioned means approved. Under construction means work is progressing. Commissioned means put into service under the relevant reporting rules. Usage tells us what people or goods actually did. We keep those stages separate because each is a different part of the story.

Finally, a change after 2014 does not tell us exactly who caused it. Union and state decisions, local bodies, private investment, earlier plans and technology can all contribute. These comparisons establish recorded changes; they are not a calculation of political credit.

Sources: 02, 03, 07, 15, 17. Full references on pages 26-28.

01 / NATIONAL HIGHWAYS

The main road network became much longer.

National highway length is one part of India's roads.

National highway network	Recorded length
March 2014	91,287 km
4 February 2026 ministry release	1,46,572 km
Increase between the displayed totals	55,285 km, or about 60.6%

A national highway is a road in a designated national network. It is not every road in India. State highways, district roads, village roads and city streets are counted under other headings. The larger later number therefore describes one important network, rather than every route a person can travel.

Imagine a map with 91 km of a particular road category. A rise of about 61% would take that category to roughly 147 km. That gives a feel for the scale. The actual national figure is a thousand times larger.

The network can grow through new alignments, extensions and the declaration of existing roads as national highways. Widening an existing stretch can improve its capacity without adding the same number of route kilometres. So the difference of 55,285 km should not be described as 55,285 km of brand-new road built on previously roadless land.

Road kilometres and lane kilometres also differ. A 10 km four-lane road is 10 road km but 40 lane km. Adding lanes can make construction substantial while the route length remains 10 km. Mixing the two units makes an increase look larger or smaller than it is.

What does this mean in daily life? A useful new or improved connection can shorten a journey and help goods reach a market. The actual gain depends on where it goes, congestion, tolls, maintenance and access from the surrounding area. A bigger national total cannot tell you whether your particular journey became easier.

The later endpoint is the dated ministry report. Network growth includes changes in designation. Sources: 03, 04. Full references on pages 26-28.

02 / FASTER AND WIDER ROADS

More lanes and expressways. Different counts.

The road category must stay the same in both columns.

Defined official comparison	2014	Recent
Four-lane and above NH, June 2026 backgrounder	18,371 km	45,516 km
Operational national access-controlled corridors, Dec 2025 review	93 km	3,052 km
Same corridor heading, June 2026 backgrounder	93 km baseline	3,644 km

Four-lane and above tells you the road's width in traffic lanes. Access-controlled tells you how traffic enters and leaves it: vehicles normally use planned interchanges rather than every roadside turning. A wide highway and an expressway are therefore not automatically the same thing.

The chart's expressway pair, 1,000 to 6,700 km, was not independently reproduced for a consistent all-India definition in this volume. National corridors are a narrower series than a total that might also include state expressways. The official national figure above cannot simply replace an all-India total without explaining the change in scope.

Construction speed also varies by year. The ministry's annual table reports 12.1 km a day in 2014-15, 36.5 in 2020-21, 33.83 in 2023-24 and 29.21 in 2024-25. The last of those is 10,660 km across the year. The peak rate was not maintained every year.

These annual construction figures can include improvement works, not just entirely new roads. The 2014-15 observation is also after the change of government. It should not be labelled the entire pace of the earlier government.

A faster road can save time when its complete usable stretch connects the places people need. An awarded project, an opened section and a complete corridor are separate milestones. Safe crossings, emergency response, local access and upkeep remain part of the result.

Road series and later dates differ by row. No single expressway total is certified here. Sources: 02, 04, 05. Full references on pages 26-28.

03 / RURAL ROADS

A village road can change an ordinary day.

PMGSY counts programme work, including construction and upgrades.

PMGSY road work	Length / status
Completed during 2000-2014, rounded earlier account	About 3.86 lakh km
Cumulative constructed across phases, July 2026 release	7,96,940.94 km
Cumulative sanctioned, same release	8,55,980.33 km
Bridges constructed, same release	10,833

PMGSY is the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana. It began in 2000 to provide all-weather rural road connectivity. Later phases also improve important routes and links to facilities. It existed before 2014 and continued afterward.

The June backgrounder separately reports about 4.11 lakh km completed during 2014-2026. That is work during the later period, not a later cumulative total of only 4.11 lakh km. The July cumulative figure of nearly 7.97 lakh km makes that distinction clearer.

Programme work is not the same as the length of a unique national rural-road network. An upgraded road can be counted as work even though a route already existed. Different programme phases also have different purposes. Adding all their work lengths does not prove that every kilometre was a first-time connection.

Think about a farm connected to a market by a track that becomes unusable during heavy rain. A durable road can make the trip more predictable. It can also help a school bus or ambulance reach the settlement. The benefit comes from the usable connection, not from the sign announcing the project.

Eligibility matters. A habitation is a settlement, and programme rules use population thresholds and special provisions for some difficult areas. “All eligible habitations connected” would not mean every small settlement in the country has every kind of road. Maintenance and bridge condition determine whether the connection stays useful.

Sources: 06, 07. Full references on pages 26-28.

04 / ELECTRIC TRAINS

Most broad-gauge routes now have electric wires.

Electrifying a route is different from building a new one.

Electrified routes: retrospective ministry series	Length
2014 baseline used in the 2026 backgrounder	21,801 route km
March 2026	69,873 route km
March 2026 share of broad-gauge network	99.6%

An electric locomotive receives power through equipment above the track. Electrification provides that system on a route. The railway can then run suitable electric trains there. A route may be decades old even when its electric equipment was installed recently.

Route km measures the distance between places along the network. Track km also counts parallel tracks. A 100 km route with two running tracks is still 100 route km, although it has 200 running-track km. Electrification statistics must not be silently compared with total track length.

The displayed electrified length is about 3.2 times the ministry's earlier baseline. The increase is about 48,072 route km. That is a major change in the type of traction the network can support. It is not a claim that the whole railway became 3.2 times longer.

There is a historical reporting difference worth keeping visible. The older revised railway statistical summary records 21,614 electrified route km for 2013-14. The 2026 backgrounder uses 21,801 for its retrospective 2014 comparison. The table above retains the later ministry vintage; it does not pretend both historical totals are identical.

Electric trains can reduce direct diesel use and support efficient operation. The wider environmental effect depends on how their electricity is generated. Wires alone do not settle punctuality, ticket availability, crowding, track quality or safety.

Broad gauge describes a particular distance between rails. The 99.6% figure applies to that network. It should not be expanded into a claim that every railway, every route or every train in India has become electric.

Sources: 08, 09, 17. Full references on pages 26-28.

05 / WHAT THE RAILWAY CARRIED

More freight. Fewer passenger journeys.

Physical use belongs beside the infrastructure total.

Annual railway activity	2013-14	2025-26
Freight tonnes, definitions noted below	1,051.64 million	1,670 million
Passenger journeys, definitions noted below	839.7 crore	741 crore

The earlier figures come from the revised railway statistical summary. The recent figures come from the ministry's annual release. On these reported measures, freight is about 59% higher, while passenger journeys are about 12% lower. The recent headline data are not a substitute for the final detailed statistical accounts.

A passenger journey is a trip, not a unique person. Someone making repeated trips can be counted repeatedly. Railway passenger counts also combine different kinds of travel, including frequent suburban journeys and longer-distance trips.

A lower total does not prove that every type of railway travel declined. Nor does it, by itself, establish why the total changed. To understand the cause, we would need comparable suburban and non-suburban data, passenger kilometres, service availability, fares and changes in reporting.

The historical series shows the pandemic's disruption plainly: 808.6 crore journeys in 2019-20, 125 crore in 2020-21 and 351.9 crore in 2021-22. A later recovery from that low point can be real while the level remains below an older year. Both facts belong in the same explanation.

Freight tonnes count how much was carried. Tonne kilometres also count how far it travelled. Carrying one tonne for 1,000 km is a different amount of transport work from carrying it for 100 km. Higher freight loading therefore needs distance and commodity mix for a fuller interpretation.

For a traveller, the practical questions remain simple: can I get a seat, can I afford it, and will the journey be safe and reasonably dependable? A larger capital budget or more electric routes cannot answer those questions on its own.

Earlier freight: revenue-earning tonnes. Later figure: ministry headline loading; final detailed accounts may refine comparability. Sources: 09, 10. Full references on pages 26-28.

06 / DEDICATED FREIGHT CORRIDORS

Routes for goods trains.

A real addition, with a history that began before 2014.

Eastern and Western dedicated freight corridors	Length
Commissioned before 2014 in the stated project account	0 km
Eastern corridor, Ludhiana-Sonnagar	1,337 km
Western corridor, Dadri-JNPT	1,506 km
Combined stated corridor length	2,843 km

Freight means goods. A dedicated freight corridor is a railway designed mainly for goods trains. Separating much of that traffic can reduce competition for space on conventional lines that also carry passenger trains.

The August 2026 parliamentary answer says both corridors were commissioned. The September announcement describes the last links being joined. These are dated accounts of completion. Their 2,843 km is the stated combined length, not all Indian freight routes.

The zero means no commissioned kilometres of these corridors in the cited before-2014 account. India already had freight trains and goods routes, and preparation for this project had begun.

The project company, DFCCIL, was registered on 30 October 2006. Planning, finance, land acquisition and construction have different timelines. Earlier preparation and later commissioning both belong in the history.

Imagine trucks and commuter buses competing on one road. A separate route for many trucks can help both services if its junctions and connections work. Dedicated freight capacity follows a similar idea.

The practical tests are dependable delivery, useful factory and port connections, costs and actual use. The chart's 100% is calculated from zero commissioned kilometres. It does not measure the share of planning, spending or preparation that occurred after 2014.

Sources: 08, 11, 12, 13. Full references on pages 26-28.

07 / METRO AND CITY TRAVEL

Metro reached more cities.

A network can expand without serving every neighbourhood.

Operational metro network	Earlier	Recent
Length	248 km, 2014	1,155 km, March 2026
Cities covered	5, 2014	26, March 2026
Reported daily ridership	28 lakh, 2013-14	Over 1.15 crore, 2026

Metro is urban rail designed for frequent travel within a city and its connected areas. The reported route length is about 4.7 times the 2014 level, an increase of 907 km. The Matrix chart's rounded 1,000 km recent endpoint is below the later official snapshot used here.

Cities covered tells us how widely the system has spread. It does not tell us how much of each city has a useful connection. A small operating section and a large connected network can each put a city into that count.

Ridership normally counts trips or entries under the operator's method, not unique people. A commuter travelling to work and back can generate two trips. The national daily total also needs its reporting date and operator coverage; it is not a household survey of how many Indians can afford metro travel.

Consider a 15-minute train journey that requires a 30-minute trip to the first station and another 20 minutes from the last station to work. The whole commute is 65 minutes, before waiting. This is an example, not a measured national average. It explains why feeder buses, walking routes and interchange design matter.

A metro can offer dependable travel where demand and connections support it. Its usefulness also depends on fares, operating frequency, accessible stations, safety and maintenance. A completed line that few people can conveniently reach has a different value from a well-used one.

Keep regional rapid transit, ordinary metro and water-based urban transport labelled separately where the source does. They can all improve mobility, but a kilometre of one is not automatically interchangeable with a kilometre of another.

The recent daily ridership is a reported 2026 snapshot, not a matched full-year average. Sources: 05, 06. Full references on pages 26-28.

08 / AIRPORTS AND REGIONAL FLIGHTS

More places can connect by air.

An operating airport is not a promise of frequent cheap flights.

Aviation indicator	Earlier / recent figure
Operational airports, 2014	74
Operational airports, 15 July 2026 snapshot	165
UDAN routes operationalised, cumulative to 15 July 2026	679
Airports, heliports and water aerodromes connected by UDAN	95

The operational-airport total is higher by 91, or about 123%. That does not mean 91 entirely new airports were all built from scratch. A total can change through new facilities, revived facilities and changes in operating status or coverage.

UDAN is a regional air-connectivity programme launched in 2016. It supports selected routes to improve access to underserved or unserved places. Its route count is a different measure from the total airport count.

The UDAN snapshot also reports over 1.68 crore passengers cumulatively. Cumulative means across the programme's operation up to that date. It is not 1.68 crore passengers in a single year. A person taking several flights can be represented several times.

Heliports and water aerodromes serve different aircraft and operations from conventional airports. The 95 connected sites should therefore keep all three categories in the label. Adding them to the national airport total would risk counting overlapping facilities twice.

A route that was operationalised at some point is not automatically a route running every day now. Airlines, schedules and services can change. Before judging regional access, look at current flights, continuity, the fare people actually pay and the time needed to reach the airport.

A useful local flight can save a long road trip to a distant airport. For someone unable to afford a ticket, the airport alone does not create affordable access. Infrastructure and the travel experience need to be assessed together.

The chart shows 164 airports. The selected later official snapshot reports 165; the date is kept visible. Sources: 14. Full references on pages 26-28.

09 / PORTS

Ports can handle more. They also handled more.

Capacity and actual cargo are separate rows.

All Indian ports in the matched ministry table	2013-14	2025-26
Cargo-handling capacity	1,400 MTPA	2,818 MTPA
Actual cargo throughput	972 million tonnes	1,668 million tonnes

A port is where ships load and unload. Capacity is the amount it can handle annually under the source's method; MTPA means million tonnes per year. Throughput is the cargo actually handled. One is a capability, the other an activity.

On the matched figures, capacity roughly doubled: about 101% growth. Actual cargo increased by about 72%. Both are substantial increases. They are different because the ability to handle cargo is not the same as the quantity arriving to be handled.

The Matrix chart uses 800 to 2,760 MTPA. Its starting point is not the all-ports 2013-14 capacity in the matched ministry table. Comparing an older major-ports figure with a later all-ports figure would change the basket. This volume uses all ports in both columns instead.

A port can be physically capable of handling more cargo while ships still wait for a berth, paperwork or a road and rail connection. Faster unloading can also be undermined by slow movement outside the port. The full delivery chain matters.

A ship-turnaround figure is a measure of time, but averages can cover different vessel types and operations. One must keep the scope and period consistent before comparing them. Capacity alone is easier to measure than the complete experience of moving goods from a factory to a customer.

More cargo is not automatically more domestic value added. Ports also handle imports, raw materials and different kinds of bulk freight. The cargo mix is needed before making a claim about the value of what India produces.

Sources: 15. Full references on pages 26-28.

10 / INLAND WATERWAYS

More freight moves on rivers and canals.

A declared waterway and an operating one are different.

Waterways indicator	Earlier -> recent
Legally designated National Waterways	5 before 2016 -> 111 after the 2016 Act
Operational waterways, matched ministry table	3 in 2013-14 -> 32 in 2025-26
Annual inland cargo, matched ministry table	About 18 -> 218.24 million tonnes, 2013-14 to 2025-26

Inland waterways are navigable routes within the country, including rivers and canals. National Waterway status identifies a route under the legal and development framework. It does not make that route commercially usable all year.

An operating route needs a usable channel, vessels, terminals and land connections. Water depth, river conditions and maintenance affect what it can carry. A legal declaration is an earlier stage than dependable transport.

The Matrix chart compares five earlier waterways with 32 later ones. Five is the earlier declared count; the matched table gives three operational waterways in 2013-14. Compare declared with declared, or operational with operational.

The chart's earlier cargo figure of 29 million tonnes differs from the roughly 18 million tonnes in the matched table. The dated pair used here shows about twelve times the earlier cargo, with the rounded baseline visible.

Water transport can suit heavy goods when the route and terminal connections fit the shipment. Distance from the river, loading time, deadlines and seasonal reliability matter. It is not automatically the best option for every product.

Cargo tonnes do not measure the full environmental effect or the share of physical waterways built. Ferries, tourist cruises and freight are different uses. Adding their counts would not give one meaningful transport total.

The matched 2013-14 cargo baseline is rounded to 18 million tonnes in the parliamentary table. Sources: 06, 15. Full references on pages 26-28.

11 / POWER CAPACITY

India can generate much more power.

Installed capacity is the equipment total, not the electricity bill.

Installed power capacity	GW
March 2014, historical ministry figure	248.554
31 August 2026, CEA total	554.544
Increase in the displayed recorded stock	305.990

The later total is about 2.23 times the earlier level, or roughly 123% higher. That is a comparison of installed generation capacity. It is not a claim that electricity generation or every household's supply grew by exactly the same percentage.

Think of capacity as the kitchens available, and generation as the meals actually produced. Some kitchens operate often; others operate only at particular times. Equipment and output must be counted separately.

The CEA's August 2026 table gives 250.21 GW of fossil-fuel capacity and 304.334 GW of non-fossil capacity. Non-fossil includes renewable sources and nuclear power. It is broader than renewable energy alone.

By capacity, the table reports 54.88% non-fossil and 45.12% fossil. Coal alone is 40.47% of the total. Those are equipment shares. They do not say that 54.88% of all electricity generated during the year came from non-fossil sources.

A solar plant cannot generate its rated power continuously through the night. Other plants also have outages, fuel limits or maintenance needs. Supply has to match demand at the moment it is needed, using generation, storage, transmission and operating arrangements together.

Installed equipment can grow while a locality still has interruptions because of distribution faults. Better operations can also improve supply without as much new generation equipment. The chart shows a rounded 540 GW; this volume uses the dated August CEA total.

Sources: 16, 17. Full references on pages 26-28.

12 / RENEWABLE ENERGY

Solar grew especially fast.

Keep large hydro in or out consistently.

Installed renewable capacity	March 2014	August 2026
Solar, MNRE year-wise series	2.822 GW	168.040 GW
Wind, same series	21.043 GW	58.520 GW
All renewables including large hydro	76.38 GW	295.554 GW

The solar total is about 59.5 times the earlier value. A tiny starting point makes a large multiple possible, but the absolute addition also matters: about 165.2 GW. Wind is about 2.8 times its earlier level. Not every renewable technology grew at the same pace.

Renewable sources include solar, wind, hydro and forms of bioenergy under the official categories. Large hydro means larger hydroelectric projects; whether it is included changes the total substantially. In August 2026, the CEA figure excluding large hydro is about 243.49 GW, compared with 295.55 GW including it.

The older 76.38 GW is the retrospective inclusive baseline in the June 2026 government backgrounder. Solar and wind use MNRE's historical series. These source vintages remain labelled, rather than being silently replaced with older differently classified totals.

The chart's renewable pair, 54 to 248 GW, was not reproduced on a clearly consistent basis here. It needs dates and an inclusion rule for large hydro. It should not be read as a universal total of all clean-energy equipment. Nuclear power is non-fossil, but it is outside the renewable total used above.

Large additions to solar capacity create more ability to generate electricity when conditions allow. Turning that into dependable supply throughout the day also requires grid connections, flexibility and storage or complementary sources. A target or a tender award is not installed capacity.

Rooftop solar can reduce purchased electricity. The outcome depends on sunlight, system size, costs, maintenance and billing rules. A national capacity total does not mean every roof has panels or every home has a zero bill.

GW figures converted from MW. Current renewable totals include the categories shown in CEA/MNRE reporting. Sources: 05, 17, 18. Full references on pages 26-28.

13 / ELECTRICITY THAT REACHES PEOPLE

Longer hours of electricity.

Connections, supply and reliability are different measures.

Reported electricity availability	Earlier	Recent
Rural areas	12.5 hours a day, FY2015	22.6 hours, FY2025
Urban areas	22.1 hours a day, 2014 backgrounder baseline	23.6 hours, FY2025
High-voltage transmission, 220 kV and above	About 2.91 lakh circuit km, 2014	Over 5 lakh, January 2026

The March 2026 reply gives these later averages. Rural supply rose by 10.1 hours. It calls the earlier year FY2015, or 2014-15; the backgrounder calls it 2014 and supplies the urban baseline. These figures do not promise uninterrupted supply to each household.

Averages hide differences between states, seasons and localities. A business affected by brief interruptions needs more than a total-hours measure. Voltage quality and repair time also matter.

Transmission moves large amounts of electricity over longer distances. Distribution carries it through local substations, transformers and lines to consumers. A strong national grid can still meet a weak local link.

Circuit km is a counting unit for transmission circuits, not simply the distance along a map. For example, two circuits running over the same 100 km route make 200 circuit km. The table covers lines at 220 kilovolts and above; it does not include every local wire.

Transmission crossed five lakh circuit km in January 2026. The release gives 71.6% growth since April 2014. The chart's roughly 42% divides the increase by the later total instead. The different denominators answer different questions.

A household connection gives access to the network. Regular supply, an affordable bill, safe wiring and prompt repairs make it useful. The February 2026 backgrounder repeats an older urban average of 23.4 hours; the March reply gives 23.6 for FY2025. The dated versions are not identical.

Supply hours: FY2025 in the March 2026 reply, not a new household survey. Transmission milestone: 14 January 2026. Sources: 19, 20. Full references on pages 26-28.

14 / GAS FOR THE KITCHEN

Gas reached more households.

PNG is piped natural gas; LPG usually arrives in cylinders.

Gas infrastructure indicator	Earlier -> recent / use
Operational natural-gas pipelines	15,340 km, 2014 -> 27,427 km, December 2025
Domestic PNG connections	About 25-26 lakh before 2014 -> 1.74 crore, August 2026
PNG billed connections, March 2026	1.07 crore of 1.69 crore recorded connections

Long-distance pipelines carry gas to consuming areas. City-gas networks distribute it to homes and businesses. A pipeline passing an area does not mean every home there has a kitchen connection.

The recent pipeline total is about 79% above the historical ministry figure. It comes from PNGRB's March 2026 publication, but that particular table explicitly dates the pipeline data to December 2025. The publication month must not replace the observation date.

A domestic PNG connection provides a fixed pipe to a household. It is different from a commercial or industrial connection. The earlier approximate reach of 25-26 lakh homes is a figure stated in the March 2026 Prime Minister's speech, rather than an independently reconstructed household survey.

PNGRB records 1,69,49,377 domestic connections for March 2026, of which 1,07,25,930 were billed connections: about 63%. The regulator distinguishes having a connection from being billed for use. The exact administrative meaning matters; the gap cannot automatically be called permanent abandonment.

The August 2026 ministry release also describes converting unbilled connections into working connections. Its later 1.74 crore total is a connection-stock figure. This report does not invent a later billed-use percentage from that stock.

Piped gas can remove cylinder deliveries where service is dependable. LPG provides another route to cleaner cooking where PNG is unavailable. For either fuel, costs, safety and supply matter. A connection alone does not prove that a household can afford enough fuel or has stopped using other fuels.

Pipeline observation: December 2025. Sources: 21, 22, 23, 24. Full references on pages 26-28.

15 / WATER AT HOME

A tap is a start. Water is the service.

The correct programme baseline is August 2019, not 2014.

Rural household tap connections	Reported reach
August 2019, at the start of Jal Jeevan Mission	3.23 crore households; 16.72%
14 August 2026 ministry update	15.91 crore households; 82.24%
Added over that programme period	12.68 crore connections

Reported coverage rose by 65.52 percentage points. About 82 of every 100 rural households were recorded with taps in the update, leaving about 18 outside coverage. States and Union Territories report these figures; they are not a fresh survey of water from every tap.

The earlier 16.72% is from 2019. Putting it under 'before 2014' moves it back five years and changes the story. This report keeps the correct programme date, rather than implying the entire recorded addition began in 2014.

The separate 2024 functionality assessment examined selected villages and households. Among households with taps in that sample, 87% had received water during the previous week, 80% received at least 55 litres per person per day, and 76% met the combined functionality conditions. Those conditions concern quantity, quality and regularity.

Fifty-five litres covers daily household needs, not just drinking. For four people, that corresponds to 220 litres a day. A pipe supplying too little or unsafe water provides a different service from a dependable tap.

The assessment's 98.1% connection figure applies to its surveyed villages. It is not India's national coverage. Nor can we multiply the 2026 national connection percentage by the 2024 sample's functionality percentage and call the result a measured national rate for 2026.

Wider access is a substantial reported change. Its everyday value depends on whether water arrives when needed, meets quality standards and can be supplied reliably through changing seasons.

Connection coverage and the independent functionality sample answer different questions and refer to different years. Sources: 25, 26. Full references on pages 26-28.

16 / SANITATION

Building toilets changed access.

Using them and safely handling waste complete the job.

Measure and reporting method	Earlier -> later / cumulative total
Administrative rural sanitation coverage	About 39%, 2014 -> 100% declared coverage, 2019
Population using improved sanitation: NFHS, all India	48.5%, 2015-16 -> 70.2%, 2019-21
Rural SBM household toilets built	12.14 crore by June 2026; programme launched in 2014

The programme count shows a large construction effort. One household toilet can serve several people, so twelve crore toilets is not twelve crore people. The cumulative count is also not a survey of every facility's present use.

The 100% refers to reported rural coverage and 2019 open-defecation-free declarations under programme rules. Open defecation means going outside without a toilet. A declaration does not establish that every Indian has used a safe, maintained toilet ever since.

NFHS measures people in households using improved sanitation, across rural and urban India. Improved facilities separate waste from human contact under its definition; shared facilities are treated separately. This survey percentage cannot replace rural programme coverage. It rose by 21.7 percentage points from 2015-16 to 2019-21. The periods show changed living conditions, not a measurement for 2014 or October 2026.

A usable toilet needs water where the design requires it, privacy, maintenance and safe arrangements for waste. Emptying a pit or tank unsafely can move the health risk to workers or nearby land and water. Access, use and safe disposal are connected, but each needs its own evidence.

Sanitation programmes existed before Swachh Bharat. Zero under a new scheme only means that scheme had not begun. The comparison concerns expanded delivery and use, not the invention of toilets in 2014.

Programme coverage is rural. NFHS figures shown here are all India; they are not a like-for-like rural coverage series. Sources: 05, 27, 28. Full references on pages 26-28.

17 / HOMES

More homes completed.

Approvals and completed homes are different counts.

Public housing measure	Earlier -> later / stage of delivery
Rural annual completions	IAY: 10.83 lakh, 2013-14 -> PMAY-G: 26.57 lakh, 2025-26
PMAY-G, cumulative at 3 August 2026	3.91 crore sanctioned; 3.12 crore completed
PMAY-Urban and 2.0, August 2026	Over 1.25 crore sanctioned; over 1 crore completed/delivered

IAY means Indira Awaas Yojana, the earlier rural housing programme. PMAY-Gramin restructured support from 2016. The row compares annual programme completions, not all homes built; rules and reporting also differ. Annual completions are about 2.45 times the earlier count. A finished home may have been approved earlier. The 26.57 lakh count does not mean every house was approved, started and finished within twelve months.

The August reply lists 4.18 crore houses in allocated targets, 3.91 crore sanctioned and 3.12 crore completed. Targets assign work; sanctions approve it; completions record a later stage. The roughly 79 lakh gap between sanction and completion is not additional completed housing.

The urban milestone combines PMAY-U, launched in 2015, and PMAY-U 2.0, introduced in 2024. The release describes over one crore homes completed or delivered. This wording does not establish an independently surveyed count of homes occupied today.

These totals cover programmes, not the whole housing stock. Rural and urban schemes count homes under different arrangements. Private construction and older housing programmes also existed. Zero under a newly launched scheme is not zero homes in India.

A completed home becomes useful when it is safe and connected to essentials. Location, water, electricity, sanitation, transport and maintenance shape that experience. Construction counts explain one stage; they cannot settle every question about living conditions.

Cumulative totals cover multiple years. Sources: 29, 30, 31. Full references on pages 26-28.

18 / INTERNET

Internet use grew fast.

Subscriptions count connections; they do not count unique people.

Digital access or use measure	Earlier -> recent / broader total
Broadband subscriptions, excluding M2M in the recent total	6.1 crore, March 2014 -> 101.03 crore, August 2026
Broadband including machine connections	110.12 crore, August 2026; not the matched consumer comparison
Average wireless data per subscriber per month	61.66 MB, 2014 baseline -> 26.70 GB, January-March 2026

Broadband meets an official minimum speed definition. That threshold changed from 512 kilobits per second to 2 megabits per second over the period. Subscriptions expanded greatly, but the measurement did not stay completely unchanged.

A subscription is a connection or account under telecom reporting rules. One person may have two mobile connections and a home line. Several people may share one device. Therefore 101 crore broadband subscriptions does not mean 101 crore different Indians each have their own dependable internet.

M2M means machine-to-machine: connections for devices such as meters or trackers. TRAI includes about 9.09 crore in its broader August total. The main comparison excludes them from the recent total; the broader total is labelled separately.

Data use measures the amount transferred, not speed or quality. On the decimal convention, 1 GB is 1,000 MB. Moving from tens of MB to tens of GB marks very different use. The average does not describe every subscriber.

TRAI reports average operator revenue of about Rs 7.51 per GB in the March 2026 quarter. This is not the price of every customer's plan. Retail plans bundle amounts, validity and other services.

Living in a covered district does not remove weak signals, phone costs or difficulty using a service. The next page looks at household access and payments alongside the network totals.

August broadband data were released on 28 September 2026. The data-use observation is for the March 2026 quarter. Sources: 32, 33, 34. Full references on pages 26-28.

19 / USING DIGITAL SERVICES

Using the digital network.

Transactions, households and people are separate measures.

Indicator	Dated figure
Households with at least one smartphone	85.5%, January-March 2025 survey
Households with internet access within the premises	86.3%, same survey
UPI transactions in August 2026	2,450.90 crore transactions
Value transferred through UPI in August 2026	Rs 29.82 lakh crore

The survey asks whether access exists in the home. It does not say every member owns or controls a phone, or can complete digital tasks alone. Its percentages describe 2025, not October 2026.

Among people aged 15-29, the survey reports internet use during the previous three months by 92.7% in rural areas and 95.7% in urban areas. Those figures concern young people in the sample. They do not describe all ages or establish that everyone can use every online public service.

UPI, the Unified Payments Interface, allows payments between accounts through participating services. It began in 2016. A 2014 UPI total is therefore 'not yet launched', not evidence that electronic payments or banking transfers did not exist before 2014.

NPCI's August 2026 table records 24,508.96 million transactions. Ten million make one crore, so that is 2,450.896 crore transactions. Its value figure, Rs 29,82,355.95 crore, is about Rs 29.82 lakh crore. Count tells us how many payment transactions occurred; value tells us how much money those transactions moved.

The same money can move more than once. A payment from one person to a shop and a later payment from that shop to a supplier are both transfers. Adding the payment values does not measure newly created wealth, government spending or GDP.

A useful digital service needs a workable device, connectivity and a way to understand and complete the task. Someone who needs help should also be able to get it. More transactions show widespread use of the system; they do not prove that access is equally easy for every person.

UPI is a monthly flow, not a count of unique users. August 2026 was the latest monthly table verified for this volume. Sources: 35, 36. Full references on pages 26-28.

20 / THE MATRIX CHART, CHECKED

Keep the claim beside the source.

Original chart pairs first; the correction or update follows.

Original chart: before -> after	What the evidence supports here
Dedicated freight corridors: 0 -> 2,843 km	2,843 km reported commissioned in August 2026. Project preparation and DFCCIL began before 2014.
Solar: 2.6 -> 162 GW	MNRE: 2.822 GW in March 2014 -> 168.040 GW in August 2026. Use exact dates and series.
Inland cargo: 29 -> 218 MMT	Matched ministry table: about 18 MMT in 2013-14 -> 218.24 MMT in 2025-26. Annual cargo, not construction.
Expressways: 1,000 -> 6,700 km	That broad pair was not reproduced here. Defined national high-speed corridors: 93 km in 2014 -> 3,644 km, June 2026.
National Waterways: 5 -> 32	5 is an earlier designated count. Matched operational count: 3 -> 32. Legally designated waterways became 111.
Domestic PNG: 25 lakh -> 1.6 crore	Earlier 25-26 lakh is a PM statement. August 2026 stock: 1.74 crore. Connection count is distinct from billed use.
Rural taps: 17% -> 80%	16.72% is August 2019, not 2014. August 2026 update: 82.24%. Connections are distinct from functionality.
Renewables: 54 -> 248 GW	Use a consistent hydro rule. Inclusive retrospective baseline: 76.38 GW in 2014 -> 295.554 GW in August 2026.

The chart's percentages divide the increase by the later value. They are not the usual growth rate. For example, 250 becoming 1,000 means 75% of the later stock was added, while the stock grew by 300% from its starting level. Neither calculation alone proves how much entirely new infrastructure was physically built.

MMT means million metric tonnes. A missing matched pair is kept visible rather than filled with a guess. Sources: 02, 05, 08, 11, 12, 15, 17, 18, 22, 23, 24, 25. Full references on pages 26-28.

21 / THE MATRIX CHART, CONTINUED

Check what each total counts.

The remaining infrastructure rows, plus the scope of later parts.

Original chart: before -> after	What the evidence supports here
Metro: 250 -> 1,000 km	Official rounded baseline 248 km in 2014 -> 1,155 km in March 2026. Track length is distinct from journeys.
Port capacity: 800 -> 2,760 MTPA	Matched all-port table: 1,400 -> 2,818 MTPA, 2013-14 to 2025-26. Capacity is distinct from cargo handled.
Rail electrification: 21,800 -> 69,800 km	2026 retrospective pair: 21,801 -> 69,873 route km. Older summary gives 21,614 for 2013-14; source vintage matters.
Four-lane NH: 18,371 -> 45,516 km	June 2026 backgrounder supports this four-lane-and-above pair. Widening is distinct from a wholly new road.
Airports: 74 -> 164	July 2026 backgrounder reports 74 -> 165 operational airports. Airport presence is distinct from frequent affordable flights.
Installed power: 249 -> 540 GW	248.554 GW, March 2014 -> 554.544 GW, August 2026. Equipment capacity is distinct from electricity generated.
Gas pipelines: 15,000 -> 26,000 km	15,340 km in 2014 -> 27,427 operational km at December 2025. Authorised and planned lengths are not operational.
Transmission: 2.9 -> 5 lakh circuit km	About 2.91 lakh in 2014 -> over 5 lakh in January 2026, for 220 kV and above. Circuit km is distinct from route km.

The chart also lists startups (500 -> 2.30 lakh), defence exports (Rs 700 -> 38,424 crore), AIIMS (8 -> 23), MBBS seats (51,348 -> 1,39,000), medical colleges (387 -> 844), steel (109 -> 222 MT) and coal (565 -> 1,000 MT). These seven claims belong to Parts 3 and 4. They are recorded here, not certified by the infrastructure checks.

The rows above complete this volume's check of all 16 infrastructure claims. Dates, definitions and stages of delivery explain the differences; the full series will examine the remaining topics in their own context.

MTPA is annual handling capacity. MT here means million tonnes; the steel and coal claims still need their own definition checks. Sources: 02, 05, 08, 09, 14, 15, 16, 17, 20, 21, 22. Full references on pages 26-28.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

01 MisterLove / Lovepreet Singh

Public author profile and editorial theme

Accessed 2 October 2026. Byline and short biography.

02 The Matrix India

Infrastructure comparison supplied by the reader

4 August 2026 post. Its 23 rows are claims to check, not a primary data series.

03 Ministry of Road Transport and Highways

Expansion and Upgradation of National Highways

4 February 2026. NH length: March 2014 and the later reported network.

04 Ministry of Road Transport and Highways

Year End Review 2025

30 December 2025. Annual construction table; defined high-speed corridor series.

05 Press Information Bureau

Ease of Living: Infrastructure and Basic Services

15 June 2026 backgrounder. Roads, power, metro and sanitation snapshots.

06 Press Information Bureau

Infrastructure at the Core of India's Development

9 June 2026 backgrounder. Earlier rural roads; urban transit and waterways.

07 Ministry of Rural Development

Roads Constructed and Upgraded under PMGSY

31 July 2026. All programme phases; constructed versus sanctioned work.

08 Press Information Bureau / Railways

From Steam to Speed: The Journey of Railways

15 April 2026. Electrified route length and March 2026 broad-gauge coverage.

09 Indian Railways

Revised Statistical Summary, 2021-22

Historical 2013-14 column. Originating passengers and revenue-earning freight.

10 Ministry of Railways

Passenger Traffic and Cargo Transport, 2025-26

1 April 2026. Annual ministry release: 741 crore journeys and 1,670 million tonnes.

11 Ministry of Railways

Railway Infrastructure and Freight Connectivity

7 August 2026 parliamentary answer. DFC length and sanctioned rail projects.

12 Ministry of Railways / DFCCIL

Progress in Dedicated Freight Corridor

7 August 2015. Company registration in October 2006; project history.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

13 Prime Minister's Office

[Vadodara programme: DFC completion announcement](#)

8 September 2026. Speech reports completion of the last corridor links.

14 Press Information Bureau / Civil Aviation

[UDAN and Regional Air Connectivity](#)

Snapshot dated 15 July 2026. Operational airports and cumulative UDAN routes.

15 Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways

[Maritime India Vision 2030](#)

21 July 2026. Tables I-II: 2013-14 and 2025-26 capacity, cargo and waterways.

16 Ministry of Power

[Growth in Installed Power Capacity](#)

19 December 2023. Historical installed capacity of 248,554 MW in March 2014.

17 Central Electricity Authority

[Installed Capacity, August 2026](#)

31 August snapshot, released in September 2026. Page 1: national capacity and mix.

18 Ministry of New and Renewable Energy

[Year-wise Renewable Energy Achievements](#)

31 March 2014 baseline and 31 August 2026 cumulative solar and wind figures.

19 Ministry of Power / PIB

[Rural and Urban Electricity Supply](#)

23 March 2026 parliamentary reply: FY2015 and FY2025. Backgrounder: urban 2014 baseline.

[28 February 2026 backgrounder](#)

20 Ministry of Power

[Transmission Network Crosses 5 Lakh Circuit Km](#)

22 January 2026. Milestone reached on 14 January; lines at 220 kV and above.

21 Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas

[Year End Review 2024](#)

January 2025 release. Operational gas-pipeline baseline: 15,340 km in 2014.

22 Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board

[City Gas Distribution MIS, March 2026](#)

Page 2: PNG connections and billed connections. Pipeline figures are dated December 2025.

23 Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas

[Incentive Scheme for Domestic PNG Connections](#)

18 August 2026. Total connections and conversion of unbilled connections to use.

24 Prime Minister's Office

[Comparative Gas-Sector Figures](#)

12 March 2026 speech. Earlier domestic PNG reach: approximately 25-26 lakh homes.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

25 Ministry of Jal Shakti

[Jal Jeevan Mission: Seven Years of Progress](#)

14 August 2026. August 2019 baseline and later state-reported tap connections.

26 Ministry of Jal Shakti

[Tap Connections and Functionality Assessment](#)

30 March 2026. Independent 2024 assessment; quantity, quality and regularity.

27 Ministry of Jal Shakti

[Year End Review 2025: Swachh Bharat Mission](#)

1 January 2026. Rural ODF declarations and programme construction counts.

28 Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

[Health and Family Welfare Statistics in India 2023](#)

Table C.1, printed page 165. NFHS-4 (2015-16) and NFHS-5 (2019-21) sanitation.

29 Ministry of Rural Development

[Historical Rural Housing Completions](#)

30 January 2017. Table reports 10.83 lakh IAY houses completed in 2013-14.

30 Ministry of Rural Development

[Progress of PMAY-Gramin](#)

7 August 2026. Annual 2025-26 completions and cumulative status at 3 August.

31 Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs

[PMAY-Urban: One Crore Houses Delivered](#)

9 August 2026. Completion and delivery milestone; PMAY-U and PMAY-U 2.0.

32 Department of Telecommunications

[2025 Year End Review](#)

19 December 2025. March 2014 internet and broadband baselines; later coverage.

33 Telecom Regulatory Authority of India

[Telecom Subscription Data, August 2026](#)

28 September 2026. Broadband with and without machine connections. Page 1.

34 Telecom Regulatory Authority of India

[Telecom Performance Indicators, January-March 2026](#)

22 June 2026. Data use, revenue per GB and subscription definitions.

35 National Payments Corporation of India

[UPI Monthly Product Statistics](#)

August 2026 table, accessed 2 October 2026. Volumes in millions; value in crore.

[UPI launch timeline: April and August 2016](#)

36 Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

[Comprehensive Modular Survey: Telecom 2025](#)

29 May 2025 release. January-March survey; households and people are separate units.

A REPORT CARD IN PLAIN ENGLISH

India, before and after 2014

Health, learning and living standards

*What changed. What the numbers mean.
What still needs a closer look.*

PART THREE OF SIX

Written by Lovepreet Singh

misterlove.in / Research cut-off: 3 October 2026

A NOTE FROM THE AUTHOR

What progress feels like.

A longer life. An easier school day. A bill a family can pay.

A country can look successful in a chart and still feel difficult to live in. I wanted this part to ask about the things that reach inside a home: whether a baby survives, whether a mother gets care, whether a child can read, and whether there is enough money for ordinary needs.

I write on MisterLove because I like taking a complicated idea apart until it becomes clear. My interests in research, business and technology keep bringing me back to one question: what does a number actually tell us about a person's life? A bigger hospital count and a healthier population are related, but they are different things.

The Matrix India posts started this series. They made me want to put the earlier figure, the later figure and the original source on the same page. In this part I return to its AIIMS, medical-college and MBBS-seat rows, and then widen the picture to health, learning, poverty and living conditions.

I am using 2014 as a point of comparison, not pretending that the country's history began there. Many changes started earlier. The Union government, states, public workers, private institutions and families all helped shape the results. A before-and-after table alone cannot divide the credit between them.

I have kept the dates visible, including the awkward ones. If the latest report published in 2026 measures 2023-24, I say 2023-24. If a new blood-testing method interrupts an older series, I explain the break. I would rather give you an honest gap than a neat number that means something else.

You do not need to know the jargon. Read the figure, then the paragraph beneath it. That is where I explain what it counts, what changed and how to picture it in everyday life.

Lovepreet Singh
MisterLove

Sources: 01, 02. Full references on pages 29-32.

YOUR READING MAP

Where to begin.

Each topic stands on its own. The dates travel with the figures.

Pages	What you will find
4	How to read the dates, units and comparisons
5-9	Life expectancy, infant deaths, maternal care, fertility and vaccination
10-14	Health spending, insurance, medical seats, AIIMS and frontline care
15-17	Child nutrition, anaemia and food support
18-23	Schools, facilities, learning, college access, literacy and education costs
24-26	Money poverty, multidimensional poverty and household consumption
27-28	Cooking fuel and women's access to phones, banking and the internet
29-32	Numbered, clickable sources and reading notes

If you are short of time, start with pages 6, 15, 20 and 24. They ask four direct questions: are fewer babies dying, are children better nourished, can children read, and how many people remain below a poverty line? Each question needs its own measure.

Part 1 covered the economy. Part 2 covered physical infrastructure and services. This volume follows the people who use those systems. Parts 4-6 will cover production and industry, institutions and the environment, and state differences and international rankings.

The national figures here are a broad report card, not a complete census of every problem. Mental health, disability, every disease, every course and every local service need more evidence than fits in one volume. A missing row does not mean the issue disappeared.

The research cut-off is 3 October 2026. The newest observation differs by topic. Source numbers at the foot of each page take you to the reference section; a source title there opens the original publication.

Parts 1 and 2 are separate completed volumes. Parts 4-6 are still planned.

01 / READING THE NUMBERS

Dates first. Numbers second.

A report released today may describe life several years earlier.

Three dates can sit behind one figure: when people were surveyed, which period the question covered, and when the report was published. NFHS-6 was conducted in 2023-24 and released in May 2026. Some of its questions look back at births or care before the interview. Calling every result 'India in 2026' would hide that.

There was no national NFHS round taken exactly on the day the government changed in 2014. The available rounds include 2005-06, 2015-16, 2019-21 and 2023-24. Where I use 2005-06, the earlier figure is much older than 2014. Where I use 2015-16, it is already after 2014. Neither date has been relabelled.

A financial year runs from April to March. So 2013-14 ends in March 2014. School and college data use academic years. A three-year maternal-death estimate combines observations to make a rare event easier to measure reliably.

One lakh is 1,00,000. One crore is 1,00,00,000, or ten million. A rate per thousand compares equal-sized groups: 40 deaths per 1,000 births means four per hundred, not 40 per hundred. A percentage describes a share.

Moving from 40% to 60% is a rise of 20 percentage points. Relative to the starting 40%, it is a 50% increase. These are two different calculations. The Matrix chart's increase divided by the later total is a third calculation; it is not ordinary growth.

Counts, access and results belong on separate lines. A seat is a training place. A card is enrolment in a scheme. A hospital admission is an event. A lower death rate is an outcome. They help explain one another, but cannot replace one another.

Finally, a change after 2014 does not by itself prove a change caused by one government. These pages describe the measured change and the relevant programmes; they do not invent a precise share of political credit.

Sources: 04, 06, 07, 08, 09. Full references on pages 29-32.

02 / LENGTH OF LIFE

People are living longer.

Life expectancy is an estimate from death rates, not a promised age.

SRS life expectancy at birth	2009-13 -> 2020-24
All India, years	67.5 -> 70.6
Men / women, years	65.8 / 69.3 -> 68.7 / 72.8
Rural / urban, years	66.3 / 71.2 -> 69.4 / 73.2

The earlier five-year period ends before 2014. The later estimate uses 2020-24 mortality and was released in 2026. The national gain is 3.1 years. Another commonly quoted baseline, 67.9, belongs to 2010-14, a period that includes 2014. Changing the period changes the starting figure.

Life expectancy asks how long a newborn would live on average if the period's death rates at each age continued. It does not say everyone born then will die at 70.6. Many people live much longer; some die much younger. Fewer deaths in childhood can raise the average even without the same increase at every adult age.

The female estimate exceeds the male estimate by 4.1 years. The urban estimate exceeds the rural estimate by 3.8 years. National improvement therefore sits beside differences between groups. An average of 70.6 does not describe the conditions in every district.

The same report puts Kerala at 75.6 years and Chhattisgarh at 64.7 years in 2020-24. That 10.9-year gap is larger than the national gain across the two periods above. State comparisons receive fuller treatment in Part 6.

Longer life does not automatically mean more years in good health. Living with diabetes, disability or another long illness still affects everyday life. This indicator measures length of life, not freedom from illness.

The rolling national series moved from 70.0 in 2016-20 to 69.8 in 2017-21 before rising again. Overlapping five-year estimates smooth events, including the pandemic; they should not be read as separate annual measurements.

Statement 1 in the SRS life-table report supplies the matched historical and recent series. Sources: 03. Full references on pages 29-32.

03 / BABIES AND CHILDREN

Fewer babies are dying.

Keep the age limit and the denominator on the same line.

Mortality measure	Earlier -> recent
Infant: death before first birthday, per 1,000 live births	40 in 2013 -> 24 in 2024
Under five: per 1,000 live births	28 in 2024
Neonatal: first 28 days, per 1,000 live births	18 in 2024
Infant, rural / urban	27 / 17 in 2024

For equal groups of 1,000 live births, the infant rate fell from 40 to 24. That is 16 fewer deaths per 1,000 and a 40% reduction relative to the earlier rate. It is a comparison of rates, not an audited count of exactly sixteen babies saved in each real village.

The infant and under-five measures overlap. A baby who dies in the first month is included in the neonatal, infant and under-five rates. Adding 18, 24 and 28 would count some deaths more than once. They describe different age boundaries around the same problem.

Neonatal deaths make up roughly three quarters of the infant rate: 18 out of 24. This points attention to pregnancy care, delivery, early feeding and care for sick or premature newborns. It does not prove that one programme caused the whole decline.

In 2024 the rural infant rate was 27, while the urban rate was 17. A ten-per-thousand gap remains despite the national improvement. The national row can improve while some places continue to face much higher risk.

SRS means Sample Registration System. It estimates births and deaths from a large sample, using continuing recording and an independent survey. These rates are different from a hospital's tally or the number of deaths that reached an administrative reporting system.

Lower is better for these measures. But 24 per thousand still means a real risk before the first birthday. A lower national rate is progress, not a statement that every preventable death has been avoided.

The latest SRS observation used here is 2024, published in 2026. Current-only rows have no invented 2014 counterpart. Sources: 04, 05. Full references on pages 29-32.

04 / MOTHERS AND CARE

Childbirth has become safer.

Deaths and care coverage are separate measures of the change.

Indicator	Earlier -> recent
Maternal deaths per 1,00,000 live births	167 in 2011-13 -> 87 in 2022-24
Births in health facilities, NFHS	38.7% in 2005-06 -> 90.6% in 2023-24
At least four pregnancy-care visits, NFHS	51.2% in 2015-16 -> 65.2% in 2023-24

The maternal mortality ratio, or MMR, counts deaths related to pregnancy or its management, during pregnancy or within 42 days after it ends, for every one lakh live births. It excludes accidental or unrelated deaths. The ratio fell by 80 per lakh, about 48% relative to the 2011-13 level.

The periods combine three years because maternal deaths are relatively rare in a sample. For 2022-24, SRS gives a national uncertainty range of 78 to 95 around the central estimate of 87. A small movement from 88 in the previous overlapping period to 87 should not be treated as a precisely measured one-unit breakthrough.

Institutional delivery means giving birth in a health facility. The very old 2005-06 figure is shown honestly; it is not the situation immediately before 2014. Coverage was already 78.9% in 2015-16 and reached 88.6% in 2019-21 before the latest 90.6%.

Antenatal care means care during pregnancy. In NFHS-6, 76.2% received the first visit in the first three months, and 65.2% received at least four visits. Starting early and maintaining visits are different measures; four visits alone do not tell us whether all needed tests or treatment were provided.

A facility birth can help a woman reach trained staff and emergency care, but the building alone is not enough. Staff, blood, medicines, referral transport and treatment quality matter. Maternal mortality measures the outcome; the care figures describe parts of the route towards it.

Maternal-care percentages refer to the NFHS-defined birth and mother groups, not to all women in India. Sources: 05, 06, 07, 08, 09. Full references on pages 29-32.

05 / FAMILY SIZE

Families are having fewer children.

Fertility describes current birth patterns; population changes more slowly.

Measure and source	Dated comparison
Total fertility rate, SRS	2.3 in 2013 -> 1.9 in 2024
Rural / urban fertility, SRS	2.1 / 1.5 in 2024
Total fertility rate, NFHS	2.7 in 2005-06 -> 2.0 in 2023-24
Any contraceptive method, NFHS	53.5% in 2015-16 -> 69.1% in 2023-24

Total fertility rate, or TFR, is the number of children a woman would have if the current birth rates at each age continued through her reproductive years. It is not the actual number of children in every existing family. A rate of 1.9 is an average across different patterns.

SRS and NFHS both show lower fertility over time, but they are different surveys with different reference periods. Their latest estimates, 1.9 and 2.0, should stay in separate rows. Substituting one source for the other can create an artificial movement.

Around 2.1 is often called replacement-level fertility: roughly enough births for one generation to replace itself in a population with low mortality, without migration. Falling below that level does not make the population shrink immediately. Large younger generations can still produce many births even when each woman has fewer children.

The contraceptive row concerns currently married women aged 15-49 using any method. The NFHS-6 release puts it at 69.1%, compared with 66.7% in NFHS-5. It is not a measure of contraceptive use by all adults, nor does it establish that everyone can choose the method they want.

Education, child survival, income, later marriage and access to reproductive healthcare can all influence family size. The numbers describe the shift; they do not isolate a single cause. Supporting informed choice and care requires more than treating a lower fertility rate as a target on its own.

SRS 2013 is linked as a supplementary source under reference 05. The NFHS and SRS series are kept separate. Sources: 04, 05, 07, 08, 09. Full references on pages 29-32.

06 / VACCINES AND INFECTION

Protection reaches more children.

The newest vaccination percentage has a narrower comparison group.

Vaccination measure, age 12-23 months	Dated comparison
All basic vaccinations: card or mother's report	43.5% in 2005-06 -> 76.4% in 2019-21
Full vaccination: children with card-based information	83.8% in 2019-21 -> 87.1% in 2023-24
Rotavirus vaccination, latest NFHS comparison	36.4% in 2019-21 -> 85.4% in 2023-24

The first row is the older basic-vaccination indicator, using a vaccination record or information from the mother. The second is the card-based comparison highlighted in the NFHS-6 release. Reading 43.5, 76.4 and 87.1 as one unchanged series would mix the evidence used to classify children.

Basic vaccination in the older measure covers BCG, measles and the required doses of polio and DPT-containing vaccines. Receiving any one vaccine is a different, easier threshold than completing the full set. New vaccines such as rotavirus also have their own coverage measures.

The card-based improvement is 3.3 percentage points. It describes that comparison group, not a verified 87.1% coverage rate for every child regardless of documentation. Keeping the label attached avoids a stronger claim than the release supports.

Tuberculosis, or TB, remains another major infection. WHO's 2025 report estimates an incidence rate of 187 new and recurrent cases per lakh population in 2024. The March 2026 ministry summary reports a 21% reduction from 2015 to 2024. The baseline is 2015, already after the comparison year.

TB incidence estimates how many cases occur, including cases that may be missed. Notifications count cases reported to the system. Better detection can raise notifications even while the underlying disease rate falls. Vaccination coverage and TB incidence tell us about different infections; neither measures the whole burden of infectious disease.

The NFHS-6 publication uses the words based on vaccination cards. That qualifier is essential to the comparison. Sources: 07, 08, 09, 18. Full references on pages 29-32.

07 / PAYING FOR HEALTH

More public money for health.

The latest spending report describes 2022-23, not this year's budget.

National Health Accounts measure	2013-14 -> 2022-23
Government health spending, current rupees	Rs 1.30 lakh crore -> Rs 3.85 lakh crore
Government spending as a share of GDP, old series	1.15% -> 1.43%
Government share of total health spending	28.6% -> 43.7%
Direct household payments: share of total spending	64.2% -> 43.4%

Government health expenditure includes Union, state and relevant local spending, including capital investment. The nominal amount is almost three times the earlier level. Prices and population also rose, so tripling rupees does not mean tripling care for each person.

The GDP row compares the old denominator series retained in the report's historical table. For 2022-23 alone, the newly rebased GDP gives 1.48% instead of 1.43%. That change comes from the denominator, not from a second health-spending total. A consistent rebased historical comparison is not invented here.

Out-of-pocket expenditure is money households pay directly for care, medicines and related services, without reimbursement. Its share fell by 20.8 percentage points. Picture Rs 100 of all recorded health spending: direct household payments accounted for about Rs 64 earlier and Rs 43 later.

This does not mean every family's medical bill fell by one third. A national share can fall because other spending grows; some households can still face large bills. The latest 43.4% is also above the 39.4% recorded in 2021-22, so the recent path was not a continuous decline.

The NHA estimates were released in May 2026. They are expenditure accounts, assembled from several sources, not a fresh 2026 household survey. States contributed about 63.7% of government health spending in 2022-23; the national total is not Union spending alone.

GDP means the value of goods and services produced. The rebasing qualification prevents a false old-versus-new comparison. Sources: 11, 12. Full references on pages 29-32.

08 / INSURANCE AND TREATMENT

A wider financial safety net.

A household, a card and an admission are three different counts.

Measure	Dated figure
Households with at least one member covered by health insurance or a financing scheme, NFHS	28.7% in 2015-16 -> 60.2% in 2023-24
PM-JAY cards issued, cumulative	Over 45.5 crore, 12 August 2026
PM-JAY hospitalisations covered, cumulative	12.69 crore, 30 June 2026

The household survey row includes different health insurance and financing arrangements. It asks whether at least one member is covered. A covered household does not necessarily mean every member has the same benefit or that every health expense is paid.

Ayushman Bharat-PMJAY began in 2018. It provides a hospital-treatment benefit of up to Rs 5 lakh per eligible family per year, under the scheme's rules. The extension covers senior citizens aged 70 and above. Coverage is not cash handed to every family, and the ceiling is not a promise to pay every kind of medical cost.

The latest backgrounder counts over 45.5 crore cards. These are cards issued to people, not 45.5 crore families. Hospitalisations count treatment events: one person admitted twice may contribute two events. Neither count is the number of unique people made healthy.

The backgrounder lists 38,466 empanelled public and private hospitals and Rs 1.92 lakh crore of covered hospitalisations by June 2026. Empanelment means participation in the network; it does not establish that every hospital offers every covered treatment nearby.

Insurance can reduce the shock of a hospital bill. Routine medicines, travel, lost wages and care outside the covered arrangements can still cost a family money. The spending accounts on the previous page help show why broader enrolment does not mean direct household spending has disappeared.

Public insurance and health services existed before PM-JAY. 'Not launched' in 2014 is the correct entry for this particular scheme, not zero health protection before 2014.

Sources: 07, 08, 09, 13. Full references on pages 29-32.

09 / MEDICAL EDUCATION

More places to train doctors.

The Matrix chart is close to a newer official count, with dates missing.

Official retrospective comparison	Before 2014 -> 7 August 2026
Medical colleges	387 -> 846
MBBS seats	51,348 -> 1,39,864
Postgraduate medical seats	31,185 -> 86,360

The ministry's August 2026 reply supports these pairs. Medical colleges rose by about 119%, MBBS seats by 172%, and postgraduate seats by 177%. An MBBS seat is an annual undergraduate training place. A postgraduate seat is a place for further medical training; neither is a doctor already practising today.

The Matrix chart says 387 to 844 colleges and 51,348 to 1,39,000 MBBS seats. The newer reply gives 846 and 1,39,864. The broad scale is supported by this dated source, but the chart's later totals should be updated rather than presented as the latest exact counts.

An older 2025-26 academic-year snapshot in the August healthcare backgrounder lists 818 colleges and 1,28,976 MBBS seats. That older snapshot cannot be used to reject the newer 1,39,000-scale claim automatically. Reporting dates and academic-year vintages explain why the official publications can show different totals.

The reply includes government and private medical-education expansion. It does not say all of the colleges are new public institutions paid for by the Union government. Some new colleges upgrade existing district or referral hospitals; their existing services should not be counted as if nothing was there before.

A larger intake matters, but teaching quality, clinical exposure, fees, graduation and the place where doctors later work also matter. National training capacity can rise while a rural facility still lacks a specialist. The next pages distinguish project expansion from functioning care.

The August reply calls the baseline before 2014 and the later count at present. A more exact baseline date is not added here. Sources: 02, 13, 14. Full references on pages 29-32.

10 / AIIMS, STAGE BY STAGE

Twenty-three is a project total.

Approved campuses are not all complete hospital systems.

PMSSY status of the 22 new AIIMS	16 September 2026 dashboard
Fully functional	6
MBBS classes plus outpatient and inpatient services	12
Only MBBS classes running	1: Madurai
Other AIIMS, still being developed	3: Awantipora, Rewari, Darbhanga

AIIMS means All India Institute of Medical Sciences. Add the original Delhi institute to these 22 new projects and the headline total becomes 23. But the official dashboard puts only six of the new campuses in its fully functional category. The other categories describe different stages of opening.

The Matrix chart's eight-to-twenty-three pair can describe a broader project count. Before 2014 there was Delhi, six new AIIMS that the ministry says had become partly functional, and the Raebareli project approved in 2009. Counting all eight does not mean eight equally complete hospitals were treating patients.

Outpatient care means a patient visits without being admitted overnight. Inpatient care means admission. A campus can start classes or open these services while still expanding beds, departments or buildings. That is real activity, but it is not identical to a completed campus with its full planned range.

The newer projects broaden the geographical spread of specialist institutions. The six earlier projects also continued developing after 2014. Their approval, construction and fuller operation cross political periods, so a one-line count cannot assign all work to the date of inauguration.

For a person seeking care, the useful details are which services work, how far away they are, whether staff and equipment are available, and how long treatment takes. The 23 headline explains scale. The stage-by-stage table explains how much of that scale has reached different forms of operation.

The dashboard covers new AIIMS under PMSSY and excludes the original Delhi institute. Its categories are reproduced separately. Sources: 02, 15, 16. Full references on pages 29-32.

11 / FRONTLINE HEALTHCARE

Care needs people and supplies.

A nearby centre becomes useful through the services it can deliver.

Latest service or assessment snapshot	What it counts
Over 1.86 lakh Ayushman Arogya Mandirs, August 2026	Primary-care centres reported functional
100% of public facilities assessed, June 2026 reply	Completion of a self-assessment process
64% scored above 50% against IPHS	Threshold in that assessment; not full compliance

Primary care covers prevention, basic treatment, follow-up and referral. Ayushman Arogya Mandirs developed from the health-and-wellness-centre programme, often strengthening existing facilities. The total does not mean 1.86 lakh completely new hospitals were built since 2014.

Indian Public Health Standards, or IPHS, cover facilities, staff, equipment, medicines and services. The August reply reports completed self-assessments, with 64% scoring above half the requirements. Completing an assessment does not mean meeting every standard.

The self-reported assessment helps find gaps. It does not show that 64% of centres have everything they need. A matched pre-2014 result for this same assessment is not supplied, so none is invented.

A doctor, nurse or technician must be present when the service is needed. Essential drugs must be in stock, tests must be usable, and serious cases must reach a facility able to treat them. Adding a building or a sanctioned post does not automatically add all of those pieces.

States recruit staff and deliver services, with support through the National Health Mission and other programmes. College expansion can increase the trained workforce, while hiring and deployment depend on local decisions.

The backgrounder also counts over 540 crore visits over time. Visits are repeated contacts, not 540 crore different patients. Activity and care quality need separate measures.

These are administrative and self-assessment snapshots, not an independently observed 2026 household access rate. Sources: 13, 17. Full references on pages 29-32.

12 / CHILD NUTRITION

Nutrition improved unevenly.

Height, weight and feeding habits answer different questions.

Children under five: NFHS measure	2005-06 / 2019-21 / 2023-24
Stunting: low height for age	48.0% / 35.5% / 29.3%
Underweight: low weight for age	42.5% / 32.1% / 31.8%
Severe wasting: very low weight for height	6.4% / 7.7% / 5.2%

The old round is 2005-06, not 2014. It provides a genuine earlier observation, but the long interval includes years on both sides of 2014. The intermediate round matters too: it shows that different problems did not move together.

Stunting means a child is unusually short for their age against the WHO growth standard. It is associated with longer-term disadvantage in nutrition, health and care. Wasting means a child is unusually thin for their height. Underweight means unusually low weight for age and can reflect both problems.

For stunting and underweight, the survey threshold is more than two standard deviations below the reference median. In plain language, it is a defined low end of the expected growth range. Severe wasting uses the more extreme three-deviation threshold. These are measured classifications, not a judgement made by looking at a child.

Between the last two rounds, stunting fell by 6.2 percentage points and severe wasting by 2.5 points. Underweight fell by only 0.3 points. Describing all three as equally large improvements would hide the weaker movement in underweight.

The latest stunting result is about 29 children in every hundred, and underweight about 32. A child can fall in more than one category; adding the percentages does not give the number of children with any nutrition problem.

Feeding also changed: children aged 6-8 months receiving solid or semi-solid food along with breastmilk rose from 45.9% to 59.5%. The release's 95.6% breastfeeding figure for babies under six months describes any breastfeeding, not exclusive breastfeeding.

The severe-wasting row is not the rate of all wasting. All figures concern children in the survey-defined age group. Sources: 07, 08, 09. Full references on pages 29-32.

13 / ANAEMIA AND ADULT HEALTH

Some problems became worse.

An older result remains older, even when the new report omits it.

NFHS measure	2015-16 -> 2019-21
Anaemia, children aged 6-59 months	58.6% -> 67.1%
Anaemia, women aged 15-49	53.1% -> 57.0%
Overweight or obesity, women aged 15-49	20.6% -> 24.0%

Anaemia means too little haemoglobin, the blood protein that carries oxygen, under the survey's age- and pregnancy-specific thresholds. Iron deficiency is one cause; infection, other nutrient shortages and inherited conditions can also contribute. The figure is not simply the percentage of people who did not eat enough iron.

The comparison showed anaemia rising among children and women, by 8.5 percentage points for children. It describes 2019-21, not October 2026, and cannot tell us whether prevalence has since risen or fallen.

The August 2026 ministry reply explains why NFHS-6 does not provide a new directly comparable anaemia headline: the ministry plans to use an independent ICMR survey with a venous blood-testing method. The older NFHS estimates used capillary blood. A change in the test method can affect the result even without the same change in people's health.

No replacement national result is inserted here without a verified release. Its absence is not evidence that anaemia improved. When the new result becomes available, the sample, thresholds and testing method need to be checked before making an old-to-new claim.

Nutrition also includes excess weight. The older comparable women's overweight-or-obesity indicator rose to 24.0%. It uses body mass index of at least 25 and the survey's pregnancy and recent-birth exclusions. It is a screening measure, not a diagnosis of every individual's health.

Under-nutrition, anaemia and excess weight can exist in the same country or family. More food or higher spending alone does not guarantee a balanced diet or better health.

The figures are deliberately dated 2019-21. They are not presented as new NFHS-6 results. Sources: 07, 08, 10. Full references on pages 29-32.

14 / FOOD SUPPORT

Food support changed its price.

The right to subsidised grain existed before 2014.

Public-distribution measure	Earlier rule -> recent rule
NFSA grain issue prices	2013: rice Rs 3, wheat Rs 2, coarse grain Rs 1 per kg -> free from 2023
Priority household entitlement	5 kg per eligible person each month
Antyodaya household entitlement	35 kg per eligible household each month
NFSA maximum coverage	81.35 crore persons, based on Census 2011

The National Food Security Act, or NFSA, became law in 2013, building on an older ration system. Calling the earlier provision zero would erase existing support. The later change made the regular grain entitlement free.

Free distribution began in January 2023, with continuation for five years from January 2024, through 2028. It uses the PM Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana name; the pandemic's additional grain entitlement was a different arrangement.

Priority households receive an entitlement per person. Antyodaya Anna Yojana, or AAY, covers the poorest eligible households and has an entitlement per household. A four-person priority household is entitled to 20 kg; an AAY household's entitlement is 35 kg. Mixing people and households creates the wrong total.

The 81.35 crore figure is a coverage ceiling based on the 2011 population, not the number of people currently below a World Bank poverty line. The 2024-25 annual report records about 80.67 crore people covered at its report date. Neither number establishes that every listed person collected the full ration every month.

Grain support can reduce hunger and free some money for other needs. Cereals alone do not provide every nutrient needed by children or adults. Nutrition results on the previous pages remain relevant even where ration coverage is broad.

Eligibility, the ability to collect grain, quantity and quality all affect delivery. A legal entitlement does not establish that it was received.

The ceiling, reported enrolment and actual grain collection must be kept separate. Figures here do not estimate the current poverty rate. Sources: 19, 20. Full references on pages 29-32.

15 / SCHOOL PARTICIPATION

Most children enter school.

Staying through the later years is a different challenge.

Rural schooling measure, ASER	Earlier -> recent
Children aged 6-14 enrolled	96.7% in 2014 -> 98.1% in 2024
Boys aged 15-16 not in school	15.9% in 2014 -> 7.7% in 2024
Girls aged 15-16 not in school	17.4% in 2014 -> 8.1% in 2024

ASER visits households in rural India. Its enrolment question includes children in different school types, and its out-of-school group includes those who never enrolled and those who left. These results do not cover urban India. The 2014 survey was taken after the change of government, so it is a near-2014 starting point, not a strictly before-2014 observation.

Enrolment among younger children was already high. It rose by 1.4 percentage points across the decade, while out-of-school rates among 15-16-year-olds roughly halved. This helps explain why entering school and continuing later need separate lines.

UDISE+ 2025-26 covers 14.67 lakh schools, 24.72 crore students and about 1.03 crore teachers: institution-reported stocks, not ASER household estimates. A smaller student count would not automatically mean more dropouts; cohort size, reporting coverage and duplicate removal also matter.

In the NEP structure, middle school is Classes VI-VIII and secondary is IX-XII. The latest gross enrolment ratios are 89.6% and 71.7%. Gross enrolment divides all students in a stage by its expected-age population, including some younger or older students.

The new IX-XII stage cannot be compared directly with an old IX-X ratio. Its 51.9% retention rate measures progress through a school sequence; it does not mean 48.1% left in one year.

Using the same NEP stages, annual secondary dropout fell from 8.2% in 2024-25 to 7.0% in 2025-26. Middle-stage dropout moved from 3.5% to 3.6%. Progress therefore varied by stage.

The latest ASER basic national rural observations verified here are for 2024. UDISE+ observations use academic year 2025-26. Sources: 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27. Full references on pages 29-32.

16 / SCHOOL FACILITIES

More schools have basic facilities.

A reported facility still needs to be usable every day.

Schools with the facility, UDISE+	2022-23 -> 2025-26
Electricity	91.7% -> 95.0%
Girls' toilets	97.0% -> 98.5%
Computer access	47.7% -> 69.9%
Internet	49.7% -> 67.4%
Ramps with handrails	51.0% -> 58.2%

This is a recent comparison using the same release's table. It is not relabelled as 2014 versus 2026. The biggest increases here concern computers and internet; both still fall well short of universal coverage.

For a group of a hundred schools, the reported computer-access share rose by about 22 schools and the internet share by about 18. These are percentage-point changes. They do not mean each school gained the same number of devices or every student can use them regularly.

The report also records drinking-water facilities in 99.5% of schools and handwashing facilities in 96.9%. A national entry for a facility's presence is not a continuous check of water quality, supply, maintenance or whether children can use it when needed.

Ramps with handrails reached 58.2%. That measure describes one accessibility feature, not complete access for every child with a disability. Entrances, classroom space, toilets, learning materials and support can still affect participation.

Teacher distribution matters alongside the buildings. The national report counts 1,00,843 single-teacher schools in 2025-26, down from 1,18,190 in 2022-23. It also records 5,663 schools with zero enrolment. A large total teacher workforce does not remove these local gaps.

National ratios can improve while a school still has a missing teacher or broken toilet. Reported resources do not establish teaching quality or successful learning.

The matched table begins in 2022-23. It avoids mixing older school categories or coverage rules with newer ones. Sources: 21, 23. Full references on pages 29-32.

17 / LEARNING TO READ

Enrolment is not learning.

ASER uses simple tasks to check what children can actually do.

Rural learning task	2014 / 2018 / 2022 / 2024
Class III can read Class II text	23.6% / 27.3% / 20.5% / 27.1%
Class V can read Class II text	48.0% / 50.5% / 42.8% / 48.8%
Class III can do subtraction	25.4% / 28.2% / 25.9% / 33.7%
Class V can do division	26.1% / 27.9% / 25.6% / 30.7%

These are the report card's combined government-and-private-school trend figures. Class III means the third school year. The reading task uses a short text pitched at Class II level. Passing it establishes that task, not complete mastery of every part of the child's course.

The intermediate years matter. Reading results were lower in 2022, after the disruption of the pandemic, and recovered in 2024. Class V reading reached 48.8%, slightly above 2014 but below 2018's 50.5%. Saying learning simply rose steadily over the decade would hide that path.

For Class V, 48.8% means just under half could read the lower-grade text in this combined group. More than half could not complete that task at the required level. This does not mean they could read nothing, nor is it a label for their intelligence. It identifies a learning need.

Arithmetic improved more over the two endpoints. Class III subtraction rose by 8.3 percentage points and Class V division by 4.6 points. The reading and arithmetic results should stay separate: improvement in one does not prove the same improvement in the other.

ASER assesses children at home, so it can reach enrolled children absent from school that day. It covers rural India and uses basic tasks, not a national board examination. Its results should not be presented as an urban-and-rural national pass rate.

Income, language, prior learning and school choice also affect results. A public-private gap alone cannot prove that school type caused it.

Some all-children tables differ slightly from the combined government/private trend because their covered school groups differ. Sources: 24, 25, 26, 27. Full references on pages 29-32.

18 / COLLEGE ACCESS

More access to college.

The latest national college survey measures 2023-24.

AISHE measure	2014-15 -> 2023-24
Students enrolled	3.42 crore -> 4.50 crore
Women enrolled	1.57 crore -> 2.24 crore
Gross enrolment ratio, all students	23.7% -> 30.0%
Gross enrolment ratio, women	22.9% -> 31.2%

AISHE is the All India Survey on Higher Education. The July 2026 release measures 2023-24. Its comparison starts in 2014-15, already after 2014. Enrolment grew by about 1.08 crore, or 31.5%. This is a student stock, not graduates added in one year.

Gross enrolment ratio, or GER, divides all enrolled students by the estimated population aged 18-23. Some students are older or younger. Therefore 30% GER does not mean exactly 30% of 18-23-year-olds attend college.

Women's enrolment grew faster than the total over this period. A female GER of 31.2% exceeds the male GER, giving a gender-parity index above one. This describes participation relative to the respective age populations. It does not mean women already have equal representation in every course, senior academic post or later job.

The latest GER is 27.8% for Scheduled Castes and 22.8% for Scheduled Tribes, compared with 30% overall. Their earlier ratios were 18.9% and 13.5%. Access expanded, but the group differences remain; a larger overall student count cannot erase them.

Institutions voluntarily upload data to AISHE. The report describes validation and estimation, and warns that appearance in its list does not itself confer recognition. Enrolment also does not establish teaching quality, course completion or employment.

Expansion needs teachers, usable facilities, affordable courses and support to finish. The survey counts participation; learning and later use of qualifications need separate evidence.

AISHE GER uses the official projected 18-23 population; the report's method and response coverage remain relevant. Sources: 28, 29. Full references on pages 29-32.

19 / LITERACY

More people can read and write.

The recent figure is a survey estimate, not a new census count.

Literate, age seven and above	2011 Census -> 2025 PLFS
All India	73.0% -> 81.1%
Men	80.9% -> 87.5%
Women	64.6% -> 74.9%
Recent rural / urban shares	77.4% / 89.0% in 2025

Literate means able to read and write with understanding in at least one language. It does not require a college degree, fluent English or completion of a particular school year. The table uses people aged seven and above; including younger children would change the denominator.

The earlier result is the final 2011 census figure, not a 2014 measurement. The often-repeated 74.04% belongs to the provisional 2011 result. Using the final 73.0% consistently avoids quietly switching the historical series.

The recent result comes from the 2025 Periodic Labour Force Survey, whose annual report was published in 2026. It estimates literacy from a household sample. Comparing a census with a sample survey gives useful context, but is not a perfectly unchanged measurement system.

The difference between these endpoints is 8.1 percentage points. In the recent survey, men's literacy exceeds women's by 12.6 points, and urban literacy exceeds rural literacy by 11.6 points. Progress and remaining gaps can be true at the same time.

PLFS was redesigned for 2025, including changes to sampling and visits. A small change from an older PLFS annual figure should not be treated as a precise year-to-year gain without checking the design. The latest 81.1% is dated openly rather than replacing it with the older 80.9% commonly quoted for 2023-24.

Reading a medicine label, understanding a form or spotting an online scam needs further skills. Basic literacy alone does not measure these. Adults learning later in life also deserve clear information.

PLFS 2025, Appendix Table 7, rural plus urban: age seven and above. Cross-source differences require care. Sources: 30, 31. Full references on pages 29-32.

20 / EDUCATION AND MONEY

Budgets and family costs differ.

More budgeted rupees do not automatically buy proportionately more learning.

Education finance measure	Dated comparison or snapshot
Union HRD / Education Ministry budget allocation	Rs 65,867 crore, 2013-14 -> Rs 1,39,289.48 crore, 2026-27
Household spending per enrolled school student, CMS 2025	Government school: Rs 2,863; non-government: Rs 25,002

The first row compares the ministry allocations announced in the two Union budgets. The nominal amount is about 2.11 times the earlier amount. It is a budget estimate for the year, not final money spent, and not the whole country's education expenditure.

States finance much of schooling. Other ministries also spend on education-related activities. A claim about total public spending as a share of GDP needs a combined, consistently defined series. Dividing the Education Ministry's allocation alone by GDP would answer a narrower question.

Prices, student numbers, salaries and the range of funded work changed between the two years. The 111% nominal rise does not establish a 111% rise in real resources per child. Actual expenditure and what it delivers must be checked separately.

The second row comes from households interviewed in April-June 2025. It estimates school-education spending per enrolled student during the current academic year under the survey's rules. It is not the government's cost per student or a fee that every family is charged.

The non-government category combines different school arrangements; it is broader than private unaided schools alone. Different student backgrounds and school levels contribute to the average. This cost gap therefore cannot be treated as a clean price comparison for two otherwise identical schools.

The same survey puts 55.9% of enrolled school students in government schools, including 66.0% in rural areas and 30.1% in urban areas. Public provision remains central to access. A family's decision also depends on distance, teaching, language, fees and the cost of staying in school.

The budget row is in current rupees and compares announced ministry allocations. The household row is a separate 2025 survey. Sources: 32, 33, 40. Full references on pages 29-32.

21 / MONEY POVERTY

Poverty fell. The line matters.

Use the same poverty line and price basis at both ends.

World Bank poverty line, 2021 PPP	2011-12 -> 2023-24
Extreme poverty: below \$3.00 per person per day	27.1% -> 2.6%
Lower-middle-income line: below \$4.20 per day	57.7% -> 16.1%
Recent \$4.20 poverty, rural / urban	19.3% / 8.6%

The April 2026 India Development Update gives these estimates using the 2011-12 consumption survey and HCES 2023-24. The observation dates are not 2014 and 2026. Under the lower line, the share fell by 24.5 percentage points; under the higher line, by 41.6 points.

PPP means purchasing power parity: an adjustment for what money buys across countries. The dollar figure is a common purchasing-power unit. Multiplying \$3 by today's rupee-dollar exchange rate would produce the wrong Indian threshold.

The lower threshold counts extreme deprivation. Crossing it does not mean a household can comfortably pay rent, healthcare, education or an unexpected bill. At the \$4.20 threshold, the report still estimates about 23.2 crore people below the line, compared with about 3.5 crore below \$3.

The World Bank revised its international lines in 2025 using 2021 PPP. Old headlines using \$2.15 and 2017 PPP cannot be put beside these figures as if the threshold never changed. A changed poverty line can alter the percentage without the same change in people's lives.

Indian consumption surveys also changed their questionnaires, visits and the periods people were asked to remember. The Bank constructs a welfare measure from food and non-food spending. Comparability involves statistical choices; it is not just counting bank balances.

The decline is meaningful under the stated method. It does not identify one cause or prove every family is secure. Poverty measures and food-support eligibility count different things.

This is the World Bank monetary-consumption measure. It is separate from India's older national poverty line and from MPI. Sources: 34, 37. Full references on pages 29-32.

22 / POVERTY BEYOND MONEY

A second way to measure hardship.

Some widely quoted before-and-after figures are projections.

National multidimensional poverty	Earlier -> later / evidence
Direct NFHS-based comparison	24.85%, 2015-16 -> 14.96%, 2019-21
Estimated endpoints in the 2024 discussion paper	29.17%, 2013-14 -> 11.28%, 2022-23
Estimated number leaving poverty in the latter period	24.82 crore; model-based comparison

Multidimensional poverty asks about several disadvantages together. NITI Aayog's national index uses twelve indicators across health, education and living standards. They include nutrition, child mortality, maternal care, schooling, fuel, sanitation, water, electricity, housing, assets and banking.

Each indicator has a rule for deprivation and a weight. People in a household are counted as multidimensionally poor when its weighted deprivation score reaches at least one third. This is not the share with any single problem, and it is not an income threshold.

The direct comparison comes from two surveys. It records a fall of 9.89 percentage points and an estimated 13.5 crore people leaving multidimensional poverty between 2015-16 and 2019-21. These are sampled household conditions, not the endpoints of the government's term.

The popular 2013-14-to-2022-23 pair uses extrapolation because surveys were not taken at those endpoints. The paper applies earlier rates of reduction to estimate the missing years. Its 24.82 crore figure is therefore an estimate under that method, not a direct survey count of people interviewed in those two years.

NFHS-6 was released in 2026. A new, comparable national MPI from it was not verified for this volume. The 2024 projection remains separate from the newer survey.

Money poverty and MPI can move at different speeds because they measure different things. A household can gain electricity or schooling and still have little money left after paying essentials. Reading both measures helps show why one poverty percentage cannot describe every kind of hardship.

The first row is survey-based. The second and third rows are estimated endpoints, not direct NFHS measurements. Sources: 09, 10, 35, 36. Full references on pages 29-32.

23 / HOUSEHOLD LIVING STANDARDS

Households spend more on average.

Separate the rise in prices from the rise in real consumption.

Monthly consumption per person, no free-item imputation	2011-12 -> 2023-24
Rural, current rupees	Rs 1,430 -> Rs 4,122
Urban, current rupees	Rs 2,630 -> Rs 6,996
Rural, constant 2011-12 prices	Rs 1,430 -> Rs 2,079
Urban, constant 2011-12 prices	Rs 2,630 -> Rs 3,632

Monthly per capita consumption expenditure, or MPCE, spreads a household's recorded consumption across its members. It includes more than wages spent that month. It is not salary, take-home income, savings or money left after bills.

At current prices, the rural average is about 2.88 times the earlier figure. At constant prices, the rise is about 45%. For urban areas, the corresponding real increase is about 38%. Removing the price rise makes the change in purchasing power easier to see.

The figures exclude the estimated value assigned to selected free benefits. Including those items gives a higher recent total: Rs 4,247 rural and Rs 7,078 urban. Both treatments can be useful, but switching between them in one comparison would change what is counted.

The survey's consumption Gini fell from 0.283 to 0.237 in rural areas and from 0.363 to 0.284 in urban areas between 2011-12 and 2023-24. A Gini nearer zero means consumption is more evenly spread under this measure. It is not a measure of land, total wealth or all income.

The average can rise while some households struggle. It is not the middle household's result, and very wealthy households are difficult to capture fully in household surveys. Lower consumption inequality does not establish that every form of inequality fell.

The survey design also changed between the rounds. These are the published comparisons, with that limitation kept visible. They offer evidence about material living standards; they cannot settle healthcare quality, debt pressure, unpaid work or access to good education on their own.

Constant-price figures use the report's 2011-12-price treatment. The survey period is 2023-24, not 2026. Sources: 37, 38. Full references on pages 29-32.

More homes can access LPG.

A connection and regular clean cooking are different achievements.

Cooking-fuel measure	Dated comparison
LPG consumer accounts, ministry backgrounder	14.51 crore in 2014 -> 33.39 crore in 2026
Households using clean cooking fuel, NFHS	43.8% in 2015-16 -> 58.6% in 2019-21
Average annual PMUY refill use	3.68 in 2021-22 -> 4.71 in 2025-26

LPG means liquefied petroleum gas, supplied mainly through cylinders. Consumer accounts describe the supply network. They do not prove that every account is actively used or every family cooks exclusively with LPG.

Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana, or PMUY, began in 2016 to provide deposit-free connections to eligible women from poor households. Zero PMUY connections in 2014 means this scheme did not yet exist. It does not mean there were no LPG connections or earlier fuel programmes.

NFHS asks about household cooking fuel. Its clean category includes electricity, LPG or natural gas, and biogas. The 58.6% figure describes 2019-21, not 2026, and is a different measure from the current account count. A newer matching household-use percentage is not invented from the connections.

The refill average rose to 4.71 in 2025-26 for PMUY consumers. This is annual use under the programme's reporting, not 4.71 cylinders for every family. Family size, meals cooked, sharing and use of other fuels differ. The average alone does not establish exclusive LPG cooking.

The backgrounder also reports LPG coverage above 100% relative to its estimated household denominator. This administrative ratio can exceed a hundred because connections and household estimates are different counts. It cannot mean more than 100% of real households use clean fuel.

Water, sanitation, electricity and safe housing, covered in Part 2, also affect daily living. Their usefulness depends on regular supply, affordability and maintenance after the first connection or completion.

The newer refill result is FY2025-26. The NFHS clean-fuel observation is deliberately retained with its older date. Sources: 07, 08, 39. Full references on pages 29-32.

25 / WOMEN AND EVERYDAY ACCESS

More women have useful access.

Having a tool and being able to control it are related, but not identical.

Women aged 15-49, NFHS

Earlier -> 2023-24

Bank or savings account they themselves use	53.0%, 2015-16 -> 89.0%
Mobile phone they themselves use	45.9%, 2015-16 -> 63.6%
Ever used the internet	33.3%, 2019-21 -> 64.3%

These indicators concern the women interviewed in the survey's age range, not every woman of every age. The earlier account and phone observations are from 2015-16; the internet baseline is 2019-21. None is silently moved back to 2014.

An account that a woman says she herself uses is a stronger measure than a bank's total number of opened accounts. It still does not tell us the balance, frequency of transactions or whether she can make every financial decision independently.

The bank-account measure rose by 36 percentage points, while the own-phone measure rose by 17.7 points. A household may have a smartphone that a woman cannot use whenever she needs it. Household access and personal access can therefore show different results.

Ever using the internet is a broad threshold. Trying it once qualifies; it does not establish daily use, a reliable connection, the skill to complete a form or control over a device. Its rise from 33.3% to 64.3% is substantial, but should not be described as universal digital independence.

Accounts and phones can help with payments, information, work and contact with services. The survey does not by itself establish that each woman gained all of these benefits or that every barrier disappeared. Affordability, confidence, language, safety and decision-making also shape what access becomes.

The figures throughout this part are national averages. They describe meaningful change while leaving differences between states, income groups, rural and urban areas, ages and communities visible. Part 6 will examine those differences more closely; the next volume turns to farming, industry, science, space and defence.

Sources were checked through 3 October 2026. Each observation keeps its own survey year; later volumes remain planned. Sources: 07, 08, 09. Full references on pages 29-32.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

01 MisterLove / Lovepreet Singh

Public author profile and editorial theme

Accessed 2 October 2026. Byline and public biography; no invented personal experiences.

02 The Matrix India

Infrastructure comparison supplied by the reader

4 August 2026 post. AllMS, medical-college and MBBS-seat rows are checked in this volume.

03 Registrar General of India

SRS Abridged Life Tables, 2020-2024

Released May 2026. Statement 1 includes the historical national series and rural-urban figures.

04 Registrar General of India

SRS Statistical Report, 2024

Released May 2026. National fertility and mortality indicators; annual observation is 2024.

05 Health Ministry / Registrar General of India

Steps Taken to Reduce IMR and MMR

27 February 2015. Explicitly identifies IMR 40 in 2013 and MMR 167 in 2011-13.

SRS Statistical Report, 2013: fertility baseline

06 Registrar General of India

Special Bulletin on Maternal Mortality, 2022-2024

May 2026. National MMR 87, state estimates and uncertainty intervals.

07 IIPS / Health Ministry / DHS Program

National Family Health Survey 4: India report

Survey 2015-16. Full report, including comparisons with NFHS-3, 2005-06.

08 IIPS / Health Ministry / DHS Program

National Family Health Survey 5: India report

Survey 2019-21. Nutrition, anaemia, maternal care, vaccination and living conditions.

09 Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

Release of National Family Health Survey 6

29 May 2026. Survey 2023-24; newer health, nutrition and women's access figures.

10 Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

Update on NFHS-6

4 August 2026. Indicator harmonisation and the separate ICMR anaemia survey.

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Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

11 National Health Systems Resource Centre

National Health Accounts, 2022-23

Released May 2026. Spending table includes old and new GDP denominators.

12 Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

Release of National Health Accounts, 2022-23

27 May 2026. Matched 2013-14 spending comparisons and the new GDP-series qualification.

13 Press Information Bureau / Health Ministry

Affordable and Accessible Healthcare for All

12 August 2026. Dated PM-JAY cards, hospitalisations, hospitals and primary-care centres.

14 Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

Strengthening Medical Education Infrastructure

7 August 2026. Before-2014 baseline and updated colleges, MBBS and postgraduate seats.

15 Health Ministry / PMSSY

Status of 22 new AIIMS

Dashboard updated 16 September 2026. Six fully functional; other campuses at different stages.

16 Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

AIIMS in the Country

February 2020 parliamentary answer. Six partly functional before 2014; Raebareli approved in 2009.

17 Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

Strengthening Healthcare Services in Rural Areas

4 August 2026. June 2026 self-assessment against Indian Public Health Standards.

18 World Health Organization / PIB

Global Tuberculosis Report 2025: burden and progress

2024 disease estimates. India incidence 187 per lakh; use estimated cases, not notifications.

24 March 2026 TB backgrounder: the dated comparison

19 Food and Public Distribution Ministry / Parliament

Food and Nutritional Security: Lok Sabha answer

11 February 2026. NFSA ceiling, 5 kg per person and 35 kg per AAY household.

20 Department of Food and Public Distribution

Annual Report, 2024-25

NFSA history, free-grain continuation and coverage of about 80.67 crore persons at that report date.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

21 Ministry of Education

[Release of UDISE+ Report, 2025-26](#)

July 2026. School totals, retention, facilities and the NEP-stage definitions.

22 Ministry of Education

[School Dropout Rates](#)

3 August 2026 parliamentary reply. Recent rates using the same NEP stages.

23 Press Information Bureau / Education Ministry

[Beyond the Numbers: School Education Progress](#)

17 August 2026. UDISE+ 2025-26 national school, teacher and facility figures.

24 ASER Centre / Pratham

[ASER 2014: Original reports and findings](#)

Rural schooling baseline around the comparison year. The survey was taken after the 2014 government change.

25 ASER Centre / Pratham

[ASER 2024: All India pages](#)

Rural household survey. National rural enrolment and learning; not urban India.

26 ASER Centre / Pratham

[ASER 2024: Enrolment and Learning Report Card](#)

Comparable rural reading and arithmetic results for 2014, 2018, 2022 and 2024.

27 ASER Centre / Pratham

[ASER 2024: National Findings](#)

Survey design, enrolment and pandemic learning recovery. Released January 2025.

28 Ministry of Education / AISHE

[All India Survey on Higher Education, 2023-24](#)

Released July 2026. Enrolment, GER, group differences and survey methodology.

29 Ministry of Education

[Release of AISHE 2023-24](#)

8 July 2026. Retrospective 2014-15 comparison; subgroup GER and female participation.

30 Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

[Annual Report, PLFS, 2025](#)

Published May 2026. Appendix Table 7 gives literacy by age, sex and residence; design changed in 2025.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

31 Press Information Bureau / Census of India

Census 2011 results and Census 2027 background

July 2025 backgrounder. Final 2011 literacy: 73.0%; male 80.9%, female 64.6%.

32 Ministry of Finance

Highlights of the Union Budget, 2013-14

28 February 2013. Announced HRD allocation of Rs 65,867 crore.

33 Ministry of Education

Education Allocation in Union Budget, 2026-27

1 February 2026. Ministry allocation of Rs 1,39,289.48 crore; budget estimate.

34 World Bank

India Development Update, April 2026

Figures 2.6-2.7 and poverty methods note. Revised 2021-PPP lines; observations 2011-12 and 2023-24.

35 NITI Aayog

National Multidimensional Poverty Index: Progress Review, 2023

Direct NFHS comparisons: 2015-16 and 2019-21. Definitions and deprivation indicators.

36 NITI Aayog

Multidimensional Poverty in India Since 2005-06

January 2024 discussion paper. 2013-14 and 2022-23 figures are extrapolated estimates.

37 Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

Household Consumption Expenditure Survey, 2023-24

Report 592. Spending, constant-price comparisons, Gini and questionnaire changes.

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HCES 2023-24: Detailed Results

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39 Press Information Bureau / Petroleum Ministry

Infrastructure at the Core of India's Development

9 June 2026. LPG consumer stock and FY2025-26 average PMUY refills.

40 Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

Comprehensive Modular Survey: Education, 2025

26 August 2025 release; April-June survey. Household school costs and enrolment by school type.

A REPORT CARD IN PLAIN ENGLISH

India, before and after 2014

Farming, industry,
science, space and defence

*What changed. What the numbers mean.
What still needs a closer look.*

PART FOUR OF SIX

Written by Lovepreet Singh

misterlove.in / Research cut-off: 3 October 2026

A NOTE FROM THE AUTHOR

What India makes.

From a field of wheat to a spacecraft. From an idea to a working business.

A bigger harvest sounds good. So does a bigger factory, a new business or a rocket that reaches the Moon. But I wanted to ask one more question after each headline: what exactly became bigger, and what does that change mean?

My interests in research, business and technology meet in this part. On MisterLove, I try to turn a complicated subject into something you can follow without already knowing its language. Here, that means explaining a farmer's household income, a factory's value added and a patent application in ordinary words.

The Matrix India posts started this series. Four of the rows I return to here concern startups, steel, coal and defence exports. I put those claims beside the original data, then widen the picture to farming, small businesses, electronics, research and space.

I have used 2014 as a comparison point. It helps organise the story, but it does not tell us who deserves every bit of credit. Farmers, workers, scientists, companies, states and the Union government all shape what a country produces. Many projects also take years to move from an idea to a result.

Some of the gaps matter as much as the increases. The latest income reading in the Situation Assessment Survey describes 2018-19; another survey offers a newer reading with a different definition. A space mission planned for next year is still a plan. Registered-business counts cannot tell us how many firms are profitable today.

You do not need to read this like a textbook. Pick a topic that interests you. The table gives the figures; the paragraphs explain each row and the question it can actually answer. I have kept the dates attached so you can see where the evidence stops.

Lovepreet Singh
MisterLove

Sources: 01, 02. Full references on pages 21-24.

YOUR READING MAP

Read the number with its date.

The newest report and the newest observation are often different things.

Pages	What you will find
4-8	Harvests, irrigation, farmer income, milk, fish, eggs and farm support
9-12	Registered factories, steel, coal and electronics
13-14	Small businesses, industrial incentives and recognised startups
15-16	Research spending, publications and patents
17-18	Completed space missions, setbacks, budgets and future targets
19-20	Defence production, exports and continuing arms imports
21-24	Numbered sources; click a title to open the original publication

FY means financial year: April to March. FY2025-26 therefore ends in March 2026. A crop year commonly runs from July to June. A survey can cover a still earlier period. Each table says which one it uses.

One lakh is 100,000. One crore is 10 million. A million tonnes is 10 lakh tonnes; a billion is 100 crore. A tonne is 1,000 kilograms. A quintal is 100 kilograms. These are different ways of writing amounts, not different kinds of progress.

Current-price rupees are the money values reported for that year. They include price changes. More rupees spent or earned does not automatically mean the same increase in physical output or purchasing power. A percentage-point change measures the gap between two percentages: 40% to 50% is 10 points.

The cut-off is 3 October 2026. This volume covers the main national measures in these subjects; it cannot list every crop, industry, invention or military programme. Parts 1-3 cover the economy, infrastructure and living standards. Parts 5-6 will cover institutions, safety, the environment, state differences and rankings.

FY2014-15 runs from April 2014 to March 2015 and crosses the change of government. It is not a fully earlier baseline.

01 / CROP PRODUCTION

The harvest is much larger.

This measures food produced. Farmer income needs a separate question.

Annual production	2013-14	2025-26 estimate
Foodgrains, million tonnes	265.05	376.563
Rice, million tonnes	106.65	154.024
Wheat, million tonnes	95.85	120.657

Foodgrains include cereals, such as rice and wheat, and pulses, such as gram and tur. Rice and wheat are already inside the first row. Adding all three rows would count them twice. The earlier 245.80 million-tonne cereal total sometimes seen in tables leaves out pulses; it is not the full foodgrain total.

The later figures are the third advance estimates, released on 27 May 2026. They are estimates for the 2025-26 crop year, not final audited totals. The 2024-25 final foodgrain figure was 357.732 million tonnes. The newer estimate is about 5.3% above that.

Against 2013-14, the estimated foodgrain harvest is roughly 42% larger. Picture an earlier harvest of 100 tonnes becoming about 142 tonnes. Rice rose by about 44%; wheat by about 26%. These are changes in physical quantity, so inflation does not explain them.

A larger national harvest can come from more land planted, more crops taken from the same land, better yields and different weather. The total alone cannot split the increase between those causes. It also does not show whether every farmer earned more.

For a family growing wheat, the useful next questions are its yield per acre, selling price and cost of seed, labour, water and transport. The country can produce more food while some farms struggle. Availability, food prices and a farmer's profit each need their own evidence.

2013-14 is a final historical figure. 2025-26 is an advance estimate; later revisions can change it. Sources: 03, 04, 39. Full references on pages 21-24.

02 / WATER FOR FARMING

More crop area gets irrigation.

Count a field once, or count each crop season. The result is different.

Irrigation measure	2013-14	2023-24 provisional
Net area, million hectares	68.419	82.416
Gross area, million hectares	96.270	130.548
Gross irrigated / gross cropped area	47.8%	59.9%

Net irrigated area counts the land that received irrigation, counting each piece once in the year. One hectare is about 2.47 acres. The increase from 68.419 to 82.416 million hectares is about 20%.

Gross irrigated area counts each irrigated crop season. If the same hectare grows two irrigated crops in a year, it contributes two hectares to the gross count. Gross area rose by about 36%. It can grow faster than net area when land is used for more crop seasons.

The third row says that about 60 out of every 100 hectares counted across crop seasons received irrigation in 2023-24. The earlier figure was about 48. The change is 12.1 percentage points. It is not the share of India's total land, or the percentage of farmers with their own pump.

Water access can reduce dependence on the timing of rain. But being recorded as irrigated does not establish that water arrived in the right quantity, at the right time or at an affordable cost. A field with an unreliable supply can still be in this count.

The report is dated October 2025 and its newest national observation is provisional 2023-24. I have kept that date visible. This is not a measurement of irrigation in 2026. Groundwater levels, water quality and the cost of pumping also matter; environmental pressures are taken up in Part 5.

Source units are thousand hectares; the table converts them to million hectares. Gross area counts repeated crop seasons. Sources: 05. Full references on pages 21-24.

03 / FARM-HOUSEHOLD INCOME

Two surveys tell the story.

Different dates and definitions. No interchangeable numbers.

Average monthly household income	Amount
SAS 2013: reference year 2012-13	Rs 6,426
SAS 2019: reference year 2018-19	Rs 10,218
NAFIS 2021-22: different survey	Rs 13,661

SAS means Situation Assessment Survey. Its first figure describes July 2012 to June 2013; the second describes July 2018 to June 2019. An August 2026 reply still identifies the 2019 round as the latest SAS. It is not the only national survey offering information on agricultural households.

Between the two SAS reference years, average income increased by Rs 3,792 a month, or about 59%. It did not double over that measured interval. This is a nominal rise, in each year's rupees. Higher prices reduce how much of the increase buys extra goods.

The figure covers the household's members and can include crops, animals, wages and other work. It is not one person's salary or crop profit alone. SAS 2019 required a self-employed agricultural member and annual produce worth more than Rs 4,000. Families doing only farm wage labour were excluded. The income comparison deducts paid business expenses.

NABARD, the National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development, runs the All India Rural Financial Inclusion Survey, or NAFIS. It reports Rs 13,661 a month for agricultural households in 2021-22. This is a newer reading, but it uses a different survey and eligibility threshold: produce worth more than Rs 6,500, with a self-employed agricultural member. It cannot simply replace the SAS endpoint.

Neither later figure describes income in 2026. Averages also hide differences between families, and counting unpaid family work as a cost changes the result. To judge a claim that income doubled, we need matched definitions, dates and a clear choice between ordinary rupees and purchasing power after inflation.

The table labels two separate surveys. A publication year is not its income reference year; no older reading is presented as 2026 income. Sources: 06, 07, 41. Full references on pages 21-24.

04 / MILK, FISH AND EGGS

Farming includes much more.

Animals and fisheries are a large part of the production story.

Annual production	2013-14	2024-25
Milk, million tonnes	137.7	247.87
Fish, million tonnes	9.579	19.775
Eggs, billion eggs	74.752	149.111

Milk production was about 80% higher than in 2013-14. Fish production more than doubled, rising about 106%. Egg production nearly doubled, rising about 99%. The fish figure is provisional. These are physical quantities, not the rupee value of sales.

For eggs, one billion means 100 crore eggs. The latest total is therefore about 14,911 crore eggs in a year. It counts production, not the number of people eating eggs or the amount each family can afford.

The dairy report also gives milk availability per person: 319 grams a day in 2014-15 and 485 grams in 2024-25. That earlier year crosses the government change. Availability is production divided across the population; it does not mean every person drank that amount each day.

India was already the world's largest milk producer in 1998. A continued first-place rank and a rise in the amount produced are two separate facts. The later output is much larger, but the leading position did not begin after 2014.

These activities can give a household more than one source of earnings. Their costs still matter: feed, animal care, disease, electricity, storage and transport can affect what the producer keeps. A bigger national milk or fish total cannot establish a bigger profit for every dairy farmer or fisher.

More production also does not guarantee better nutrition in every home. Prices, distribution, diets and who gets the food shape that result. Part 3 examines nutrition directly rather than treating output as a substitute for a health survey.

Milk and egg series use the dairy report; fish is converted from lakh tonnes. All production figures keep FY2024-25 as their latest year. Sources: 08, 09. Full references on pages 21-24.

05 / FARM SUPPORT

A price promise and a cash transfer.

The announced price, the actual sale and family income are separate amounts.

MSP, rupees per quintal	2013-14	2026-27
Common paddy	1,310	2,441
Maize	1,310	2,410
Tur / arhar	4,300	8,450

MSP means Minimum Support Price. It is an announced support price for specified crops. A quintal is 100 kilograms. Common-paddy MSP rose about 86%, maize about 84% and tur about 97% in ordinary rupees. Different crops received different increases.

An announced MSP does not establish that every farmer sold every crop to the government at that price. Actual procurement, local buyers, crop quality and access to a purchase centre affect what happens at the sale. The table records the policy price, not each farmer's received price.

The 2026-27 paddy announcement uses a cost of Rs 1,627 per quintal and a margin of about 50%. That cost includes paid expenses and an estimated value for family labour, often called A2+FL. It is not the wider C2 cost, which also includes items such as the rental value of owned land. A 50% margin on one cost measure does not automatically mean a 50% profit on every farmer's full costs.

PM-KISAN, introduced in 2019, pays eligible landholding farmer families Rs 6,000 a year in three Rs 2,000 instalments. The 23rd instalment, released on 20 June 2026, transferred Rs 18,880 crore to 9.44 crore farmers. These are that instalment's reported recipients, not a count of everyone working in agriculture.

For a recipient family, the annual benefit averages Rs 500 a month. It can help pay some expenses, but it is not the family's whole income. Adding it to an older survey average would invent a new national income figure; the survey year, eligibility and other earnings would need to be measured together.

The MSP comparison uses the same crop and kharif marketing-season series. All price increases shown are nominal. Sources: 10, 11. Full references on pages 21-24.

06 / REGISTERED FACTORIES

More people work in factories.

The newest factory survey was released on 30 September 2026.

Annual Survey of Industries	2013-14	2024-25
Factories in the survey frame	2,24,576	2,66,931
Factories operating	1,85,690	2,18,543
Total persons engaged	1,35,38,114	2,09,96,913
Gross value added, Rs lakh crore	10.65	26.94
Total output value, Rs lakh crore	65.55	165.24

The Annual Survey of Industries, or ASI, covers the registered factory sector. It does not count every workshop, home business or informal manufacturer. The latest results describe April 2024 to March 2025, although the release came in September 2026.

The first row includes factories in the survey's frame. The second counts those operating. The difference matters: a recorded factory is not automatically a working one. Operating factories rose by roughly 18% over this comparison.

Persons engaged includes workers and other people working in these establishments, such as management and support staff. The total rose by about 74.59 lakh, or 55%. It is a difference between two annual survey estimates, not a count of unique people who got a new permanent job during 2026.

Output is the total value produced. Gross value added, or GVA, subtracts the value of bought-in inputs. Imagine a factory producing goods worth Rs 100 using purchased materials and services worth Rs 60: the value it adds is Rs 40. That amount still has to cover wages and other claims; it is not the owner's profit.

GVA was about 2.53 times the earlier rupee value. Output was about 2.52 times. Both use current prices, so these multiples include inflation and are not physical-production growth rates. Survey coverage also evolves over time; these results describe the ASI sector, not all Indian manufacturing.

Source money tables use Rs lakh; these values are converted to Rs lakh crore and rounded. Employment is not a count of workers alone. Sources: 12, 13. Full references on pages 21-24.

07 / STEEL

Capacity is not the steel made.

A plant can be able to produce more than it actually produces.

Steel measure	2013-14	2025-26
Crude steel capacity, million tonnes/year	102.26	Over 220.4
Crude steel produced, million tonnes	81.69	168.4

Capacity means how much plants are equipped to make in a year. Production means how much they actually made. Think of a bakery able to bake 1,000 loaves a day but baking 750. Its capacity is 1,000; its output is 750. Neither number can replace the other.

Crude steel is the steel at an early production stage, before it becomes many finished products. Actual crude steel output more than doubled between 2013-14 and 2025-26, increasing by about 106%. The newer figure comes from the ministry's April 2026 release and is provisional.

The June 2026 compendium puts capacity at over 220.4 million tonnes a year. Capacity also more than doubled against the 2013-14 baseline. The capacity recorded near a year's end and the output made throughout that year do not give a precise utilisation rate simply by division.

The Matrix chart shows 109 to 222 million tonnes. The historical ministry table identifies 109.85 as capacity in 2014-15, a year spanning the government change. It gives 102.26 for 2013-14. Neither is that year's actual crude steel output.

The chart's later 222 is close to the recent capacity scale, but it is not the exact June compendium figure. Without a matching source date, I cannot reproduce that number precisely. What the dated sources do show is a large rise in both productive capacity and actual output.

More steel can support buildings, machinery and transport. It does not by itself tell us the profit of steel companies, the quality of every product, the jobs created or the environmental cost. Those outcomes require separate measurements.

The chart row is explained as a capacity claim. The report keeps capacity and physical production in separate rows. Sources: 02, 14, 15, 16. Full references on pages 21-24.

08 / COAL

Much more coal. A recent dip.

A long-term rise can contain a year when production falls.

India coal production	Million tonnes
FY2013-14	565.77
FY2024-25	1,047.52
FY2025-26	1,040.08

The latest full-year figure is about 84% above 2013-14. A production level of 100 in the earlier year would be about 184 now. These figures measure coal mined in India; they are not mining capacity or the monetary value of coal.

The newest year is slightly below the preceding one: 1,040.08 versus 1,047.52 million tonnes. That is a fall of 7.44 million tonnes, or about 0.7%. A report card should show both the long-term increase and the most recent change. 'It kept rising every year' would go further than these figures allow.

The Matrix row shows 565 to 1,000 million tonnes. Its earlier number is a rounded version of the historical scale. The later rounded number captures the move past one billion tonnes, but the current full-year observation is 1,040.08. The years need to travel with the numbers.

Higher domestic production can help supply power stations and industry. It does not automatically end imports. Coal comes in different grades, and steelmaking needs coking coal. A country can produce more of some grades while still buying others abroad.

These coal totals should not be mixed with lignite, a different fuel that has its own statistics. Nor should mined tonnes be added to power-generation capacity measured in megawatts. One counts fuel produced; the other counts the power equipment installed.

Supply security and environmental effects are different questions. More coal can support energy availability while increasing pressures that need to be managed. Air quality, emissions and the wider energy balance belong in the environment discussion in Part 5.

The table uses full financial years. FY2025-26 ended in March 2026; it is not a partial calendar-year total. Sources: 02, 17, 18. Full references on pages 21-24.

09 / ELECTRONICS AND MOBILES

India makes and exports more.

Production value does not reveal how much of each product is made locally.

Value, Rs crore	2014-15, approx.	2025-26
All electronics produced	1,90,000	13,11,000
Electronics exports	38,000	4,24,000
Mobile phones produced	18,000	6,27,000
Mobile-phone exports	1,500	2,59,000

The matched table comes from a July 2026 parliamentary reply. Its earlier year is 2014-15, not a strictly pre-2014 baseline. All values are in the rupees of the reporting year. Production counts value made in India; exports count value sold abroad.

All-electronics production became about 6.9 times the earlier value. Electronics exports became about 11.2 times. Mobile production and exports grew much faster. Using the rounded endpoints above gives about 35 times and 173 times respectively; these are approximate ratios, not exact unrounded results.

The release also calls the mobile increases about 33-fold and 165-fold. Those labels do not reproduce exactly from its displayed rounded baselines. The table therefore keeps the endpoints visible.

A phone assembled in India can still contain imported chips, displays and other parts. The value of the finished phone is larger than the value added inside India. This table establishes growth in production and exports; it cannot establish that every component is domestic.

Mobile figures are part of the wider electronics figures. Adding them together would double-count mobiles. Exports are also part of production and sales, rather than an extra amount of GDP to add on top.

To judge how deeply manufacturing has developed, we would also want local component production, design work, domestic value added, worker pay and productivity. A larger sales-value table is useful evidence, but it does not answer all those questions by itself.

Rs 1,00,000 crore = Rs 1 lakh crore. Electronics production of Rs 13,11,000 crore is Rs 13.11 lakh crore. Sources: 19. Full references on pages 21-24.

10 / SMALL BUSINESSES AND SUPPORT

More registrations need context.

A survey estimate and an online register count different things.

MSME measure	Reported number
Estimated enterprises, NSS survey 2015-16	6.3388 crore
Government registration headline, August 2026	9.16 crore

MSME means micro, small and medium enterprise. The older figure estimates unincorporated, non-agricultural enterprises covered by the National Sample Survey, or NSS. Its scope excludes some registered companies, registered factories and construction. It is not a count of every Indian business.

The newer figure is an administrative registration headline. Udyam and the complementary Udyam Assist system bring firms into formal recognition, including existing informal micro businesses. Registering an old shop does not mean the shop was newly created. Eligibility and coverage also differ from the older survey.

The survey estimated 11.10 crore people employed in its covered enterprises in 2015-16. The August 2026 backgrounder says registered MSMEs employ more than 40 crore. These are different systems, so subtracting them would not give jobs created. The newer headline is not an independent survey of unique, currently active jobs.

A separate industrial support programme is PLI: Production Linked Incentive. It supports additional eligible production or sales across 14 sectors. The September 2026 government summary reports, up to June 2026, Rs 2.6 lakh crore of investment, Rs 23.8 lakh crore of production and sales, over Rs 15.5 lakh crore of exports and 14.6 lakh jobs.

Those PLI amounts are programme totals accumulated over time, not one year's national manufacturing output. Investment is not the government's incentive bill; sales are not profit. Exports overlap with sales, so the amounts should not be added. The reported jobs also do not establish the net jobs caused by the programme compared with what would have happened without it.

2015-16 is after 2014. No percentage-growth claim is made from the unmatched MSME survey and registration counts. Sources: 20, 21, 22. Full references on pages 21-24.

11 / STARTUPS

Recognition began in 2016.

India had young businesses before it had this particular official register.

DPIIT-recognised startups	Count
2016	452
September 2026	About 2.54 lakh

DPIIT is the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade. Startup India began in January 2016. Recognition is an official status for entities meeting eligibility conditions; it is not a census of every new business, or a guarantee that a recognised firm will succeed.

The rise from 452 in the scheme's first year to about 2.54 lakh is a large expansion of recognition. Part of the early-to-later difference reflects the register building up after it began. New recognition can include a business that already existed before it applied.

The Matrix chart compares 500 before 2014 with 2,30,000 later. The later number is within the scale of the expanding official register, although the September 2026 update is higher. But the earlier 500 cannot be a 2014 count under a recognition system launched in 2016.

I have not found a matching source definition that makes those two chart endpoints the same measure. That leaves the exact 500-to-2,30,000 comparison unresolved. It does not mean India had no startups before 2014, and it does not erase the growth documented after recognition began.

A recognised-startup count tells us about participation in the system. It does not tell us how many firms remain active, earn a profit, survive several years or create secure jobs. Those need business-survival and employment data. Eligibility rules also shape who can enter the count.

A 'unicorn' is a private company valued at at least one billion US dollars. That valuation is an estimate used in investment deals; it is not cash earned, annual production or the founder's money in a bank account. Large startup counts and valuations should therefore be read alongside actual business results.

There is no invented zero for startups in 2014. The comparable administrative series begins after the comparison boundary. Sources: 02, 22, 23, 40. Full references on pages 21-24.

12 / RESEARCH SPENDING

More money goes into research.

The newest observed total and the projected total are not interchangeable.

National R&D expenditure	Rs crore	Share of GDP
2013-14, observed	79,355.89	0.71%
2023-24, observed	2,44,767.81	0.84%
2025-26, projected	3,13,007.02	0.90%

R&D means research and development: work to understand something new or develop a new product, process or technology. GERD means the total spent on this work inside the country across the sectors covered by the statistics. It is wider than the budget of one science ministry.

The latest observed expenditure in DST's 2025-26 statistical publication is for 2023-24. It is about 3.08 times the 2013-14 amount in current rupees. This includes price changes; it does not establish that research activity or its results tripled.

The GDP share asks how large research spending is relative to the economy. At 0.84%, it is roughly 84 paise for every Rs 100 of GDP. The older share uses the 2011-12 GDP base and the newer one the 2022-23 base. That change prevents a perfectly matched comparison.

The 2025-26 figure is projected from recent sector growth rates. It is not a fresh observation of all spending in that year. The report labels it as a projection, so the 0.90% headline should keep that label too.

For research papers, the report uses a US National Science Foundation data series: 78,135 in 2012 and 2,07,390 in 2022. The later observation remains 2022. The count rose about 2.65 times; it measures papers counted in that series, not the quality or usefulness of every paper.

Spending, papers, skilled researchers and useful discoveries are connected, but they answer different questions. A stronger report card needs both resources and results. A larger budget cannot tell us by itself whether a treatment worked, a new machine reached customers or a paper changed what scientists know.

DST = Department of Science and Technology. The last row is projected. GDP-base changes and current-price rupees are stated explicitly. Sources: 24, 25. Full references on pages 21-24.

13 / PATENTS

More applications. Uneven grants.

Asking for protection and receiving it are different events.

Patent-office measure	2014-15	2024-25
Applications filed, all applicants	42,763	1,10,375
Applications filed by Indian applicants	12,071	68,201
Indian share of applications	28.23%	61.79%
Patents granted, all applicants	5,978	33,504

A patent application asks for legal protection for an invention. A grant means the office accepted an application after examination. One is a request; the other is a later decision. The baseline is 2014-15, not fully before the government change.

Applications were about 2.58 times the earlier count. Indian applicants' share rose by 33.56 percentage points. The all-applicant total also includes foreign applicants seeking protection in India; it should not be presented as a count of inventions made only by Indians.

Grants show a less smooth path. DST reports 1,03,057 grants in 2023-24, followed by 33,504 in 2024-25. The latest level is well above 2014-15 but much lower than that recent peak. Presenting the peak as the newest annual result would conceal the drop.

Applications and grants need not come from the same batch. A patent granted this year may have been applied for years earlier. Dividing this year's grants by this year's applications would therefore not give an applicant's chance of approval.

Changes in grants can reflect the flow and timing of examination as well as the earlier stock of applications. These totals alone cannot identify the cause of the latest fall. They do not prove that inventions suddenly became less useful, or that a particular administrative change caused it.

A granted patent is also not a product already sold. Some inventions reach the market; others do not. Applications, grants, licensing income and successful products are separate steps. For a small inventor, receiving a grant can matter greatly, but the national count cannot tell us the commercial outcome of every invention.

DST Tables 30 and 33. Latest verified annual patent counts here describe FY2024-25, not inventions or decisions made throughout 2026. Sources: 24, 25. Full references on pages 21-24.

14 / SPACE MISSIONS

Old capability. New milestones.

The story crosses 2014, and it includes setbacks as well as achievements.

Mission	Dated event
Chandrayaan-1	22 October 2008: lunar mission launched
Mars Orbiter Mission	5 November 2013: launched; 24 September 2014: entered Mars orbit
Chandrayaan-3	23 August 2023: successful lunar soft landing
SpaDeX	16 January 2025: docking demonstrated in orbit
PSLV-C62 / EOS-N1	12 January 2026: anomaly near the end of the third stage

India already had a lunar mission before 2014. Chandrayaan-1 was an orbiter: a spacecraft studying the Moon from space. Chandrayaan-3 demonstrated a soft landing, reaching the surface under control. Orbiting and landing are different technical achievements.

The Mars mission makes the date boundary especially clear. It launched in November 2013 and reached Mars in September 2014. Its planning, construction, launch and arrival cannot all be assigned to one side of the 2014 line.

SpaDeX demonstrated docking: bringing two spacecraft together and joining them in orbit. That is a useful capability for more complex missions. A successful demonstration does not mean every future mission using it has already succeeded.

The 2026 PSLV-C62 mission also belongs in the record. ISRO reports an anomaly near the end of the third stage. A launch taking place is not automatically a successful delivery of its intended spacecraft. Counting only celebrated achievements would leave out part of the programme's performance.

These are selected mission milestones, not a total of all launches. Launch count, satellites carried, mission complexity, reliability and useful data are different measures. One rocket can carry many satellites, so more satellites does not necessarily mean the same increase in rocket launches.

Dates refer to actual events, not announcement dates. The Mars mission spans the comparison boundary. Sources: 26, 27, 28, 29, 30. Full references on pages 21-24.

15 / SPACE BUDGET AND NEXT STEPS

About twice the full allocation.

Use the same budget stage, then keep future missions separate.

Department of Space	Rs crore
2013-14: Budget Estimate, full total	6,792.00
2024-25: actual expenditure, net	10,949.40
2025-26: original Budget Estimate	13,416.20
2025-26: Revised Estimate	12,448.60
2026-27: Budget Estimate	13,705.63

Budget Estimate is the amount planned at the start. Revised Estimate is the updated plan later in the year. Actual expenditure is what was spent. Comparing the full original allocations, 2026-27 is about 2.02 times 2013-14 in current rupees, not a doubling of purchasing power.

The original 2013-14 budget contains Rs 5,615 crore under the old Plan category and Rs 1,177 crore under Non-Plan. Together they make Rs 6,792 crore. Comparing only the earlier Plan portion with the later full total would inflate the rise.

The 2026-27 budget document also shows that the 2025-26 estimate was revised down from Rs 13,416.20 to Rs 12,448.60 crore. Neither estimate is a final bill. The actual-expenditure row shown here is the 2024-25 net figure in that document.

An August 2026 reply targets the first uncrewed Gaganyaan experimental mission for October-December 2026. Further uncrewed flights and the first crewed mission are targeted by 2027. 'Uncrewed' means without people aboard. These are target dates; they do not count as completed human flights.

The same reply targets a fully operational Bharatiya Antariksh Station by 2035. It records an approved Rs 20,193 crore programme budget for eight missions. Approval is not the same as money already spent, and a budget spread across missions is not a single year's departmental allocation.

Historical allocation categories have changed. The comparison uses full Budget Estimates; all Gaganyaan and station targets retain their source date. Sources: 31, 32, 33. Full references on pages 21-24.

16 / DEFENCE PRODUCTION

Defence production value grew.

Production value, spending and readiness are separate measures.

Annual defence production value	Current-price rupees
FY2013-14	Rs 43,746 crore
FY2024-25	About Rs 1.54 lakh crore
FY2025-26	About Rs 1.78 lakh crore

Defence production reached about Rs 1.78 lakh crore in 2025-26: about 4.07 times 2013-14 and roughly 16% above the rounded 2024-25 value. These rupee totals include changes in prices, the amount produced and the mix of equipment.

The latest production split is about 76% from defence public-sector companies and other public units, and 24% from the private sector. Public production therefore remains the larger part of the reported total. A growing private sector does not mean public units have disappeared.

Production value counts the sector's output. It is not the government's defence budget, the value of exports alone or the number of weapons available to troops. A high-value aircraft, a ship and many small components can all contribute money values without being comparable units of equipment.

The Union's 2026-27 defence allocation is about Rs 7.85 lakh crore. Its capital allocation is about Rs 2.19 lakh crore, including about Rs 1.39 lakh crore earmarked for capital procurement from domestic industry. Capital spending covers longer-lived assets; the wider budget also pays for other needs.

An earmark is a planned allocation. It does not mean every purchase is complete or every rupee has been paid to a supplier. These budget amounts cannot be added to production value as though they were separate pieces of national output.

Domestic production can build skills and supply capacity. Imported components, maintenance, delivery delays and performance require separate evidence. This table records production value; it cannot establish complete military self-sufficiency or combat readiness.

The later production values are ministry-rounded current-price totals. FY2026-27 defence spending is a Budget Estimate, not actual expenditure. Sources: 34, 37. Full references on pages 21-24.

17 / DEFENCE EXPORTS AND IMPORTS

Defence exports rose sharply.

Selling more abroad and buying major weapons abroad can happen together.

Annual defence exports	Rupees
FY2013-14	Rs 686 crore
FY2024-25	Rs 23,622 crore
FY2025-26	Rs 38,424 crore

The latest export value is about 56 times the 2013-14 figure. That means an increase of about 5,501%, using the earlier value as the starting base. It rose about 62.7% from 2024-25. These are rupee export values, not the number of weapons exported.

In 2025-26, public-sector defence companies exported Rs 21,071 crore and private companies Rs 17,353 crore: about 55% and 45% respectively. The ministry reports 145 exporters and destinations in more than 80 countries. These counts show reach, not profit or wholly Indian content.

The Matrix chart's 700-to-38,424 comparison is close to the official rounded-baseline story. The exact historical figure is 686. Its percentage method divides the increase by the later total. That answers a different arithmetic question from growth, which divides by the earlier total.

For a simple example, 100 becoming 200 is 100% growth. The added 100 is also 50% of the later 200. Neither calculation tells us that a government caused that percentage of the result. Dates and a subtraction cannot separate policy effects from other influences.

The Stockholm International Peace Research Institute, or SIPRI, places India second among major-arms importers in its March 2026 report. India had 8.2% of global imports in 2021-25. That is its share of the world import market, not the share of its own equipment imported. Its import volume fell 4% against 2016-20.

SIPRI measures major-arms transfer volume using its own indicator; the ministry measures exports in money. The two cannot be divided to calculate a self-reliance percentage. Both sources show why the report card needs export growth and continuing import dependence on the same page.

The four Matrix rows covered here are steel (p10), coal (p11), startups (p14) and defence exports (p20). Full cross-chart checks continue in Part 6. Sources: 02, 35, 36, 38. Full references on pages 21-24.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

01 MisterLove / Lovepreet Singh

Public author profile and editorial theme

Accessed 3 October 2026. Byline, public interests and website design.

02 The Matrix India

Before-and-after chart supplied by the reader

4 August 2026 post. Startup, steel, coal and defence-export rows are examined here.

03 Ministry of Food Processing Industries

Historical cereal production table

19 July 2019. Rice and wheat in 2013-14; its cereal total excludes pulses.

04 Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare

Third Advance Estimates, 2025-26

27 May 2026. Foodgrain, rice and wheat production; estimates remain revisable.

05 Agriculture Ministry / Economics and Statistics

Land Use Statistics at a Glance, 2023-24

Revised October 2025. Table 2: irrigation, thousand hectares; 2023-24 provisional.

06 Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare

Income of Agricultural Households

February 2024 reply. SAS reference years 2012-13 and 2018-19, and monthly income.

Original SAS 2019 report: definitions and methods

07 Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare

Latest Available Data on Farmer Income

11 August 2026 reply. Latest nationwide Situation Assessment Survey remains 2019.

08 Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying

Annual Report, 2025-26

Historical milk and egg production series; milk availability per person.

09 Ministry of Fisheries

Fish Production and Fisheries Development

12 January 2026. 2013-14 and provisional 2024-25 fish-production comparison.

10 Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs

Kharif Minimum Support Prices, 2026-27

13 May 2026. Crop prices, 2013-14 baselines and the cost definition used for margins.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

11 Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare

23rd Instalment of PM-KISAN

20 June 2026. Scheme benefit, release amount and recipients in this instalment.

12 Ministry of Statistics / ASI

Annual Survey of Industries, 2013-14

Volume I, principal characteristics. Historical factories, persons engaged and GVA.

13 Ministry of Statistics / ASI

Annual Survey of Industries, 2024-25

Released 30 September 2026. Table 1: factories, employment, output and GVA.

14 Ministry of Steel

Historical Steel Capacity and Production

8 March 2021 parliamentary table. Separates 2013-14 from 2014-15 capacity.

15 Ministry of Steel / Joint Plant Committee

Development of Indian Steel Sector

June 2026 compendium. FY2025-26 capacity and revised recent steel figures.

16 Ministry of Steel

Steel Sector Performance in FY2025-26

8 April 2026. Crude steel production: 168.4 million tonnes; provisional release.

17 Ministry of Coal

Coal Sector Progress and Historical Production

12 January 2026. FY2013-14 production: 565.77 million tonnes.

18 Ministry of Coal / PIB

Coal Production and Sector Developments

2 August 2026. FY2025-26: 1,040.08 MT; FY2024-25: 1,047.52 MT.

19 Ministry of Electronics and IT

Electronics and Mobile Manufacturing

29 July 2026. Matched 2014-15 and 2025-26 production and export-value table.

20 Ministry of MSME

Annual Report, 2019-20

NSS 73rd round, 2015-16. Estimated unincorporated enterprises and employment.

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Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

21 Ministry of MSME / PIB

[MSME Development Amendment Background](#)

11 August 2026. Registration headline; Udyam and Udyam Assist definitions.

22 Press Information Bureau

[Twelve Years of Make in India](#)

25 September 2026. PLI results to June 2026; startup recognition to September 2026.

23 Commerce and Industry Ministry

[DPIIT Recognition: Historical Startup Counts](#)

7 December 2022. Recognised startups in 2016: 452; recognition began in 2016.

24 Department of Science and Technology

[S&T Indicators Tables, 2025-26](#)

Tables 1, 3, 30 and 33. R&D spending, GDP shares and patent applications/grants.

25 Department of Science and Technology

[R&D Statistics at a Glance, 2025-26](#)

Actual versus projected R&D; NSF publication series through 2022.

26 Indian Space Research Organisation

[Chandrayaan-1](#)

Mission history. First Indian lunar mission launched on 22 October 2008.

27 ISRO / Indian Space Science Data Centre

[Mars Orbiter Mission](#)

Launch: 5 November 2013. Mars orbit insertion: 24 September 2014.

28 Indian Space Research Organisation

[Chandrayaan-3](#)

Mission record. Successful lunar soft landing on 23 August 2023.

29 Indian Space Research Organisation

[SpaDeX Docking Successfully Accomplished](#)

16 January 2025. Demonstration of joining two spacecraft in orbit.

30 Indian Space Research Organisation

[PSLV-C62 / EOS-N1 Mission](#)

12 January 2026. ISRO records an anomaly near the end of the third stage.

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Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

31 Ministry of Finance / Union Budget

Department of Space, Demand 90, 2013-14

Original Budget Estimate: Rs 6,792 crore, including Plan and Non-Plan portions.

32 Ministry of Finance / Union Budget

Department of Space, Demand 95, 2026-27

BE 2026-27, RE 2025-26 and actual expenditure 2024-25 are separate columns.

33 Department of Space

Gaganyaan and Bharatiya Antariksh Station

5 August 2026 reply. Completed tests, future mission targets and approved programme budget.

34 Ministry of Defence

Defence Production in FY2025-26

17 June 2026. Production value and 2013-14 baseline; public and private shares.

35 Ministry of Defence

Defence Exports in FY2025-26

2 April 2026. Rs 38,424 crore; prior year, sector shares and export destinations.

36 Ministry of Defence

Historical Defence Export Comparison

24 July 2026 reply. FY2013-14 baseline: Rs 686 crore; recent export trajectory.

37 Ministry of Defence

Defence Allocation in Union Budget, 2026-27

1 February 2026. Total, capital and domestic capital-procurement allocations.

38 Stockholm International Peace Research Institute

Trends in International Arms Transfers, 2025

March 2026. Major-arms imports, 2021-25; volume measure rather than rupee sales.

39 Agriculture Ministry / PIB

Agricultural Policy and Output, 2014-2026

June 2026 backgrounder. Final foodgrain production: 265.05 MT in 2013-14.

40 DPIIT / Startup India

Startup Recognition and Eligibility

Current portal checked 3 October 2026. Administrative recognition and eligibility conditions.

41 NABARD / National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development

All India Rural Financial Inclusion Survey, 2021-22

Released October 2024. Agricultural-household income and the distinct NAFIS eligibility definition.

A REPORT CARD IN PLAIN ENGLISH

India, before and after 2014

Crime, safety, institutions and environment

*What changed. What the numbers mean.
What still needs a closer look.*

PART FIVE OF SIX

Written by Lovepreet Singh

misterlove.in / Research cut-off: 3 October 2026

A NOTE FROM THE AUTHOR

The numbers touch real lives.

Safety, justice, clean air and water belong in the same report card.

A road can get wider while the number of people dying on it rises. A court can put its records online while cases keep waiting. A city can have cleaner air than before and still have air that falls short of the standard. I wanted this part to explain those situations without making you fight through a pile of official language.

I write on MisterLove because I like taking a difficult subject apart until its meaning becomes clear. My work moves between research, business and technology. In this volume, the most useful question is often a small one: does this number count people, cases, places, capacity or something else?

The Matrix India posts started the series. The tribal-crime chart is one I return to here. I checked its entries against the original NCRB table, included the places it left out and explained why an empty rate cannot be turned into zero.

This is a before-and-after report, with 2014 as the organising point. It is not a claim that every change came from one government. Reporting rules, population, state administration, courts, communities and long-running programmes all belong in the explanation.

I also do not want an old observation to pass as a new one. A report released in 2026 can describe crimes in 2024 or emissions in 2022. Where I could not find a fair pre-2014 comparison, I say so and use the available dated comparison.

Start with the subject you care about. The table gives the numbers. The paragraphs explain each row, then show what remains unanswered. You should not need a degree, a political loyalty or a love of long reports to follow it.

Lovepreet Singh
MisterLove

Sources: 01, 02. Full references on pages 26-28.

YOUR READING MAP

A number needs a meaning.

The date, the unit and the coverage are part of the number.

Pages	What you will find
4-8	Crime totals, murder, women, children and caste-based atrocities
9-10	All 36 states and Union Territories in the tribal-crime table
11-13	Cybercrime, road crashes and suicides
14-17	Police, court delays, prisons, information rights and voting
18-21	Air, forest cover, greenhouse gases and climate
22-25	Rivers, groundwater, waste, tigers and wetlands
26-28	Numbered sources; click a title to open the publication

One lakh means 100,000. One crore means 10 million. A rate per lakh compares a count with a population of 100,000. If a place has 20 recorded cases among two lakh people, its rate is 10 per lakh. A case is not necessarily one victim.

A percentage point is the gap between two percentages. Going from 60% to 70% adds 10 points. It is about 16.7% growth compared with the earlier 60. A rate and a growth percentage answer different questions.

FY means financial year, April to March. Calendar-year crime totals cover January to December. Court and prison figures often count the stock on one date. A stock of pending cases cannot be added to annual new cases as if they were separate events.

The research cut-off is 3 October 2026. This part covers the main national measures in these subjects and the supplied tribal-crime chart. Parts 1-4 cover the economy, infrastructure, living conditions and production. Part 6 will examine international rankings, state differences and the wider chart audit.

Latest means the latest observation verified for that measure, not a completed statistical account of every day in 2026.

01 / RECORDED CRIME

The total changed. So did the rules.

Police records count registered cases, not every offence that happened.

Registered cognisable cases	2013	2024
IPC in 2013; IPC + BNS in 2024	26,47,722	35,44,608
Special and Local Laws	39,92,656	23,41,259
Total of the two groups	66,40,378	58,85,867

Cognisable means the kind of offence for which police can normally investigate without first obtaining a magistrate's order. IPC is the old Indian Penal Code. BNS, the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, replaced it from 1 July 2024. Special and Local Laws include offences under separate central or state laws.

The first row is the main criminal code. The second is the other laws collected in this report. The third adds those two groups. Do not add the total again. The later calendar year combines IPC cases from the earlier part of 2024 with BNS cases from the later part.

NCRB also changed its collection. It excluded the heads for simple hurt under IPC Section 323, food and drug adulteration under Sections 272-276, and criminal intimidation under Section 506. Other forms of hurt remain. A lower total therefore cannot be read as a clean measurement of less actual crime.

One FIR can contain several offences. NCRB's principal-offence rule usually counts it under the most serious offence. An FIR is the police's First Information Report; it is not a court finding that somebody is guilty.

For IPC/BNS cases, the 2024 conviction rate is 53.3%. Its denominator is cases in which trial was completed, not all complaints or all registered cases. Cases still waiting for trial are outside that calculation. Reporting, investigation and judgment are different stages.

Definitions and collection changes are in the report itself. More registration can reflect better reporting as well as more offences. Sources: 03, 04, 06, 07. Full references on pages 26-28.

02 / MURDER

Fewer registered murder cases.

A case count and a population rate tell two parts of the story.

Year	Registered cases	Cases per lakh people
2013	33,201	2.7
2023	27,721	2.0
2024	27,049	1.9

The 2024 count is 6,152 lower than in 2013, a fall of about 18.5%. In plain terms, an earlier count of 100 became about 81. The count also fell by 672 between 2023 and 2024, about 2.4%.

The rate adjusts for the size of the population. The reported rate fell from 2.7 to 1.9 cases per 100,000 people. Those published rates are rounded. They help distinguish a change in the number of cases from a change relative to the number of people.

These are murder cases registered by police. A single case can involve more than one person killed. In 2013, NCRB separately reported 33,901 murder victims; replacing the earlier case count with that victim count would mix two units.

NCRB records disputes as the most common stated motive in 2024, in 9,607 cases. Personal vendetta or enmity accounted for 3,638; gain for 1,460. These are police classifications of cases, not a complete psychological explanation of every killing.

This is a clear decline in the registered murder series. It does not mean violence of every kind fell by 18.5%, or that every district became safer. Assault, domestic abuse, sexual violence and offences never registered need their own evidence.

A national rate also spreads very different local experiences into one average. Someone living in a district facing violence can face a worse situation even when the country's total falls. The table describes the countrywide record, not a promise about an individual's safety.

Cases, victims and accused persons are separate units. Population rates here use NCRB population estimates for the stated years. Sources: 03, 04. Full references on pages 26-28.

03 / WOMEN AND SEXUAL VIOLENCE

Different offences moved differently.

Read the whole category and the rape row separately.

Registered cases or rate	2013	2024
All crimes against women	3,09,546	4,41,534
Rate per lakh women	52.2	64.6
Rape cases	33,707	29,536
Cruelty by husband or relatives	1,18,866	1,20,227

The first row covers several offences against women. It rose by about 42.6%. The second compares those cases with the female population: about 52 cases per lakh women became about 65. This rate is not calculated using all men and women together.

The rape row fell by about 12.4% in the registered-case series. The cruelty row remained around 1.2 lakh cases. A fall in rape cases and a rise in the wider category can both occur, because the wider category includes many other offences.

The latest all-crime count is below 2023's 4,48,211. That one-year fall does not erase the longer-period rise. Likewise, the long-period rise does not tell us that registration increased in every intervening year.

The law changed around this baseline. The 2013 criminal-law amendment broadened sexual-offence provisions, and POCSO introduced a separate framework for children. Legal definitions, willingness to complain and police recording affect comparisons across time.

The figures leave out violence that never becomes a registered case. They cannot establish that an unreported assault did not happen. They also cannot tell us how much of a rise came from more violence and how much from more reporting.

A police complaint is not proof of guilt. An acquittal is not, by itself, proof that the complaint was invented. Investigation and the evidence required in court determine the outcome. The table is useful precisely when we keep those different questions apart.

Women and child categories overlap; adding them would double-count some cases. These are registered cases, not a victimisation survey. Sources: 03, 04. Full references on pages 26-28.

04 / CHILDREN

Much more crime is being recorded.

The category grew, with kidnapping and POCSO cases making up large shares.

Registered cases or rate	2013	2024
All crimes against children	58,224	1,87,702
Rate per lakh children	13.2	42.3
2024 kidnapping and abduction	-	75,108
2024 POCSO Act cases	-	69,191

Children means people below 18 in this report. The all-crime count is about 3.22 times the 2013 count. The rate is also higher, so population growth alone does not explain the larger recorded category.

The last two rows break down 2024. Kidnapping and abduction made up about 40% of recorded child-crime cases. POCSO made up about 36.9%. POCSO means Protection of Children from Sexual Offences. These rows are parts of the total, not extra cases to add to it.

The POCSO law began in 2012, close to the earlier comparison point. The legal framework and the detail collected expanded over the longer period. The rise cannot honestly be turned into a claim that the same narrowly defined risk became exactly 3.22 times greater.

A registered kidnapping category also needs the case's facts. It cannot be read as a count of children kidnapped by strangers alone. The statistical label does not describe who the accused was or what happened in every case.

The total rose from 1,77,335 in 2023 to 1,87,702 in 2024, about 5.8%. This is a continuing rise in the latest registered total. It deserves attention even while definitions and reporting are kept in view.

Girls can appear in both the women and children chapters. One event may therefore be described in more than one victim-group table. Those chapters help us understand different groups; they are not separate piles that can all be added to calculate a new national crime total.

A dash in the 2013 breakdown means no matched figure is supplied here. It does not mean zero offences occurred. Sources: 03, 04. Full references on pages 26-28.

05 / CASTE AND TRIBAL ATROCITIES

The national totals need context.

The tribal-crime chart is about a specific recorded category.

Registered cases	2013	2023	2024
Against Scheduled Castes	39,408	57,789	55,698
Against Scheduled Tribes	6,793	12,960	9,966

Scheduled Castes, or SCs, and Scheduled Tribes, or STs, are legally recognised groups. The later SC count is about 41.3% above 2013. The later ST count is about 46.7% above 2013. Both are lower than their 2023 counts.

The recent tables concern crimes and atrocities against these groups within NCRB's stated scope. The ST table says atrocities concern offences committed against STs by non-SC/ST persons. It excludes IPC-only cases without the SC/ST Act where the offender is from SC/ST groups. It is not a count of every crime involving a tribal person.

The legal framework and reporting coverage changed over the long comparison, including amendments to the atrocities law. These before-and-after totals should not be treated as an unchanged survey of all violence, discrimination or actual risk.

The published 2024 rates are 27.7 per lakh SC people and 9.5 per lakh ST people. Their denominators still come from the 2011 Census. They are not rates calculated from a fresh 2024 or 2026 count of those populations.

The ST national total fell by 2,994 from 2023 to 2024. Manipur alone fell from 3,399 to 289, a reduction of 3,110. Across the remaining places together, the net change was an increase of 116. This arithmetic shows how much one state's swing shaped the national change.

It does not tell us why that swing occurred. The next two pages reproduce all 36 places in the official table, sorted by published 2024 rate, and explain the errors in the supplied chart.

The rate is specific to the SC or ST population. The 2011 denominator and legal scope are essential parts of the comparison. Sources: 02, 03, 05. Full references on pages 26-28.

06 / TRIBAL CRIME: ALL 36 PLACES

Tribal crime, place by place.

Registered cases by year. Rate means cases per lakh ST people in 2024.

State / Union Territory	2022	2023	2024	Rate
Kerala	172	185	145	29.9
Manipur	1	3,399	289	24.8
Rajasthan	2,521	2,453	2,282	24.7
Madhya Pradesh	2,979	2,858	3,165	20.7
Telangana	545	575	658	20.0
Andhra Pradesh	396	361	333	12.7
Karnataka	438	434	393	9.2
Bihar	146	114	113	8.5
Maharashtra	742	773	830	7.9
Tamil Nadu	67	48	55	6.9
Odisha	773	662	599	6.2
Chhattisgarh	516	336	387	4.9
Goa	1	2	7	4.7
Uttarakhand	1	2	12	4.1
Andaman & Nicobar Islands	3	2	1	3.5
Gujarat	330	307	297	3.3
Jharkhand	283	308	260	3.0
Mizoram	29	21	19	1.8

Kerala has the highest published rate, 29.9, with 145 cases. Madhya Pradesh has the largest count, 3,165, with a rate of 20.7. A smaller population can produce a higher rate from fewer cases. These are recorded rates in this specific category, using ST population from the 2011 Census. They are not a ranking of every kind of danger faced by tribal people.

Sorted by the published 2024 rate, highest first. Rounded rates should not be recalculated from the table's rounded population figures. Sources: 02, 05. Full references on pages 26-28.

07 / TRIBAL CRIME: CONTINUED

The rest of the same table.

An unpublished rate stays unpublished. It is different from a recorded zero.

State / Union Territory	2022	2023	2024	Rate
West Bengal	90	90	87	1.6
Uttar Pradesh	5	6	8	0.7
Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu	5	2	1	0.5
Assam	9	2	14	0.4
Himachal Pradesh	4	7	1	0.3
Tripura	3	9	3	0.3
Arunachal Pradesh	0	0	1	0.1
Jammu & Kashmir	1	0	1	0.1
Meghalaya	0	0	0	0.0
Nagaland	0	0	0	0.0
Sikkim	4	2	0	0.0
Ladakh	0	0	0	0.0
Lakshadweep	0	0	0	0.0
Punjab	0	0	0	No rate
Chandigarh	0	0	0	No rate
Delhi	0	2	4	No rate
Haryana	0	0	1	No rate
Puducherry	0	0	0	No rate
ALL INDIA	10,064	12,960	9,966	9.5

The supplied chart gives Punjab a rate of 0.2. NCRB prints no rate. It also prints no rate for Chandigarh and Puducherry, where the chart shows zero. Haryana and Delhi are missing from that chart; both appear here. The five 'No rate' places have no notified ST population denominator in the cited Census table. Their recorded cases remain visible.

A recorded zero does not establish absence of unreported violence. This category and its legal scope are explained on page 8. All 36 places are included. Sources: 02, 05. Full references on pages 26-28.

08 / CYBERCRIME

The recorded count rose sharply.

A growing digital economy also gives crime more digital routes.

Police-registered cybercrime	Cases
2013: IT Act cases	4,356
2013: IPC cybercrime cases	1,337
2013: combined total	5,693
2023: newer reporting framework	86,420
2024: newer reporting framework	1,01,928

The two 2013 rows add to 5,693. The Information Technology Act covers specified digital offences; some cyber-enabled offences were counted under IPC. The 2024 total is about 18 times that combined earlier count. It rose about 17.9% from 2023.

That large increase is in registered cases. The newer framework collects a broader range of offences, while digital use and opportunities to report have also expanded. Dividing the totals alone cannot show that the risk for each internet user rose 18 times.

Fraud was the recorded motive in 73,987 cases in 2024, or 72.6% of the cybercrime total. A motive category is not the amount of money lost. One case can involve several victims, and a complaint to an online portal is not automatically a police FIR.

The government says its financial-fraud response system saved more than Rs 11,158 crore across over 32.80 lakh complaints by 30 June 2026. These are cumulative figures for the system launched in 2021. They are not the number of 2024 FIRs, an annual loss estimate or proof that all the money reached victims again.

For someone facing an online financial fraud, 1930 and cybercrime.gov.in are the official reporting routes. Prompt reporting helps the response system try to stop funds moving further. The larger report-card question is whether prevention, investigation and recovery keep pace with the growth in recorded fraud.

NCRB case counts and the cybercrime portal's cumulative complaints use different units and cannot be added. Sources: 03, 04, 05, 08. Full references on pages 26-28.

Similar crashes. More deaths.

The long-term rise in deaths is much larger than the rise in reported crashes.

Annual MoRTH road-crash measure	2013	2024
Reported crashes	4,86,476	4,87,707
People killed	1,37,572	1,77,175
People injured	4,94,893	4,71,441
Deaths per 100 reported crashes	28.3	36.3

Reported crashes rose by about 0.3% between these years. Deaths rose by 39,603, or about 28.8%. The injury count was lower. These rows count different things: an event, people killed and people injured.

The last row divides deaths by reported crashes. It went from about 28 deaths per 100 crashes to about 36. This does not mean each crash has a 36% chance of killing someone. One crash can kill several people. It is a measure of the seriousness of the reported crash record.

Deaths also rose from 1,72,890 in 2023 to 1,77,175 in 2024, about 2.5%. The latest year therefore continued the recent rise. A longer or wider road network has not automatically delivered fewer road deaths.

More vehicles and more travel change exposure. A per-kilometre risk calculation would need the distance travelled, not only these totals. The annual deaths remain important even without that calculation: they measure lives lost.

Road design, speeds, vehicle protection, enforcement and emergency care can all influence the outcome. This table cannot allocate the increase between those causes. Nor can it show that every highway or state moved in the same direction.

This page keeps the ministry's historical series together. NCRB has a separate road-death total of 1,75,142 for 2024. Different reporting systems can produce different totals. Adding those two counts would largely count the same deaths twice.

MoRTH = Ministry of Road Transport and Highways. All main rows use its series, rather than switching sources between endpoints. Sources: 09, 10. Full references on pages 26-28.

10 / SUICIDES

The long-term count is higher.

The latest small fall follows several years of rising recorded deaths.

Year	Recorded deaths	Deaths per lakh people
2013	1,34,799	11.0
2019	1,39,123	10.4
2023	1,71,418	12.3
2024	1,70,746	12.2

The 2024 count is 35,947 above 2013, about 26.7% higher. The reported population rate is also higher, from 11.0 to 12.2 per lakh. More people in the country do not explain the whole increase in the recorded rate.

The 2019 row shows why two endpoints do not tell the entire path. Its count was slightly above 2013, but its rate was lower. Recorded deaths then rose substantially before the latest small fall.

Between 2023 and 2024, the count fell by 672, about 0.4%. That is a change in the latest year, not a reversal of the full rise since 2013. Both facts belong on the page.

NCRB compiles suicides reported to police. These are not counts from a complete clinical survey of mental health. Differences in recognition and reporting affect the record; the figures do not cover every unrecorded death.

The report lists stated causes and occupations. A police-recorded cause is not a medical diagnosis or a complete account of a person's life. Several pressures can exist together. An occupation category says what work the person did, not that the occupation itself caused the death.

These numbers describe a serious loss of life. They support looking closely at prevention, accessible care and social pressures. They do not support blaming every death on a single policy, exam, occupation or personal failing.

No methods of suicide are described. The earlier count and rate are confirmed in the parliamentary annexure; later values use ADSI 2024. Sources: 10, 11. Full references on pages 26-28.

11 / POLICE CAPACITY

More personnel. Many vacancies.

A sanctioned post is permission to employ someone; an actual post is filled.

State and UT police measure	1 Jan 2014	1 Jan 2024
Sanctioned personnel	22,83,646	27,55,274
Actual personnel in position	17,22,786	21,62,436
Vacant posts: difference	5,60,860	5,92,838
Vacancies / sanctioned posts	24.6%	21.5%

The number of personnel actually serving rose by 4,39,650, about 25.5%. The approved establishment also grew. The first row is the intended staffing ceiling; it does not mean all those officers were already working.

Subtracting actual staff from sanctioned staff gives the vacancy count. The later shortfall is 31,978 larger in absolute numbers, but smaller as a share of the expanded establishment: about 21.5% instead of 24.6%. Both statements can be true.

Using the report's projected population, the 2024 actual strength is about 155 personnel per lakh people. This includes civil police, District Armed Reserve, Special Armed Police and India Reserve Battalions in the state and UT establishment. Central forces are reported separately.

Women numbered 2,72,535 in that establishment, about 12.6% of its actual strength. A national share does not show whether every station has enough women, whether they hold leadership positions or which duties they are assigned.

This publication describes 1 January 2024, although it was published in 2025. It is not a live count of staff in October 2026. Police and public order are primarily state responsibilities, so staffing differs widely between states.

Staff numbers are one part of capacity. Training, time spent on other duties, investigation skills, equipment and the ability to register a complaint also matter. A larger force alone cannot tell us whether an investigation was fair or finished promptly.

Percentages are calculated from the cited sanctioned and actual totals. The comparison excludes central-force totals from both sides. Sources: 12, 13. Full references on pages 26-28.

12 / COURTS AND DELAY

Many more cases are waiting.

Digital access expanded while the stock of pending cases grew.

Pending cases	31 Dec 2013	30 Jul 2026
High Courts	44,62,705	64,66,970
District and subordinate courts	2,68,38,861	4,99,11,920

High Court pendency rose by about 44.9%. District and subordinate court pendency rose by about 86%. These are stocks of cases awaiting disposal on the two dates. They are not the number newly filed in each year.

The Supreme Court had another 95,954 pending cases in the July 2026 snapshot. Adding the three levels gives 5,64,74,844, about 5.65 crore. No matched 2013 Supreme Court figure is inserted into the table, so it does not pretend to offer an all-level 2013 comparison.

The queue can grow even when courts dispose of many cases, if incoming cases outnumber completed ones. Disposal is a flow over time; pendency is the stock left at a date. A pending case is also not necessarily a criminal case: these totals include different kinds of disputes.

The August 2026 reply reports more than 4.18 crore video hearings, about 1.25 crore electronic filings and 2,584 eSewa centres. These are cumulative service figures. A hearing is not a separate completed case, and several hearings can concern the same case.

At 30 June 2026, the reply records 21,411 working district/subordinate judicial officers against 30,825 sanctioned posts. That gap is another part of the capacity picture. Courtrooms, staffing and case management need to be considered together.

Online filing and access can save journeys and make a case easier to track. They do not prove that waiting times disappeared. To measure speed directly, we need the age and duration of cases as well as the number pending.

Latest pendency is the dated parliamentary NJDG snapshot. It is not a claim to be the live dashboard reading on 3 October 2026. Sources: 14, 15. Full references on pages 26-28.

13 / PRISONS AND UNDERTRIALS

Prisons remain over capacity.

Most people in prison are undertrials, awaiting the outcome of proceedings.

Prison measure, 31 December	2013	2024 revised
Available capacity	3,47,859	4,53,769
People held	4,11,992	5,09,012
Occupancy: people / capacity	118.4%	112.2%
Undertrial prisoners	2,78,503	3,68,883
Undertrials / all prisoners	67.6%	72.5%

Capacity is the number of people the prison system is designed to hold. It grew by about 30.4%. The number held grew by about 23.5%. Capacity grew faster, so national occupancy fell, but it remained above 100%.

An occupancy rate of 112.2% means roughly 112 people for every 100 places. It does not mean every prison has exactly that crowding. Some are below capacity; others face much greater pressure.

The 2024 values come from NCRB's revision dated 15 September 2026. They count 5,09,012 people. Earlier published 2024 figures quoted elsewhere can differ. This page uses the revised counts and their matching occupancy rate together.

Undertrial prisoners are held while proceedings are ongoing; they have not been convicted in the case for which they are held as undertrials. Their share rose from 67.6% to 72.5%, or 4.9 percentage points. Prison population must not be described as a count of convicted offenders.

The other categories include convicts and people detained under other legal provisions. The undertrial row is part of the total, so adding it to the inmate count would double-count people.

These are year-end snapshots. They do not count everyone admitted over the entire year, and they cannot alone measure sentence length, bail access or conditions inside a particular jail.

The 2024 report was revised in 2026; its observation remains 31 December 2024. Undertrial status is not a finding of guilt. Sources: 16, 17. Full references on pages 26-28.

14 / INFORMATION RIGHTS AND VOTING

Two ways citizens take part.

Requesting public information and casting a vote need different measures.

Measure	Earlier observation	Later observation
RTI application rejection rate	7.21%: 2013-14	3.26%: 2024-25
Lok Sabha total voter turnout	58.21%: 2009	66.10%: 2024

RTI means Right to Information. The Act, passed in 2005, lets people request information from public authorities. The cited rejection rate concerns the Union authorities reporting through the central system. It is not the combined rate for every state authority.

The rejection rate fell by 3.95 percentage points. But an application not rejected is not necessarily a complete, useful answer. The February 2026 reply says separate data on partially answered or unresolved applications are not collected.

The Central Information Commission had 29,034 appeals and 3,577 complaints pending on 1 February 2026. Those are different types of pending matters, not the annual number of RTI applications. A low initial rejection rate can coexist with a queue of disputes.

Turnout is votes cast as a share of registered electors. The Election Commission's atlas shows 58.21% in 2009, 66.44% in 2014, 67.40% in 2019 and 66.10% in 2024. The latest share is above 2009 but below the previous two general elections.

The 2014 election belongs to the transition year, so the table uses 2009 as its pre-2014 observation. The atlas's total includes the final voting record; an earlier polling-day percentage should not replace it without saying the coverage changed.

Participation, access to information, case delays and police capacity each describe one part of institutions. None of these figures is a complete democracy or corruption score. International indices and their methods are examined separately in Part 6.

RTI uses financial years; voting uses the named general election. Turnout is not a share of all residents, because only registered electors form its denominator. Sources: 18, 19. Full references on pages 26-28.

15 / AIR QUALITY

Improvement is not the finish line.

A city can reduce pollution and still fail an air-quality standard.

FY2025-26 result, among 130 NCAP cities	Cities
Lower PM10 than in FY2017-18	108
PM10 reduction greater than 20%	72
PM10 reduction greater than 40%	26
Met Indian annual PM10 standard	14
Met Indian annual PM2.5 standard	65

NCAP is the National Clean Air Programme, launched in 2019. Its comparison uses 2017-18, not 2014. These results describe its 130 cities, not a national average weighted by how many people breathe each city's air.

PM10 is airborne particulate matter up to 10 micrometres across; PM2.5 is the smaller fraction up to 2.5. Their annual averages are measured in micrograms per cubic metre of air. PM2.5 is part of PM10, so the two concentrations should not be added.

The 72 cities with reductions above 20% and the 26 above 40% sit within the 108 improved cities. These groups overlap. Adding 108, 72 and 26 would count many cities repeatedly.

Only 14 met India's annual PM10 limit of 60, compared with six in the baseline year. The annual PM2.5 limit is 40. WHO's 2021 health-based annual guidelines are lower: 15 for PM10 and 5 for PM2.5, in the same units.

For example, the reply gives Delhi an annual PM2.5 value of 102 in 2025-26. That is above both benchmarks. Mumbai's reported value is 33: below India's annual limit but above WHO's guideline. Meeting the Indian standard and meeting the WHO guideline are different results.

An annual average can also hide very polluted days. The count of cities that improved answers whether measured conditions changed against the programme baseline. The standards answer a separate question about the level that remains.

No matched pre-2014 all-India PM average is invented. Programme results and standards are kept separate; lower pollution is not the same as no pollution. Sources: 20, 21. Full references on pages 26-28.

16 / FORESTS AND TREES

More cover. Uneven changes.

The matched national comparison includes gains outside recorded forest areas.

Cover in square kilometres	2013 recomputed	2023 assessment
Forest cover	698,712.36	715,342.61
Tree cover	91,267.00	112,014.34
Combined forest and tree cover	789,979.36	827,356.95
North-East forest cover: subset	172,035.79	168,903.52

FSI, the Forest Survey of India, recomputed the earlier figures for a matched comparison in the 2023 report. Its original 2013 headline was different. Using the revised baseline with the revised endpoint avoids treating a mapping revision as new tree growth.

Forest cover rose by 16,630.25 square kilometres, about 2.38%. Separately measured tree cover rose by 20,747.34, about 22.73%. The combined increase was 37,377.59, or about 4.73%. The combined row already contains the first two.

Forest cover means patches larger than one hectare with at least 10% tree canopy, regardless of ownership, legal status or land use. It includes some orchards and plantations. Tree cover separately measures other tree patches and dispersed trees. More mapped cover is not automatically more old natural forest.

Inside recorded forest areas, the matched forest-cover increase was only 440.47 square kilometres. Outside them it was 16,189.78. Most of the net mapped increase was therefore outside recorded areas. That location alone does not establish the kind or ecological quality of every new patch.

The North-East row is part of the national forest total, not extra cover. Across its eight states, cover fell by 3,132.27 square kilometres. A national increase therefore coexists with a substantial regional loss.

The latest assessment puts combined forest and tree cover at 25.17% of India's land area. This is the 2023 assessment, using imagery from earlier observation periods. It is not a measurement of all forests in October 2026.

Use Chapter 9 for the matched historical figures. Cover, legal forest area, natural-forest quality and biodiversity are distinct measures. Sources: 22. Full references on pages 26-28.

17 / GREENHOUSE GASES

More emissions. Lower intensity.

The total and the amount per unit of economic output can move differently.

Matched climate-report measure	2005	2022
GHG emissions excluding land use, million tonnes CO ₂ -equivalent	About 2,001	About 3,396
Emissions per unit of GDP: index	100	62.62

GHG means greenhouse gases, including carbon dioxide, methane and nitrous oxide. CO₂-equivalent puts their different warming effects into a common unit. These gases are different from the local particle-pollution measure on page 18.

India's first Biennial Transparency Report, submitted in April 2026, puts emissions excluding land use and forestry about 69.7% above 2005 by 2022. The inventory's latest year is 2022. A 2026 submission is not a 2026 emissions observation.

Intensity means emissions per unit of economic output. It fell by 37.38%, so an earlier index of 100 became 62.62. If output doubles while emissions rise by half, the emissions per unit fall by 25%. A growing total and a falling intensity can therefore both be true.

The official climate-pledge baseline is 2005, not 2014. The matched inventory does not provide a 2013 entry. Forests and other land uses remove part of the emissions; including those removals, net national emissions still rose by 57.33% from 2005 to 2022.

The July 2026 reply reports non-fossil electricity capacity at 54.18% on 30 June. Capacity is equipment installed, not its share of electricity actually generated. The intensity-reduction target is 45% by 2030 and 47% by 2035; those targets are future commitments.

The same reply reports an additional forest-and-tree carbon sink of 2.44 billion tonnes of CO₂-equivalent from 2005 to 2022. That is additional stored carbon, not an annual quantity that can simply be subtracted from one year's emissions.

The first row uses report-rounded values; the stated changes use the inventory calculations. Targets, installed capacity, carbon stocks and annual emissions are separate. Sources: 23, 24. Full references on pages 26-28.

One cooler year does not end warming.

Compare temperatures against the same long-term reference.

Calendar year	India annual temperature above 1991-2020 mean
2009	0.40 C
2016	0.54 C
2024	0.65 C
2025	0.28 C

IMD, the India Meteorological Department, compares these years with India's average annual temperature over 1991-2020. The value 0.65 C is a gap above that reference. It is not an outdoor temperature of 65 degrees, or an increase measured only since 2014.

The 2009 observation gives earlier context using the same reference in the latest statement. A matched 2013 value was not verified here, so none is invented. One earlier year's temperature is also not a substitute for a long-term average.

2024 was warmer than 2025 in this measure. Yet 2025 was still the eighth-warmest year in India's record beginning in 1901. Annual temperatures fluctuate; one lower reading does not erase a longer trend.

The 2016-2025 decade was the warmest recorded decade, 0.32 C above the same reference. Across 1901-2025, the reported mean-temperature trend is 0.68 C per 100 years. That is the trend's rate, not a claim that warming began in 2014.

IMD reports 1,274 millimetres of rain in 2025, 110% of the 1971-2020 annual normal. A millimetre measures the depth of rain; 110% means about 10% more than that reference amount. Rainfall uses its own stated baseline, not the temperature baseline.

An annual national average does not tell us where rain fell or whether it arrived in damaging bursts. Heat, floods and drought are local experiences shaped by weather, buildings, land use and preparedness. A warming trend and better disaster protection are different questions, so neither should stand in for the other.

All temperature entries share the 1991-2020 reference. Rainfall uses the report's 1971-2020 normal. Observations stop at 2025. Sources: 25. Full references on pages 26-28.

19 / RIVERS AND SEWAGE

Fewer listed polluted stretches.

The latest river list uses earlier monitoring and a specific pollution test.

CPCB river assessment	Result
2018 report: polluted river stretches	351
2025 report: polluted river stretches	296
2025 report: rivers containing those stretches	271
2025 report: rivers assessed	623

A stretch is a section of a river. One river can have more than one polluted stretch. That is why 296 stretches and 271 affected rivers are different counts, and why neither means all 623 rivers were polluted.

The listed stretch count fell by 55, about 15.7%, against the 2018 report. The 2025 assessment uses water-quality monitoring from 2022-23. Its name is the report year, not a claim that every sample was taken in 2025.

CPCB, the Central Pollution Control Board, identifies these stretches mainly through BOD, biochemical oxygen demand. It measures the oxygen used as microbes break down organic matter. A value above 3 milligrams per litre is the assessment criterion used here.

High BOD can leave less oxygen for aquatic life. Low BOD alone does not prove that water is safe to drink: microbes, metals and other contaminants require their own tests. This list is therefore not a complete map of every kind of water pollution.

Monitoring coverage and stretch boundaries change. The 15.7% fall is a change in the published list, not proof that pollution in every Indian river fell by that percentage. A fair matched pre-2014 nationwide stretch comparison is not supplied here.

Namami Gange created 4,263 million litres per day of sewage-treatment capacity by June 2026. That is potential daily treatment, not the verified volume treated every day. Whether sewage reaches the plant, the plant runs properly and its output meets standards determines the actual benefit.

Latest polluted-stretch counts follow the main assessment tables and the March 2026 parliamentary confirmation. Treatment capacity is kept separate from river-water quality. Sources: 26, 27, 28. Full references on pages 26-28.

20 / GROUNDWATER

The average hides local pressure.

The amount taken out must be compared with the resource assessed as available.

National groundwater measure	2013 assessment	2025 assessment
Annual recharge, billion cubic metres	447	448.52
Net availability / extractable resource	411	407.75
Annual withdrawal, billion cubic metres	253	247.22
Withdrawal / available resource	62%	60.63%
Over-exploited assessment units	1,034 of 6,584	730 of 6,762

Recharge is water replenishing the underground resource. The second row is what the assessment counts as available for use after its deductions. Withdrawal is water taken out. A billion cubic metres is one billion units of 1,000 litres each.

The old headline stage was about 62%; the 2025 stage is 60.63%. It does not mean 60.63% of all underground water has been used up. It compares estimated annual withdrawal with the assessed annual extractable resource.

The 2025 share is lower than the 2013 headline, but slightly above 2024's 60.47%. The most recent change was an increase of 0.16 percentage points. Keeping both comparisons avoids presenting every year as an improvement.

Over-exploited means extraction exceeds the annual resource under the assessment. The share of units so classified fell from about 15.70% to 10.80%. But boundaries, the number of units and assessment methods changed, so this is not an unchanged panel of identical local areas.

In 2025, over-exploited and critical units made up more than a quarter of units in Punjab, Haryana, Rajasthan, Delhi and Tamil Nadu. A manageable-looking national average cannot make a stressed local aquifer safe.

These are estimates, not readings from one giant national underground tank. Rain, recharge, irrigation demand and measurement changes affect them. Water level and water quality also need local evidence.

The 2013 assessment was published in 2017; the 2025 assessment was released in November 2025. Historical methods and availability definitions differ. Sources: 29, 30. Full references on pages 26-28.

21 / URBAN WASTE

Much more waste is reported processed.

Collection, processing and recycling describe different steps.

Reported urban programme indicator	2014 baseline	June 2026 release
Waste processing	16%	82%
Door-to-door collection coverage	43%	98%

The June 2026 government backgrounder reports processing rising from 16% to 82%. That is a gain of 66 percentage points. In the programme's reported waste measure, roughly 16 out of 100 became 82 out of 100.

Collection coverage rose from 43% to 98%, a gain of 55 points. This is the reported urban service indicator. The backgrounder does not spell out its full counting base, so I do not turn it into a claim about 98% of all Indian households.

Collection is getting waste from the point where it is discarded. Processing is handling it through a treatment route. Recycling is recovering material for use again. Waste counted as processed can go through composting, biological treatment, fuel production or other routes; 82% processed does not mean 82% recycled.

The January 2026 ministry reply gave 81.30% processing in its dated administrative record. The June backgrounder reports 82%. Different dates and rounding matter. Neither is presented here as a new October survey.

These are official administrative results, based on programme reporting. They are useful for tracking the reported expansion of services. They do not establish that every collection round happened, that every plant met its standards or that every city performed equally.

New daily waste is a flow. Old waste accumulated in dumps is a stock. A high share of fresh waste processed does not mean every old landfill has been cleared. Cleaner streets, properly treated waste and restored dumpsites require separate evidence.

Urban programme coverage is not all-India rural-and-urban household coverage. Processing and recycling should not be used as interchangeable words. Sources: 31, 32. Full references on pages 26-28.

22 / TIGERS AND WETLANDS

Recovery and recognition grew.

Animal estimates and protected-site designations are different kinds of progress.

Conservation measure	Earlier observation	Later observation
Estimated wild tigers	2,226: 2014	3,682: 2022
Tiger reserves	46: 2014	58: July 2026
Ramsar-designated wetlands	26: 2014	101: August 2026

The estimated tiger population rose by about 65.4% from 2014 to 2022. The earlier census belongs to the transition year, not a fully pre-2014 year. The latest estimation verified in the July 2026 update still describes 2022.

The final 2022 estimate is 3,682. The earlier minimum estimate of 3,167 covered camera-trapped areas; further analysis included other tiger-presence areas. Those are two stages of the same estimation, not two different annual populations.

This is a scientific estimate using field work, camera traps and modelling. It is not an exact headcount of every tiger alive on the day of publication. The final report also gives an upper estimate of 3,925.

The reserve network expanded from 46 to 58. More reserves mean more sites designated for tiger conservation; the count alone does not describe their size, condition or links between habitats. Project Tiger began in 1973, so the conservation story long predates 2014.

Ramsar sites are wetlands recognised as internationally important under the Convention on Wetlands. The count reached 101 with Glaw Lake in Arunachal Pradesh in August 2026. It was 26 in 2014. The increase is in recognised sites, not proof that India gained 75 entirely new wetlands.

These are substantial gains in the measured indicators. They do not establish that every species or ecosystem recovered. The tiger report describes local declines too. Water quality, habitat connections and pressure on people living around protected areas remain part of conservation.

All three measures keep their own dates. The tiger estimate is 2022; reserve and Ramsar counts are dated 2026 updates. Part 6 follows with rankings and wider chart checks. Sources: 33, 34, 35. Full references on pages 26-28.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

01 MisterLove / Lovepreet Singh

Public author profile and editorial theme

Website checked 3 October 2026. Byline and public interests.

02 The Matrix India

Scheduled Tribe crime chart supplied by the reader

The 2024 chart is checked against NCRB Table 7C.1 on pages 8-10.

03 National Crime Records Bureau

Crime in India, 2013

Original NCRB report, preserved by LatestLaws. Snapshots and chapter totals.

04 National Crime Records Bureau

Crime in India, 2024: Volume I

National snapshots; overall crime, murder, women and children.

05 National Crime Records Bureau

Crime in India, 2024: Volume II

Tables 7A.1, 7C.1 and cybercrime tables; population and scope notes.

06 National Crime Records Bureau

Crime in India, 2024: Volume III

Court disposal and publication changes, including excluded crime heads.

07 Ministry of Home Affairs

Implementation of the New Criminal Laws

25 July 2026. Laws implemented from 1 July 2024.

08 Ministry of Home Affairs

Measures Against Cybercrime

28 July 2026. Cumulative funds saved and complaints to 30 June 2026.

09 Ministry of Road Transport and Highways

Road Accidents in India, 2024

Original ministry report mirrored by OpenCity. Table 1.6, historical series.

10 National Crime Records Bureau

Accidental Deaths and Suicides in India, 2024

Original NCRB report mirrored by OpenCity. Table 2.1 and suicide snapshots.

11 Ministry of Home Affairs

Rise in Suicide Cases: Rajya Sabha Q359

26 November 2014. Annexure gives 2013 count and rate.

12 Ministry of Home Affairs

Police Vacancies: Lok Sabha Q23

21 July 2015. Sanctioned and actual police strength on 1 January 2014.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

13 Bureau of Police Research and Development

[Data on Police Organizations, 2024](#)

Observation: 1 January 2024. State/UT strength, vacancies and women.

14 Department of Justice

[Parliamentary Replies, 2014: Rajya Sabha Q266](#)

25 July 2014; PDF pp42-43. Court pendency on 31 December 2013.

15 Department of Justice

[Court Pendency and e-Courts: Lok Sabha Q3371](#)

7 August 2026 reply, mirrored original PDF. NJDG snapshot: 30 July 2026.

16 National Crime Records Bureau

[Prison Statistics India, 2013](#)

Capacity, inmates and undertrials at 31 December 2013.

17 National Crime Records Bureau

[Prison Statistics India, 2024: Revised Edition](#)

Version dated 15 September 2026. Tables and charts for 31 December 2024.

18 Department of Personnel and Training

[Disposal of RTI Applications](#)

12 February 2026. Union authorities, rejection rates and CIC pending cases.

19 Election Commission of India

[Atlas of Lok Sabha Elections, 2024](#)

Page 93, Table 29.1. Total voter turnout, 2009-2024.

20 Environment Ministry

[National Clean Air Programme: Parliament Reply](#)

23 July 2026. FY2025-26 city results against FY2017-18.

21 World Health Organization

[Air Pollutants and Air-Quality Guidelines](#)

2021 annual guideline values: PM2.5 and PM10; health-based benchmarks.

22 Forest Survey of India

[India State of Forest Report, 2023: Volume I](#)

Chapter 9 gives recomputed 2013 comparisons. Chapter 1 defines forest cover.

23 Government of India / UNFCCC

[First Biennial Transparency Report, 2026](#)

Submitted April 2026. Matched GHG inventory for 2005, 2020, 2021 and 2022.

[Preserved copy of the same government report](#)

24 Environment Ministry

[India's Nationally Determined Contribution Targets](#)

27 July 2026. Measured progress, 2030 targets and enhanced 2035 targets.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

25 India Meteorological Department

[Statement on the Climate of India, 2025](#)

1 January 2026. Same 1991–2020 temperature baseline for the stated anomalies.

26 Central Pollution Control Board

[Polluted River Stretches for Restoration, 2025](#)

Assessment uses 2022–23 monitoring; BOD criterion and river coverage.

27 Jal Shakti Ministry

[Water Quality of Indian Rivers](#)

16 March 2026. Confirms 351 stretches in 2018 and 296 in the 2025 report.

28 Jal Shakti Ministry

[Namami Gange: Sewage Treatment Capacity](#)

August 2026 reply. Capacity created to June 2026; not actual daily treatment.

29 Central Ground Water Board

[Dynamic Ground Water Resources, 2013](#)

Published June 2017; assessment as on 31 March 2013.

30 Jal Shakti Ministry

[Groundwater Assessment, 2025: Year-End Review](#)

30 December 2025. Recharge, extraction and categories of assessment units.

31 Press Information Bureau

[Twelve Years of Public Services: Waste Indicators](#)

8 June 2026. Urban processing and door-to-door collection comparisons.

32 Housing and Urban Affairs Ministry

[Swachh Bharat Mission Urban: Waste Processing](#)

29 January 2026. Reported urban waste generation and processing.

33 Environment Ministry / NTCA

[Final All India Tiger Estimation, 2022](#)

29 July 2023 release. Historical estimates and final 2022 estimate.

July 2026 update: latest estimation and 58 reserves

34 Environment Ministry

[Glaw Lake: India's 101st Ramsar Site](#)

3 August 2026. Matched comparison: 26 sites in 2014 and 101 in August 2026.

35 Press Information Bureau / Environment Ministry

[India's Green Transformation](#)

4 June 2026. Historical tiger estimate, reserves and conservation programmes.

A REPORT CARD IN PLAIN ENGLISH

India, before and after 2014

States, rankings and chart checks

*What changed. What the numbers mean.
What still needs a closer look.*

PART SIX OF SIX

Written by Lovepreet Singh

misterlove.in / Research cut-off: 3 October 2026

A NOTE FROM THE AUTHOR

One country. Many different lives.

The last part asks what the national headlines leave out.

I wanted this report to answer a simple question: what changed in India, and what do those changes mean for someone living here? A long list of impressive numbers is easy to share. Understanding which numbers belong together takes more patience.

For me, that patience matters. I write about ideas, research and public life through MisterLove. I want a reader to understand a figure without needing a degree, a party membership or a glossary beside every sentence. That is why I have kept the explanations direct.

A person can benefit from a new road and still struggle to find steady work. A state can become less poor and still have many families facing hardship. A country can build more hospitals while questions about quality, access and freedom remain. These experiences can exist together.

This final volume brings the states and international rankings into the picture. It also returns to the Matrix India charts. All 15 economic rows and all 23 rows of the supplied infrastructure chart appear with an explanation. The Scheduled Tribe crime chart's 36-place check is in Part 5; its key corrections are carried forward here.

I also examine selected consumption, growth, income, railway and defence posts from the same account. Where the underlying annual data or a clear definition could not be established, I say so. This is a report built from the identified charts and published sources, not a complete archive of everything the account has posted.

I have not given India one final mark. There is no honest arithmetic that turns roads, hunger, jobs and civil rights into a single grade without choosing whose needs count more. I would rather show the evidence clearly and let you form a view with the facts in front of you.

Lovepreet Singh

misterlove.in

Research frozen at 3 October 2026. A report published in 2026 may describe an earlier year. Missing comparisons remain missing. Sources: 01, 02, 42. Full references on pages 26-28.

HOW TO FIND WHAT YOU NEED

Your map through the final part.

Start with a subject. Read its dates before reading its rank.

Pages	Subject	What the pages explain
4-7	Rankings and states	Rank versus score; state income; all 36 state/UT poverty and SDG figures.
8-11	People and daily life	Human development, gender gaps, hunger and life satisfaction.
12-13	Innovation and business	Innovation, logistics and the discontinued Doing Business ranking.
14-16	Public institutions	Perceived corruption, press freedom, political rights and the rule of law.
17	Environment and SDGs	Two global indices, and why their scores need their own methods.
18-19	Economic chart	All 15 original rows, including the newly resolved current-account figure.
20-22	Infrastructure chart	All 23 original rows, with dates, definitions and delivery stages.
23-25	Other Matrix posts	ST crime corrections; rail and defence cautions; consumption, growth and income.
26-28	Sources	Numbered links to the reports, original charts and companion documents.

Parts 1 to 5 cover the economy; infrastructure; health and education; farming, industry, science and defence; and crime, institutions and the environment. Their tables explain the underlying national figures in more detail. This part adds the comparisons and chart checks.

A financial year such as 2025-26 runs from April 2025 to March 2026. A survey period such as 2019-21 covers fieldwork across those years. An estimate can be revised. A forecast describes what may happen. These labels change the meaning of the number.

The six volumes total 168 pages: 28 + 28 + 32 + 24 + 28 + 28. Page references in this map refer to Part 6.

01 / RANK AND SCORE

A rank is a place in a queue.

A score tells you more about what was measured.

Imagine three runners. You finish a race in 12 minutes, then improve to 11 minutes next year. If two other runners improve even more, you can move from second to third while running faster. A country's rank works like that: it depends on everyone else too.

A score is the measured result under an index's rules. A rank sorts those scores. Being 100th does not mean scoring 100 points. A rank of 100 among 120 countries also differs from 100 among 190. Always keep the number of countries beside the rank.

The direction matters. Higher HDI and corruption-perception scores are better. Lower hunger scores are better. Rank 1 normally leads the list. Old press-freedom scores used the opposite direction from today's scale, so comparing their raw values would reverse the meaning.

Methods matter as well. Adding an indicator, changing a weight or improving a data source can move a score without an equally large change in everyday conditions. Where possible, use a single report's recalculated history. That applies the same framework to the earlier and later years.

A report's year is another label, not an observation date. India's latest HDI in this report was published in 2025 and describes 2023. Happiness in the 2026 edition averages 2023-2025. Writing all of those as 'India today' would hide the delay.

Finally, ask who publishes the index. UNDP, the World Bank, a research network and a civil-society organisation have different mandates and methods. Naming the publisher lets you assess its choices. A ranking is useful evidence about its subject; it is not a measurement of every part of India.

The following pages therefore keep the publisher, date, score where verified, country coverage and comparison limit together. No rank is turned into a percentage of Indians who are happy, honest, hungry or free.

Examples explain the arithmetic; they are not estimates of Indian conditions. The latest verified edition is used at the stated research cutoff. Sources: 06, 07, 10, 11, 13, 19, 21. Full references on pages 26-28.

02 / DIFFERENCES BETWEEN STATES

The national average hides a lot.

Start with income, then look at poverty and development together.

Annual income per person	2013-14	2024-25
Bihar	Rs 26,948	Rs 69,321
Uttar Pradesh	Rs 41,137	Rs 1,08,572
Punjab	Rs 1,03,831	Rs 2,21,197
Karnataka	Rs 1,18,829	Rs 3,80,906
Tamil Nadu	Rs 1,16,960	Rs 3,61,619
Delhi (UT)	Rs 2,27,900	Rs 4,93,024

These are RBI's per capita net state domestic product figures at each year's prices, from its 2024-25 handbook. They are annual averages, not wages. Inflation is included. Delhi's later figure is about seven times Bihar's; it does not mean every Delhi resident earns seven times every Bihar resident.

The next two pages show all 28 states and eight union territories. MPI means multidimensional poverty: overlapping shortages in health, education and living conditions. A resident counts as poor here if their household faces at least one-third of the weighted deprivations across 12 indicators.

India's MPI headcount fell from 24.85% in 2015-16 to 14.96% in 2019-21. That is a fall of 9.89 percentage points. These survey dates are both after 2014; this is not a 2014-to-2026 comparison. Rural figures fell from 32.59% to 19.28%; urban figures from 8.65% to 5.27%.

The last column is NITI's SDG India Index score for 2023-24. Higher means closer to the chosen development targets; lower MPI means fewer residents meet the poverty definition. The columns have different dates and methods. They should not be added into a personal mark for a state.

Income uses a common FY2024-25 snapshot, not the latest economic survey of every state. The poverty table uses survey observations, not later projected poverty estimates. Sources: 03, 04, 05. Full references on pages 26-28.

03 / ALL STATES AND UNION TERRITORIES

Where the state figures stand.

Sorted by the 2019-21 poverty share, from lower to higher.

State or union territory	MPI poor % 2015-16	MPI poor % 2019-21	SDG score 2023-24
Kerala	0.70	0.55	79
Goa	3.76	0.84	77
Puducherry (UT)	1.71	0.85	74
Lakshadweep (UT)	1.82	1.11	66
Tamil Nadu	4.76	2.20	78
Andaman & Nicobar Islands (UT)	4.29	2.30	70
Sikkim	3.82	2.60	76
Delhi (UT)	4.44	3.43	70
Chandigarh (UT)	5.97	3.52	77
Ladakh (UT)	12.70	3.53	65
Punjab	5.57	4.75	76
Jammu & Kashmir (UT)	12.56	4.80	74
Himachal Pradesh	7.59	4.93	77
Mizoram	9.78	5.30	72
Telangana	13.18	5.88	74
Andhra Pradesh	11.77	6.06	74
Haryana	11.88	7.07	72
Karnataka	12.77	7.58	75

Read Kerala's 0.55 as about 0.55 residents in every 100 meeting this poverty definition in the survey. It is not a claim that nobody there struggles. An SDG score of 79 is a composite result, not 79% of residents being wealthy.

UT means union territory. MPI is a resident headcount share; SDG is a 0-100 index. Current geographic units follow the reports, including retrospective split/merged-unit baselines. This ordering is not an overall state ranking. Sources: 03, 04, 05. Full references on pages 26-28.

04 / ALL STATES AND UNION TERRITORIES

The state table, continued.

Sorted by the 2019-21 poverty share, from lower to higher.

State or union territory	MPI poor % 2015-16	MPI poor % 2019-21	SDG score 2023-24
Maharashtra	14.80	7.81	73
Manipur	16.96	8.10	72
Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu (UT)	19.58	9.21	66
Uttarakhand	17.67	9.67	79
Gujarat	18.47	11.66	74
West Bengal	21.29	11.89	70
Tripura	16.62	13.11	71
Arunachal Pradesh	24.23	13.76	65
Rajasthan	28.86	15.31	67
Nagaland	25.16	15.43	63
Odisha	29.34	15.68	66
Chhattisgarh	29.90	16.37	67
Assam	32.65	19.35	65
Madhya Pradesh	36.57	20.63	67
Uttar Pradesh	37.68	22.93	67
Meghalaya	32.54	27.79	63
Jharkhand	42.10	28.81	62
Bihar	51.89	33.76	57

Bihar's poverty share fell by 18.13 points but remained 33.76%. A large improvement and a high remaining burden can both be true. The national SDG score was 71; Kerala and Uttarakhand scored 79, while Bihar scored 57.

UT means union territory. MPI is a resident headcount share; SDG is a 0-100 index. Current geographic units follow the reports, including retrospective split/merged-unit baselines. This ordering is not an overall state ranking. Sources: 03, 04, 05. Full references on pages 26-28.

05 / HUMAN DEVELOPMENT

A longer, better-equipped life.

UNDP combines health, schooling and income in the HDI.

Published edition	India rank	Score / observation
Human Development Report 2013	136 / 187	0.554; year 2012
Human Development Report 2025	130 / 193	0.685; year 2023

HDI means Human Development Index. It combines life expectancy, expected and completed schooling, and income per person adjusted for differences in purchasing power. Its scale runs from 0 to 1. Higher is better. It asks whether people have more scope to live, learn and support themselves.

The two published scores above are different statistical vintages. UNDP revises data and historical estimates. Subtracting 0.554 from 0.685 would treat those revisions as if all of them were new progress. Use a matched series for the change over time.

Same revised HDR2025 series	2013	2023
India HDI	0.615	0.685

Within that series, HDI rose by 0.070, about 11.4% of its earlier value. This is an index change; it does not mean every person's life improved by 11.4%. India remains in UNDP's medium human-development category in the latest assessment.

The 2023 components include life expectancy of about 72 years, expected schooling of 13 years and average completed schooling of 6.9 years for adults. Expected schooling concerns a child entering education; completed schooling concerns adults. The two figures answer different questions.

HDI is an average. UNDP's inequality-adjusted result is 0.475, about 30.7% below the headline HDI. That gap shows how uneven achievements reduce the combined measure. It is not a count of people in poverty, and it does not say which individual benefited most.

Latest verified HDI edition: 2025, using 2023 observations. UNDP modelled life expectancy and India's domestic SRS estimate are different series; they should not be spliced. Sources: 06, 07. Full references on pages 26-28.

06 / GENDER GAPS

Opportunity and equality.

Parity is a comparison between sexes, not a measure of absolute opportunity.

Gender Gap Report	India rank	Gap closed: score
2013	101 / 136	65.5%
2026	131 / 145	64.5%

The World Economic Forum compares women's and men's outcomes in economic participation, education, health and political empowerment. A score of 64.5% means that share of the measured parity gap is closed under its rules. It does not mean 64.5% of Indian women have jobs or are treated equally.

Dimension score	2013	2026
Economic participation and opportunity	44.6%	41.2%
Educational attainment	85.7%	96.6%
Health and survival	93.1%	95.6%
Political empowerment	38.5%	24.5%

Educational parity improved strongly in these published profiles. Economic and political parity remain much lower. A country's total rank can therefore look poor even when school participation between sexes becomes more equal.

Parity is relative. If both women and men have weak access to a service, their ratio can still look equal. This index therefore does not replace the health, learning or wage levels examined in the earlier volumes. Equality and a good overall level are separate aims.

Political empowerment includes a rolling measure of years with a female head of state over the past 50 years. Older years dropping out of that window can change the score. It is not simply the proportion of women who voted or who held a local office in 2026.

The 2026 report was released on 16 September and draws on indicators from different years. Country coverage also changed. Read the scores alongside the rank: a 30-place drop is not a 30% decline in women's lives.

Displayed scores are rounded. These are published edition comparisons, not a newly reconstructed common-indicator panel. Sources: 08, 09. Full references on pages 26-28.

07 / HUNGER AND NUTRITION

The hunger rank needs its history.

The newer method does not measure hunger in the same way as 2013.

Global Hunger Index edition	India rank	Score
2013: original method	63 / 78 ranked	21.3
2025: current method	102 / 123 ranked	25.8: serious

GHI combines undernourishment, child wasting, child stunting and child mortality. Wasting means too little weight for height; stunting means too little height for age. Its score runs from 0 toward 100, with lower better. It is not the percentage of all Indians who went without dinner.

In 2013, countries with very low scores were listed separately rather than given individual ranks in the main list. The method changed in 2015, including replacing child underweight with wasting and stunting. The original 21.3 and today's 25.8 are therefore not a fair before-and-after score pair.

Recomputed inside the 2025 report	2008	2016	2025
India GHI score	34.6	29.3	25.8

This matched history points to improvement, while the remaining 25.8 is still classified as serious. It does not supply a matched 2013 score. A falling score and a low international rank can coexist.

The 2025 inputs include about 12.0% undernourishment, 18.7% child wasting, 32.9% child stunting and 2.8% under-five mortality. They cover different earlier periods; wasting uses NFHS-5. They are not four 2025 surveys, and they are not meant to be added. Later NFHS-6 findings do not retroactively become inputs to this edition.

The Indian government has challenged the index's method, including the weight given to child outcomes in a population-wide label. That criticism should be read alongside the publishers' explanation. Administrative nutrition records and representative household surveys also have different coverage. Method disagreements do not make the directly measured nutrition problems disappear.

Latest edition verified at the cutoff: 2025. Component percentages are rounded and come from the report's separate source periods. No 2026 GHI result is assumed. Sources: 10, 11. Full references on pages 26-28.

08 / HAPPINESS

How people rate their own lives.

The question concerns life as a whole, not how often someone smiles.

World Happiness Report	India rank	Life-evaluation score
2013: average 2010-2012	111 / 156	4.772 / 10
2026: average 2023-2025	116 / 147	4.536 / 10

Respondents imagine a ladder with their worst possible life at 0 and their best possible life at 10. They say where their own life stands. The ranking sorts country averages of those answers. India's 4.536 is therefore an average assessment, not 45.36% of people being happy.

The latest average is about 0.236 points below the older one. Survey years and country coverage differ, and samples carry uncertainty. This is a descriptive comparison of two published survey windows, not proof of what one government caused.

The 2026 data give India's score a confidence interval of roughly 4.470 to 4.601. That range represents sampling uncertainty under the report's calculation. Nearby scores and ranks should not be treated as precise differences between whole populations.

The report also uses income, social support, healthy life expectancy, freedom to make choices, generosity and perceived corruption to help explain country differences. Those factors are not six ingredients added together to manufacture the ranking. The ranking itself comes from people's ladder answers.

The 2025 edition put India at 118, with a score of 4.389. The 2026 edition is better on both figures. That recent improvement can exist alongside a lower score than the much earlier 2013 survey window. Choosing only one comparison can hide the other.

Country averages conceal differences by age, income, health, region and social circumstances. A low rank is not a diagnosis of depression, and a high rank does not mean nobody is lonely or struggling. For daily life, the survey is a useful extra lens beside jobs, safety, health and relationships.

The 2026 workbook labels the latest window by its final survey year, 2025. It is not a ranking from interviews conducted only in 2026. Sources: 12, 13. Full references on pages 26-28.

09 / INNOVATION

More ideas reaching useful output.

WIPO measures the conditions for innovation and its results.

Global Innovation Index	Overall rank	Inputs / outputs ranks
2013	66 / 142	87 / 42
2026	38 / 139	49 / 25

Innovation means turning knowledge and ideas into useful products, processes and services. WIPO's index brings together roughly 80 indicators. Inputs include institutions, research, skills, infrastructure and finance. Outputs include technology, knowledge and creative results.

India's position improved substantially between the published editions. In 2026, its output rank is stronger than its input rank: 25 compared with 49. That means the index places India higher for its measured results than for its measured supporting conditions.

India is first among the 36 lower-middle-income economies and first among the 11 economies in Central and Southern Asia in this edition. Those are subgroup ranks. They can coexist with being 38th overall because the overall table also includes richer economies and other regions.

The profile gives a statistical rank interval of 34 to 39. Data availability, indicators and the model can change between editions. Moving from 66 to 38 does not translate into '42% more innovative', nor does it establish the value of every invention.

India's 2026 strengths include ICT services exports, domestic market scale and later-stage venture-capital activity. Weaker relative indicators include researchers per million people, secondary pupil-teacher ratios and knowledge-intensive employment. A strong headline can therefore contain specific areas that still need work.

A patent count is another measure. Applications are requests; grants are legal approvals. Neither is automatically a successful product or a secure job. Part 4 explains patents, research spending and scientific publications separately, so this combined rank does not have to carry the entire science story.

Rank 1 is best. The 2026 country profile is used for the latest ranks and its uncertainty interval; no cross-edition score-growth percentage is calculated. Sources: 14, 15. Full references on pages 26-28.

10 / LOGISTICS AND BUSINESS RULES

Goods and business rules.

One index continues. Another was stopped.

Logistics Performance Index	India rank	Score / 5
2012: before 2014	46 / 155	3.08
2014: transition year	54 / 160	3.08
2023: latest verified edition	38 / 139	3.40

The World Bank's LPI asks logistics professionals about customs, infrastructure, international shipments, service quality, tracking and timeliness. India's latest score is higher than in 2012. In 2014, the same displayed score had a worse rank, showing why the place in the list and the measured result are different.

LPI includes expert perceptions and survey uncertainty. It is not the number of ports, kilometres of road or delivery cost for every trader. The 2023 edition is the latest verified here, so it should not be labelled a new 2026 measurement.

Doing Business edition	India rank	Observation
2014: published in 2013	134 / 189	Mainly June 2013
2020: final published edition	63 / 190	2019 conditions

Doing Business measured selected regulations through standardised business cases, mainly in Delhi and Mumbai for India. The rank improvement was large, but the index did not measure every business's experience, all states, corruption as a whole or the quality of employment.

The frequently quoted old rank of 142 comes from the 2015 edition, released in 2014. It is not the same starting observation as the 2014 edition above. A publication year and its title year can differ.

The World Bank discontinued Doing Business in September 2021 after concerns about data irregularities in reports. There is no current Doing Business rank of 63 in 2026. The newer Business Ready project uses a different framework and should not be joined to this old series as if the measure never changed.

Doing Business 2020 is a historical result, not a present-day ranking. Its discontinuation does not by itself prove that the India figures were manipulated. Sources: 16, 17, 18. Full references on pages 26-28.

11 / PERCEIVED CORRUPTION

Public-sector corruption.

Transparency International measures perceptions, with a defined scope.

Corruption Perceptions Index	India rank	Score / 100
2013	94 / 177	36
2024	96 / 180	38
2025: released in 2026	91 / 182	39

CPI combines assessments from experts and business sources about perceived public-sector corruption. Here, 0 means highly corrupt and 100 means very clean. A higher score is better. India's latest 39 is above its 2013 score of 36, but still low on this scale.

The score does not count individual bribes. It does not mean 39% of officials are honest, or that 61% of all Indians are corrupt. It is also not a complete measure of corruption in private companies, illicit money flows or every transaction a citizen encounters.

Transparency International's score framework is designed for comparisons from 2012 onward. The three-point rise from 2013 is therefore more informative than simply comparing ranks with different country counts. Even so, a small change should be read with the sources' uncertainty, rather than automatically called statistically meaningful.

The 2025 score is one point above 2024 and the rank is five places better. That is the recent published movement. It does not establish a long, uninterrupted improvement: there are intermediate years, and a national perception index can miss very different experiences across offices and regions.

More prosecutions can mean more corruption, more detection, stronger enforcement or a combination. Fewer complaints can mean less corruption or harder reporting. Those administrative counts answer different questions from this index and need their own interpretation.

Direct experience matters too: does a service arrive without an unofficial payment, can citizens scrutinise contracts, and do complaints lead to fair action? Those questions show how institutions work alongside the broad perception score.

CPI 2025 is the latest verified edition at the cutoff. Rank 1 is best; score 100 is the cleanest end of the scale. Sources: 19. Full references on pages 26-28.

12 / PRESS FREEDOM

Freedom to report the news.

RSF assesses whether journalists can work freely and safely.

World Press Freedom Index	India rank	Score treatment
2013	140 / 179	41.22; lower was better
2025	151 / 180	32.96; higher is better
2026	157 / 180	31.96; higher is better

Reporters Without Borders, or RSF, examines political, economic, legal and social conditions, along with safety. It uses expert questionnaires and records of abuses affecting journalists and media. The index asks whether journalists can gather and publish news independently, without serious obstacles or threats.

In the latest edition, India's score fell by one point and its rank moved down six places from 2025. These adjacent editions use the current framework. RSF's assessment places India low in the global list.

A major methodological overhaul took effect in 2022. The older score also ran in the opposite direction. An old and new raw score should therefore not be subtracted to calculate a precise decline since 2013. The historical rank is context; it is not a controlled experiment across an unchanged questionnaire.

The publisher is a press-freedom organisation, not an Indian official statistical office. Its definitions, expert selection, evidence and weighting deserve examination. Naming those choices is more useful than assuming any international rank is either unquestionable or worthless.

Having many newspapers, television channels or internet users does not by itself settle press freedom. The relevant questions include who can investigate powerful actors, whether ownership or advertising pressures shape coverage and whether reporters face violence, detention or intimidation.

This is an assessment of the wider operating environment. It does not declare every article false or every journalist unsafe. Read it alongside evidence about incidents, laws, ownership and access to information.

Historical and current methods are distinguished. Current scores are on a 0-100 scale with higher better; no numerical 2013-to-2026 score change is asserted. Sources: 20, 21. Full references on pages 26-28.

13 / RIGHTS AND THE RULE OF LAW

Rights, power and justice.

Votes, checks on power and access to justice need their own evidence.

Freedom House edition	India assessment	Scoring system
2013	Free	Rights 2; liberties 3: old 1-7 ratings
2026	Partly Free	62 / 100; higher is better

Freedom House's 2026 score splits into 31 of 40 for political rights and 31 of 60 for civil liberties. It mainly covers 2025 events, not the percentage of citizens allowed to vote.

The 2013 ratings used 1 as best and 7 as worst. They cannot be converted into a made-up old 100-point score. Freedom House also assesses Indian Kashmir separately, so its India country entry has a stated territorial scope. This is not a single undifferentiated score for every Indian territory.

WJP Rule of Law Index, 2025	India global rank
Overall	86 / 143
Open government	43 / 143
Fundamental rights	103 / 143
Civil justice	114 / 143

The World Justice Project uses household and legal-expert surveys. Its eight areas cover limits on government power, corruption, open government, rights, security, enforcement, civil justice and criminal justice. One overall rank conceals India's variation across them.

WJP says India's overall score decreased 1.7% from the previous edition. A matched pre-2014 overall score has not been established here. None is invented. The latest verified edition is 2025; an expected 2026 release is not treated as already published.

Part 5 gives direct Indian records on courts, prisons, policing and elections. These international assessments add their own questions and methods. Voting turnout, rights and justice each need their own evidence.

Freedom House does not give the simple ordinal global rank used by the other tables. WJP rank 1 is best. No fake old overall rule-of-law rank is supplied. Sources: 22, 23. Full references on pages 26-28.

14 / ENVIRONMENT AND GLOBAL GOALS

Environment and development.

Two indices ask different questions and cannot share a score.

Environmental Performance Index	India rank	Comparison limit
2012	125 / 132	Old indicator framework
2026	176 / 177	Score 22.46 / 100

Yale's EPI combines environmental health, ecosystems and climate results. In 2026, India's air-quality rank is 175 and its score is 7.89: serious weaknesses under the chosen indicators.

Methods changed since 2012, so the rank difference cannot measure a precise deterioration. Inside the 2026 model, the publisher reports a ten-year overall score gain of 7.47 points. Poor current performance and improvement from a low baseline can coexist.

Part 5 gives the direct evidence on air, rivers, forests, emissions and groundwater. Installed renewable capacity is equipment; an emissions indicator measures a different result.

Global SDG Index, SDSN	India result
2026 overall rank	94 / 169
2026 composite score	68.33 / 100
Pre-2014 SDG Index baseline	None: goals adopted in 2015

SDSN, the Sustainable Development Solutions Network, tracks progress toward the 17 global goals. Its research index is not an official UN ranking or a percentage of people counted as developed.

Its 68.33 differs from NITI's 71 because methods, indicators and targets differ. The goals began in 2015, so there is no 2013 SDG rank. The 2026 report combines observations from different earlier years.

The underlying issue still needs its own evidence: breathable air, healthy children or reliable water. A stronger result in one area cannot erase a weaker result elsewhere by simple addition.

EPI and SDSN are separate publishers and models. Their scores are not percentages of Indians enjoying a good environment or a developed life. Sources: 24, 25, 26. Full references on pages 26-28.

15 / ECONOMIC CHART: ROWS 1-8

Read the pair with its missing label.

Original Matrix figures first; the source explanation follows.

Original chart: earlier -> later	What the comparison means
Real GDP growth: 4.7% -> 7.6%	4.7% is an old 2004-05 framework reading. The revised 2011-12 series gives 6.4% for 2013-14. New 2026 estimates use another base; the displayed pair is not one unchanged series.
Inflation: 9.5% -> 2.1%	9.5% is an annual-average CPI reading. A matched FY2025-26 annual 2.1% is not independently established here. August 2026 is 4.82%, a monthly annual rate; it cannot replace a whole-year average.
Fiscal deficit / GDP: 4.5% -> 4.4%	Broadly supported for the Centre, including provisional 2025-26 actuals of 4.40%. It is the annual borrowing gap, not accumulated government debt.
Capital spending / total: 11.7% -> 22.1%	22.1% is close to revised Budget amounts; provisional actuals are about 21.8%. The old 11.7% denominator is not independently matched.
Current account / GDP: -1.7% -> -0.6%	Now confirmed: 2013-14 deficit US\$32.4 billion; 2025-26 US\$25.2 billion. RBI reports 0.6% for the later full year. A smaller deficit share, not a surplus.
Gross bank NPA ratio: 4.1% -> 1.8%	Endpoint bank-asset-quality ratios are supported. Recognition, recoveries, write-offs and loan growth all matter. The fall is not entirely cash recovered.
Revenue deficit / GDP: 3.2% -> 1.5%	The provisional 2025-26 ratio is 1.55%. The 2026-27 Budget target is 1.5%. Keep the rounding, financial year and estimate status visible.
Government debt / GDP: 51.6% -> 56.1%	56.1% is a central-debt revised estimate. The old 51.6% is not matched here under one definition and GDP vintage. Centre-only debt is not Centre-plus-state debt.

GDP is annual production; deficits are annual gaps; debt is a stock of obligations. These rows therefore cannot be added together. The current-account release resolves the open item in Part 1, pages 24-25.

The chart labels its endpoints FY2013-14 and FY2025-26; some rows actually need other dates or statuses. Unestablished pairs remain visibly unestablished. Sources: 02, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31. Full references on pages 26-28.

16 / ECONOMIC CHART: ROWS 9-15

The other seven economic rows.

A larger economy, healthier banks and world forecasts are different measures.

Original chart: earlier -> later	What the comparison means
External debt / GDP: 23.3% -> 20.8%	RBI's current historical table gives 23.9% for March 2014; June 2026 gives 20.8%. Keep the revision and dates. External debt includes more than government borrowing.
Import cover: 8 -> 10 months	The reserve date and denominator are missing. Goods-only imports and goods-plus-services imports produce different cover. This exact pair is not certified here.
Bank credit growth: 14% -> 15.9%	Bank of India's 2025-26 annual report cites 15.9% growth in non-food bank credit at March 2026. Matching the old 14%, coverage and merger adjustments remains open.
Subsidies / GDP: 2.2% -> 1.2%	The subsidy categories and GDP vintage need matching. CGA reports Rs 4.54 lakh crore of major subsidies in 2025-26; this is narrower than all welfare support. Exact ratio pair remains open.
World growth: 3.2% -> 3.0%	IMF's July 2026 update forecasts 3.0% global growth for calendar 2026. It is a forecast for the world, not an observed Indian FY2025-26 outcome.
PPP share of world growth: 11% -> 17.5%	This needs the year, country weights and contribution formula. It is not India's share of world GDP, and the exact pair has not been independently reproduced.
Growth rank: major economies 3 -> 1	Define the country group, real versus nominal measure, year and forecast status. Some smaller countries grow faster; this is not rank 1 among every economy on Earth.

PPP means purchasing power parity: adjusting money values for differences in local prices. A contribution to global growth concerns how much an economy adds to a worldwide change. It differs from its share of worldwide output.

Together, pages 18-19 cover all 15 economic chart rows. Where a pair is supported, its meaning is explained. Where its source or definition is still missing, it is not promoted into a verified fact. Two endpoints alone do not divide credit among governments, states, private firms and world conditions.

Import cover, the exact subsidy ratio, PPP contribution and the undefined ranking subgroup remain unresolved. See Part 1 for the fuller economic explanations. Sources: 02, 29, 32. Full references on pages 26-28.

17 / INFRASTRUCTURE CHART: ROWS 1-8

More assets. Read what was counted.

The chart mixes commissioned routes, registrations, capacity and annual cargo.

Original chart: earlier -> later	Dated evidence and explanation
Freight corridors: 0 -> 2,843 km	Eastern plus Western DFC: 2,843 km reported commissioned in 2026. Zero means none of these corridors commissioned before 2014; project preparation and DFCCIL began earlier.
Recognised startups: 500 -> 2.30 lakh	Recognition began in 2016; 452 were recognised that year. September 2026 reports about 2.54 lakh. The old 500 is not a matched pre-2014 official-recognition count.
Solar power: 2.6 -> 162 GW	MNRE: 2.822 GW in March 2014 -> 168.040 GW in August 2026. Installed generating capacity, not electricity produced throughout the year.
Defence exports: Rs 700 -> 38,424 crore	Official annual values: Rs 686 crore in 2013-14 -> Rs 38,424 crore in 2025-26. The older chart value is rounded; exports are money values, not weapon headcounts.
Inland cargo: 29 -> 218 MMT	Matched ministry table: about 18 MMT in 2013-14 -> 218.24 in 2025-26. The old 29 was not reproduced on that same scope. Annual goods carried, not waterways built.
Expressways: 1,000 -> 6,700 km	This broad pair was not reproduced. The defined national high-speed-corridor series is 93 km in 2014 -> 3,644 km in June 2026. Different road categories cannot be joined.
National Waterways: 5 -> 32	Five is an earlier legally designated count. Operational waterways rose from 3 to 32; legally designated waterways became 111. Legal status and operation differ.
Domestic PNG: 25 lakh -> 1.6 crore	August 2026 stock: 1.74 crore connections. A connection is not proof of regular gas use. PNGRB separately reports connected and billed households.

MMT means million metric tonnes. GW measures generating capacity. A lakh is 1,00,000; a crore is 1,00,00,000. Units describe what grew, so they belong beside the numbers.

Rows follow the original infrastructure chart order. Full explanations and longer primary-source lists appear in Parts 2 and 4. Sources: 02, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 39, 40. Full references on pages 26-28.

18 / INFRASTRUCTURE CHART: ROWS 9-16

Connections and projects need stages.

A sanctioned asset, an operating service and a measured result are different.

Original chart: earlier -> later	Dated evidence and explanation
Rural taps: 17% -> 80%	Baseline 16.72% is August 2019, not 2014. August 2026 reported coverage is 82.24%. A recorded connection differs from reliable, safe water every day.
Renewables: 54 -> 248 GW	Use the same hydro rule. Inclusive retrospective series: 76.38 GW in March 2014 -> 295.554 GW in August 2026. The 54-to-248 pair is not certified on one common definition.
Metro: 250 -> 1,000 km	Official rounded historical pair: 248 km in 2014 -> 1,155 km in March 2026. A longer operating network does not count annual passengers or affordability.
Port capacity: 800 -> 2,760 MTPA	Matched all-port capacity: 1,400 MTPA in 2013-14 -> 2,818 in 2025-26. Actual cargo was about 972 -> 1,668 MT. The old 800 has unmatched scope.
Rail electrification: 21,800 -> 69,800 km	2026 retrospective series: 21,801 -> 69,873 route km. An older 2013-14 publication gives 21,614; source vintage matters. Electrified routes do not mean zero railway emissions.
AIIMS: 8 -> 23	The later 23 counts Delhi plus 22 new projects. Of the new projects in September 2026: 6 fully functional, 12 with clinical services, 1 with MBBS only, and 3 at other stages.
MBBS seats: 51,348 -> 1,39,000	Official August 2026 comparison: 51,348 -> 1,39,864 seats. Annual intake capacity is not that many additional doctors already treating patients.
Four-lane NH: 18,371 -> 45,516 km	June 2026 backgrounder supports the four-lane-and-above pair. Widening an existing road differs from building an entirely new route through new land.

MTPA means million tonnes of handling capacity per year. It is the potential amount; actual cargo measures the amount handled. A capacity figure should not be called output.

All AIIMS stage counts concern the 22 new projects; Delhi is additional. Parts 2 and 3 explain delivery, usage and health-service limits in detail. Sources: 02, 33, 35, 36, 37, 38. Full references on pages 26-28.

19 / INFRASTRUCTURE CHART: ROWS 17-23

The final seven infrastructure rows.

Date changes explain some updates; definition changes explain others.

Original chart: earlier -> later	Dated evidence and explanation
Airports: 74 -> 164	The July 2026 aviation snapshot reports 74 in 2014 -> 165 operational airports. A count can include revived facilities; it is not a count of wholly new airports built from scratch.
Medical colleges: 387 -> 844	The August 2026 official comparison gives 387 -> 846. College count does not establish equal staffing, teaching quality or treatment access in every district.
Installed electricity: 249 -> 540 GW	CEA: 248.554 GW in March 2014 -> 554.544 GW in August 2026. Installed equipment differs from electricity generated or dependable household supply.
Steel: 109 -> 222 MT	109 is near 2014-15 capacity of 109.85 MT, not pre-2014 capacity. The 2013-14 capacity was 102.26 MT; June 2026 reports above 220 MT. Annual 2025-26 output was 168.4 MT.
Coal: 565 -> 1,000 MT	Annual output: 565.77 MT in 2013-14 -> 1,040.08 in 2025-26. The latest level remains below 2024-25's 1,047.52 MT; a long rise does not mean a rise every year.
Gas pipelines: 15,000 -> 26,000 km	15,340 km in 2014 -> 27,427 operational km at December 2025, reported in the March 2026 MIS. Authorised or planned pipelines are different counts.
Transmission: 2.9 -> 5 lakh circuit km	About 2.91 lakh in 2014 -> above 5 lakh in January 2026, for lines of 220 kV and above. Circuit km is not the same as route km.

The infrastructure chart's percentage usually divides the added amount by the later total. If 250 becomes 1,000, the added 750 is 75% of the later stock. Ordinary growth uses the earlier base: 750 divided by 250 is 300%. Both calculations have a meaning, but they answer different questions.

Neither arithmetic operation proves that a government created that share of the total. Plans, construction, commissioning, private investment and earlier assets can have different timelines. Pages 20-22 cover all 23 supplied chart rows; the qualifications belong with the achievements.

The steel comparison separates annual capacity from annual production. Chart percentages are not measurements of political responsibility. Sources: 02, 34, 36, 37, 38, 39. Full references on pages 26-28.

20 / CRIME, RAILWAYS AND DEFENCE

Read the missing qualifier.

The same reading problems recur across different subjects.

Scheduled Tribe crime chart issue	What NCRB actually shows
India, 2024	9,966 registered cases; rate 9.5 per lakh ST population using the Census-based denominator.
Punjab's displayed rate 0.2	NCRB does not publish a rate there in Table 7C.1. A missing rate is not a measured 0.2.
Chandigarh / Puducherry shown as 0	Their rates are not published. Do not replace a blank or suppressed rate with numerical zero.
Haryana / Delhi missing from chart	The 2024 table records 1 and 4 cases respectively, but no published rate. Absence from a picture does not mean no recorded cases.

Part 5, pages 9-10, reproduces the case and rate data for all 36 places. National cases fell from 12,960 in 2023 to 9,966 in 2024: down 2,994. Manipur alone fell from 3,399 to 289, down 3,110. Other places together therefore rose by 116. That arithmetic does not establish what caused the changes.

Registered cases are reports recorded by police, not all incidents that occurred. Population, willingness to report and recording practices affect comparisons. A place's crime rate is not a finding about the character of its residents.

The other railway chart labels 1,051 to 1,670 million tonnes as 'freight capacity'. Those are annual freight-loading amounts, meaning goods actually carried. The distinction matters. Its zero for a named automatic train-protection system should also not be read as India having no railway safety systems before 2014.

The defence chart's export pair, Rs 686 to Rs 38,424 crore, is supported. Its production headline of Rs 1.71 lakh crore is below the later ministry figure of about Rs 1.78 lakh crore for 2025-26. The 2026-27 defence allocation is about Rs 7.85 lakh crore, a spending plan rather than completed production.

The remaining railway and defence rows need individual dated sources and consistent equipment definitions. They have not all been independently reproduced here. Fleet totals and estimated nuclear stockpiles remain unverified.

Full ST crime correction is in Part 5; railway and defence explanations are in Parts 2 and 4. Additional charts are selectively checked, not declared wholly verified. Sources: 02, 33, 40, 41, 42. Full references on pages 26-28.

21 / CONSUMPTION POST

A sale is not a unique household.

The figures below are the Matrix post's claims, not a certified sales dataset.

Cumulative claimed sales, million units	2000-01 to 2013-14	2014-15 to 2025-26
Air conditioners	35.8	88.9
Mobile phones	1,242.10	2,978.0
Washing machines	42.4	98.7
Refrigerators	74.5	152.4
Personal computers	87.7	169.1
Passenger vehicles	21.85	40.71
Two-wheelers	116.98	212.66
Commercial vehicles	6.22	9.85
Televisions	171.7	229.3
Three-wheelers	5.2	6.8

The earlier period has 14 financial years; the later one has 12. These are not equal-length eras. They also do not cover all sales since independence. The post combines data-provider names but does not supply the full annual input tables needed to reproduce every total.

Its percentages use later sales divided by the sum of both periods. For air conditioners, 88.9 divided by 124.7 is about 71.3%. That is the later share of claimed sales across the stated 26 years. It is not a 71.3% growth rate, or the percentage of Indian homes with an air conditioner.

One person can buy several phones; an appliance can be replaced; a business can buy a fleet. Sales do not identify unique households or show how purchases were distributed between richer and poorer buyers.

The arithmetic interpretation can be checked even while the underlying totals remain unverified. To establish them, we would need matching annual domestic-sales or shipment series, with provider definitions and coverage. I have preserved all ten claimed pairs without treating those missing inputs as solved.

One million units equals ten lakh units. Product categories and sales versus shipments must be held consistent before the totals can be independently certified. Sources: 42. Full references on pages 26-28.

22 / GROWTH, INCOME AND THE WHOLE SERIES

Growth and relative income.

A relative lead can grow while a country's own growth rate falls.

Matrix post	Displayed India figures
G20 nominal US-dollar GDP growth	2004-2014: 10.9% a year, rank 7. 2014-2026: 6.1% a year, rank 1.
Income per person / EMDE average	2003: 35.17%; 2013: 27.81%; 2026: 37.2%; 2031: 46.22% forecast.

The growth chart's footnote says nominal US dollars. That includes domestic price changes and currency movements; it is not real GDP growth. Its compound annual rate spreads the change between two endpoints across the intervening years. The endpoint in 2026 also needs its forecast or observed status.

India's displayed rate falls from 10.9% to 6.1% while its relative position rises. That can happen if the other economies' rates fall more. The chart therefore does not show India growing faster in its own later period on this measure. Its group also includes the EU alongside some member countries; it is not a list of every country.

EMDE means emerging-market and developing economies. If India's income becomes a larger share of their average, it has improved relative to that denominator. A falling ratio can occur even when India's own income rises, if the comparison average rises faster.

The income chart needs a stated dollar or PPP measure, a definition of the group average and one IMF data vintage. The exact ratio series and G20 endpoint calculations were not independently reproduced here. The 2031 number is plainly a projection, not an achievement already delivered.

The six volumes show substantial gains in networks, production and several human outcomes. They also show gaps in work quality, nutrition, clean air, opportunity and justice. Every conclusion keeps its own measure, population and date.

I want the reader to leave with a usable habit: read the number, read its label, then ask what it changes in a person's life. That keeps achievements and problems visible together.

The two final chart series remain claims pending reproducible raw data and definitions. This closes the planned six-part, 168-page series; it does not claim an exhaustive audit of every Matrix post. Sources: 01, 42. Full references on pages 26-28.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

01 MisterLove / Lovepreet Singh: [Public profile and editorial theme](#)

Byline and public interests; checked 3 October 2026.

02 The Matrix India: [Infrastructure comparison](#)

Reader-supplied chart; economic and ST charts are companion links.

[Economic chart](#) / [Scheduled Tribe crime chart](#)

03 NITI Aayog: [National Multidimensional Poverty Index, 2023](#)

Printed p36: all 36 state/UT headcount pairs; NFHS-4 and NFHS-5.

04 NITI Aayog: [SDG India Index, 2023-24](#)

Printed pp68-69: state/UT composite scores; published July 2024.

[Official release](#)

05 Reserve Bank of India: [Handbook of Statistics on Indian States, 2024-25](#)

Tables 10, 19 and 106. RBI-authored report; accessible preserved copy.

[RBI publication location](#)

06 UNDP: [Human Development Report, 2013](#)

Table 1: 2012 observation, rank 136/187, original score 0.554.

07 UNDP: [Human Development Report, 2025: data series](#)

Revised 2013-2023 comparison; latest observed HDI year is 2023.

[India release](#)

08 World Economic Forum: [Global Gender Gap Report, 2013: profiles](#)

India country profile: overall and four dimension scores.

09 World Economic Forum: [Global Gender Gap Report, 2026](#)

India discussion in benchmarking chapter; released 16 September 2026.

10 Global Hunger Index publishers: [Global Hunger Index, 2013](#)

Original rank and method; low-score countries were listed separately.

11 Global Hunger Index publishers: [India: Global Hunger Index, 2025](#)

Latest India score, components and recomputed historical benchmarks.

[2025 full report](#) / [Government response, October 2023](#)

12 World Happiness Report: [World Happiness Report, 2013](#)

India: rank 111, score 4.772; survey average 2010-2012.

13 World Happiness Report: [2026 ranking data workbook](#)

India: rank 116/147, score 4.536; average 2023-2025.

[2026 chapter and method](#)

14 WIPO / Cornell / INSEAD: [Global Innovation Index, 2013](#)

India rank 66/142; inputs 87 and outputs 42.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

15 World Intellectual Property Organization: [Global Innovation Index, 2026: India](#)
Rank 38/139; inputs 49, outputs 25; uncertainty interval 34-39.

16 World Bank: [Logistics Performance Index: India series](#)
2012, 2014 and 2023 scores and ranks. Latest edition: 2023.
[2023 release and measurement](#)

17 World Bank: [Doing Business 2014: India profile](#)
Published in 2013: rank 134/189; mainly June 2013 conditions.

18 World Bank: [Doing Business 2020: India profile](#)
Rank 63/190; 2019 conditions in Delhi and Mumbai.
[Discontinuation, 16 September 2021](#)

19 Transparency International: [Corruption Perceptions Index, 2013 and 2025](#)
Scores 36 and 39; ranks 94/177 and 91/182. Higher is cleaner.
[2025 results / 2025 workbook and history](#)

20 Reporters Without Borders: [World Press Freedom Index, 2013](#)
Original report preserved by UNHCR; rank 140/179.

21 Reporters Without Borders: [India: World Press Freedom Index, 2026](#)
Rank 157/180; score 31.96. Method changed in 2022.
[2026 methodology](#)

22 Freedom House: [Freedom in the World, 2013](#)
India: Free; political-rights rating 2, civil-liberties rating 3.
[India assessment, 2026](#)

23 World Justice Project: [India: Rule of Law Index, 2025](#)
Rank 86/143; eight factor ranks; household and expert surveys.

24 Yale / Columbia EPI team: [Environmental Performance Index, 2012](#)
India rank 125/132; original report held by co-publisher Columbia.

25 Yale Environmental Performance Index: [India: Environmental Performance Index, 2026](#)
Overall 176/177, score 22.46; within-model ten-year change +7.47.
[Comparison guidance](#)

26 Sustainable Development Solutions Network: [Sustainable Development Report, 2026](#)
India rank 94/169, score 68.33; global index differs from NITI.
[2026 full report](#)

27 MoSPI / Ministry of Finance: [Historical growth and latest GDP series](#)
Old 4.7% vintage; revised historical series and August 2026 release.
[Historical revised GDP / Latest GDP release](#)

28 MoSPI: [Consumer Price Index: historical and latest releases](#)
Annual 2013-14 reading and August 2026 monthly reading kept separate.
[August 2026 release](#)

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

29 Controller General of Accounts / Finance Ministry: 2025-26 provisional accounts and 2026-27 Budget

Actuals, revised estimates and plans have different statuses.

[Deficit and debt estimates](#) / [Receipts and spending estimates](#)

30 RBI / Ministry of Finance: Annual current account: 2013-14 and 2025-26

Later RBI release dated 8 June 2026, preserved by HelloBanker.

[RBI 2025-26 release: preserved copy](#)

31 Reserve Bank of India / Finance Ministry: Bank asset quality and historical fiscal indicators

June 2026 FSR; debt ratios depend on definition and GDP vintage.

[Historical central debt](#) / [March 2014 NPA ratio](#)

32 RBI / Bank of India / IMF: External debt, bank credit and world growth

Debt: June 2026; non-food credit: March; IMF forecast: July.

[Bank of India annual report, 2025-26](#) / [IMF July 2026 update](#)

33 Road and Railway Ministries: Roads and railways: 2026 backgrounders

High-speed corridors, four-lane highways, metro and electrification.

[Railway infrastructure](#) / [Annual railway freight and passengers](#)

34 Railways / Civil Aviation: Freight corridors and operating airports

DFC completion: September 2026; aviation snapshot: July 2026.

[Aviation backgrounder](#)

35 Ports, Shipping and Waterways Ministry: Port capacity and inland waterways

Matched historical/current tables; capacity and actual cargo differ.

36 MNRE / Central Electricity Authority: Renewables and installed electricity capacity

March 2014 and August 2026; hydro definition held consistent.

[CEA August 2026 capacity](#) / [Transmission milestone](#)

37 PNGRB / Petroleum / Jal Shakti Ministries: Gas connections, pipelines and rural taps

Pipeline snapshot December 2025; household updates August 2026.

[PNG connections](#) / [Rural tap coverage](#)

38 Health Ministry / PMSSY: Medical colleges, MBBS seats and AIIMS stages

Medical capacity: August 2026; AIIMS stage details: September 2026.

[AIIMS project status](#)

39 Steel / Coal / Commerce Ministries: Steel, coal and recognised startups

2026 production/capacity releases; startup scheme began in 2016.

[Coal output](#) / [September 2026 startups](#) / [Historical recognition counts](#)

40 Ministry of Defence: Production, exports and spending

FY2025-26 production/exports; FY2026-27 spending is a Budget Estimate.

[Exports](#) / [Historical export baseline](#) / [2026-27 allocation](#)

41 National Crime Records Bureau: Crime in India, 2024: Volumes II and III

Table 7C.1: ST cases/rates; coverage and missing-rate notes.

[Volume III](#)

42 The Matrix India: Consumption comparison and other posts reviewed

Claim totals are transcribed, not independently certified as a dataset.

[Publisher account: other reviewed charts](#)

A REPORT CARD IN PLAIN ENGLISH

India, before and after 2014

The final verdict UPA and NDA

*Who did better. How I judge the evidence.
Why the answer needs conditions.*

FINAL COMPARISON VOLUME

Written by Lovepreet Singh

misterlove.in / Research cut-off: 3 October 2026

01 / AUTHOR'S NOTE

I wanted an answer I could defend.

A final judgment by Lovepreet Singh.

After six volumes, I did not want to leave you with a pile of numbers and no answer. You asked which government did better. This last volume gives my answer, explains how I reached it and keeps the strongest objections beside it.

On MisterLove, I try to make a difficult subject readable without asking you to learn a new language first. Here, I start with a few ordinary questions. Did daily services reach more people? Did incomes grow faster? Did people become healthier? Could they find decent work? Could they question those in power?

My overall judgment gives the BJP-led NDA a qualified advantage when I put greatest weight on infrastructure execution, basic-service reach and financial inclusion. That is a declared choice of priorities. Congress-led UPA has the stronger observed ten-year GDP-growth record in the common historical series, and the stronger case on the independent freedom assessments examined here.

I cannot turn those different outcomes into a scientific score proving that one government was better for every person. I can tell you where the evidence is strong, where the comparison is weak and why I still make the judgment I make.

COVID belongs in this assessment. So do the global financial crisis, oil-price changes, policy disruptions and unfinished work inherited from earlier years. A government's response deserves scrutiny even when the original shock came from outside.

This is my reading of published evidence. It is not an official finding, a claim of personal fieldwork or a request that you support a party. I want the reasoning to remain useful even when you disagree with my priorities.

Research cut-off: 3 October 2026. Final volume prepared 4 October 2026. Observations, calculations and editorial judgments are distinguished throughout. Sources: 01, 03, 43. References on pages 30-33.

02 / THE ANSWER FIRST

Who did better? My answer.

A clear conclusion, with the conditions attached.

My overall choice in this report is the BJP-led NDA after 2014, with a qualified lead on material delivery. By material delivery, I mean useful public networks and wider access to everyday services: transport, power, taps, sanitation, bank accounts and payment systems. The later record has substantial, documented expansion in these areas.

I give those outcomes the largest weight because they affect daily life and support later improvements. I count infrastructure and connected services as one broad group, rather than treating every road, pipe and bank-account row as a separate political point.

Congress-led UPA did better on observed real GDP growth across the equal ten-year periods. The annual compound rates were 6.80% in 2004-05 to 2013-14 and 6.06% in 2014-15 to 2023-24. The NDA figure includes the pandemic. NDA's first six years, mostly before COVID, compounded at 6.79%, almost the same as UPA's full-decade rate.

UPA also has a stronger case on the freedom assessments considered here. Neither that advantage nor the growth result proves that every UPA policy was good. They do mean that 'BJP was better in everything' is unsupported.

Health outcomes and poverty improved across both periods. The available jobs, wages, learning, safety and environmental evidence does not establish a clean overall winner. These areas limit how confidently I can call either era a complete success.

My final sentence is therefore specific: **NDA has the stronger case for delivery and expansion; UPA has the stronger measured full-decade growth record and a stronger case on institutional freedom. I choose NDA overall only under the delivery-first priorities disclosed in this report.**

The overall choice is editorial judgment, not a statistically estimated causal effect or an official national score. Sources: 03, 16, 19, 22, 43. References on pages 30-33.

03 / WHAT WE ARE COMPARING

Congress before 2014 needs dates.

The main comparison is UPA 2004-2014 versus NDA from 2014.

Government at the Centre	Period used here
Congress-led UPA; Prime Minister Manmohan Singh	22 May 2004 to 26 May 2014. Main GDP window: FY2004-05 to FY2013-14.
BJP-led NDA; Prime Minister Narendra Modi	From 26 May 2014. Equal GDP window ends FY2023-24; later dated outcomes are also discussed.

'Before 2014' is not the same as 'under Congress'. India had other governments, including an earlier BJP-led NDA. An asset already present in 2004 cannot automatically be credited to UPA. Equally, an asset present in 2026 cannot automatically be credited entirely to Modi.

Both UPA and NDA are alliances. Their central policies also operated alongside governments in the states, local authorities, RBI, public institutions, businesses and citizens. I use the alliance names when making government-level judgments.

FY means financial year. FY2013-14 runs from April 2013 to March 2014. Governments changed in May 2004 and May 2014, so both starting financial years contain a short period under the predecessor. Annual data cannot isolate the exact handover day.

For growth, ten years are compared with ten years. For the latest condition of India, I also use the newest suitable observations checked by the cut-off. Those observations are not all from 2026: poverty may describe 2023-24, crime 2024, and health a multi-year period.

This volume adds a judgment to the six completed reports. It does not replace their detailed tables, and it does not claim to have verified every post ever published by The Matrix India.

The six evidence volumes total 168 pages. This additional final volume uses their findings plus newly checked earlier baselines and growth calculations. Sources: 02, 59. References on pages 30-33.

04 / HOW I JUDGE

A larger number is only a start.

I ask about pace, use, quality, fairness and responsibility.

First, I separate the level from the pace. A later government should normally inherit a larger economy and more roads. The useful question is how much changed during its term, over how many years, and what the change meant.

Second, I compare the same thing. Capacity is what equipment could produce; output is what it actually produced. A sanctioned hospital is an approved project; a fully functioning hospital treats people with working staff and facilities. An account or tap connection is not proof of regular use.

Third, I remove inflation when judging purchasing power. Rs 100 becoming Rs 200 does not double what a family can buy if prices also doubled. Physical units, such as tonnes or route kilometres, do not need that same price correction.

Fourth, I keep shared achievements together. Roads, railways, ports and logistics are connected. Counting every indicator as a separate vote would let a long infrastructure chart overpower health or freedom simply because it contains more rows.

Fifth, I distinguish a recorded result from its cause. A government can influence a result without causing all of it. Weather, technology, inherited projects, private investment, state decisions and world conditions can also matter.

Finally, I disclose my priorities. Delivery receives the largest weight in my overall choice. Growth, human outcomes, work quality, safety and rights remain independent checks. I use no invented percentage of political credit, no fake marks out of 100 and no claim that the evidence forces everyone to choose the same winner.

A verdict is an interpretation of several measures. None of the sources supplies a universal Congress-versus-BJP performance score. Sources: 59, 05. References on pages 30-33.

05 / REAL ECONOMIC GROWTH

The equal ten-year comparison.

Real GDP measures output after removing price changes.

UPA year	Real growth	NDA year	Real growth
2004-05	7.92%	2014-15	7.41%
2005-06	7.92%	2015-16	8.00%
2006-07	8.06%	2016-17	8.26%
2007-08	7.66%	2017-18	6.80%
2008-09	3.09%	2018-19	6.45%
2009-10	7.86%	2019-20	3.87%
2010-11	8.50%	2020-21	-5.78%
2011-12	5.24%	2021-22	9.69%
2012-13	5.46%	2022-23	7.61%
2013-14	6.39%	2023-24	9.19%

Across the decade, UPA's real GDP rose about 93.0%; NDA's first-decade increase was about 80.1%. The compound annual rates were **6.80% and 6.06%**. A compound rate is the steady annual pace that would produce the same start-to-end change.

The simple averages of the annual rates are 6.81% and 6.15%. They differ from the compound result because a fall followed by a rise must multiply, rather than simply cancel. This report uses the compound measure for its main growth verdict.

The table retains one published historical framework: the Economic Survey's January 2026 snapshot of the 2011-12 GDP series. The new 2022-23-base estimates are not spliced into these older observations.

Verdict on the observed full-decade growth pace: UPA leads. COVID accounts for an important part of NDA's weaker result; the next page shows how much that qualification matters.

Annual rates are calculated from published GDP levels and rounded to two decimals. FY2023-24 is revised. These are observed national outcomes, not estimates of a government's isolated contribution. Sources: 03, 05. References on pages 30-33.

06 / WHAT COVID CHANGES

Keep the fall and the rebound together.

A recovery percentage can look large because the earlier year was weak.

Growth comparison	Annual compound rate
UPA, full ten years: FY2004-05 to FY2013-14	6.80%
NDA, full ten years: FY2014-15 to FY2023-24	6.06%
NDA, first six years: FY2014-15 to FY2019-20	6.79%
NDA, eleven years through FY2024-25, provisional	6.10%
Two-year pandemic block: FY2020-21 and FY2021-22	1.66%

The pandemic fall was 5.78%, followed by 9.69% growth. Taken together, output rose about 3.35% over the two years, or 1.66% a year compounded. The recovery year cannot be used as if the loss had never happened.

For a sensitivity check, I remove both pandemic years from NDA's first-decade annual-rate list. The eight retained rates compound to 7.19% a year. If I also remove FY2008-09 and FY2009-10, the financial-crisis-and-recovery block, from UPA's list, its eight retained rates compound to 7.14%. That tiny gap does not establish a decisive winner.

These retained-year calculations are not continuous historical periods. They do not reconstruct an India without either crisis. Choosing different affected years can change the answer. They show how sensitive a verdict is to the way shocks are handled.

My conclusion: UPA's observed decade was faster. The evidence does not support claiming a large underlying growth advantage for either government once the major shock blocks are selectively removed. NDA's slowdown was already underway before the main pandemic years; FY2019-20 recorded 3.87% growth.

FY2019-20 includes early COVID effects and the final week's lockdown. Both shocks affected other years too. Deleting years is a sensitivity exercise, not a causal adjustment or forecast. Sources: 03, 10. References on pages 30-33.

07 / INCOME PER PERSON

The income race is much closer.

National income per person is an average, not a typical salary.

Constant-price income per person	Published amount
FY2003-04: starting observation before UPA	Rs 42,995
FY2013-14: end of the UPA decade	Rs 68,572
FY2023-24: end of NDA's first decade	Rs 1,08,786
FY2024-25: later provisional observation	Rs 1,14,710

UPA's ten-year increase was 59.49%, equivalent to 4.78% a year compounded. NDA's first-ten-year increase was 58.64%, or 4.72% a year. The difference is small enough that I treat these two average-income growth records as essentially close, rather than a dramatic victory.

Through FY2024-25, NDA's eleven-year increase was 67.28%, or 4.79% a year. That extra year changes the comparison length. It is useful recent context, not an equal-ten-year win.

These amounts use constant 2011-12 prices. They are tools for comparing buying power over time, not the money you would see deposited into your account in those years.

An average can rise while many people struggle. If one person's income grows much faster than everyone else's, it pulls up the average. The middle person's income, wages adjusted for prices, and dependable days of work would tell us more about ordinary households.

Verdict on the measured income pace: the two equal decades are close. **Verdict on today's income level:** it is higher. Neither statement establishes that every family became better off, or that one party alone caused the increase.

Calculations use per capita net national income, not GDP per capita or a household salary series. FY2024-25 is provisional in the retained snapshot. Sources: 04, 34. References on pages 30-33.

08 / DISRUPTIONS UNDER UPA

UPA did not govern in calm weather.

Outside shocks explain part of its record. Domestic weaknesses also matter.

The global financial crisis of 2008-09 damaged world demand, finance and business confidence. India faced tighter credit, weaker exports and slower activity. UPA used additional public spending, tax reductions and sector support; RBI also responded through monetary measures.

The common historical GDP series shows growth falling to 3.09% in FY2008-09 and recovering to 7.86% in FY2009-10. Contemporary reports used older methods and published different figures. I use those reports for policy history, and the common series for numerical comparison.

Later, international financial volatility put pressure on India. In 2013, the expected withdrawal of exceptionally easy US monetary policy encouraged money to leave vulnerable emerging markets. That helps explain currency and financial-market pressure, but does not remove domestic responsibility.

The IMF's February 2014 assessment identified persistent inflation, weak investment, domestic supply constraints and deteriorating corporate and bank finances alongside external pressures. Those weaknesses made the outside shock harder to absorb.

UPA deserves credit for substantial growth and poverty reduction despite a major world crisis. It also deserves criticism for its late-period slowdown, investment obstacles and weak financial conditions. Calling the whole record a disaster ignores the decade; calling every late problem an outside event ignores the domestic diagnosis.

My treatment: the crisis counts as a real external disadvantage. UPA's response is part of its governing record. So are the vulnerabilities that remained when it left office.

No attempt is made to estimate how India would have grown under a different government during the same crisis. Sources: 06, 03. References on pages 30-33.

09 / DISRUPTIONS UNDER NDA

NDA had shocks and advantages.

Fairness requires counting help as well as harm.

The large fall in world oil prices after 2014 helped India, a major oil importer. The IMF described benefits for economic activity, the external account, the budget and inflation. Monetary and supply measures also contributed; the exact size of the oil effect is debated.

Weather and harvest conditions could work in the other direction. Poor rainfall, heat and floods affect food supplies and rural incomes. They do not originate in a prime minister's office, but preparedness, irrigation, relief and adaptation remain matters of policy.

Demonetisation in November 2016 was a government decision. The resulting shortage of cash was described by the IMF as an adverse temporary shock. It belongs in the assessment of NDA policy, rather than in the same category as a virus or a foreign financial crisis.

GST began in July 2017 after years of groundwork. Its national framework is an important reform; its design, transition and administration also deserve assessment. A chosen transition cost cannot simply be deleted from the record as bad luck.

COVID in 2020-22 was a severe outside shock. Russia's invasion of Ukraine in 2022 added global commodity and inflation pressure. Conversely, inherited systems, private investment and technological improvements helped India expand services and recover.

My treatment: credit NDA's response and delivery where the evidence supports it; recognise the difficult circumstances; keep policy choices and beneficial outside conditions visible. The result should not depend on remembering only the shocks that help one side's argument.

This covers major relevant disruptions and enabling conditions; it is not an exhaustive list of every event from 2014 to 2026. Sources: 07, 08, 09, 10, 50. References on pages 30-33.

10 / COVID AND THE ECONOMY

The virus was external. The response was policy.

Both belong in the final assessment.

A national lockdown was announced on 24 March 2020, beginning at midnight, initially for 21 days. Restricting movement aimed to slow infections. It also interrupted ordinary work, travel and spending in a country where many livelihoods depend on daily activity.

The economic damage came from several things at once: the disease itself, fear of infection, restrictions, world disruptions and weaknesses already present. The annual GDP fall cannot identify the exact contribution of each.

India's response included food support, financial measures, monetary easing and later vaccination. IMF analysis recognised support to vulnerable groups and policies that helped recovery. Health workers, state administrations, manufacturers and households also contributed.

Recovery deserves credit, but a rebound is not the same as catching up with the path India might have followed without COVID. That imagined path is uncertain. The report therefore gives the actual two-year change and avoids inventing a precise 'COVID-adjusted' performance figure.

The shock does not explain all earlier weakness: growth was already slowing before it, and FY2019-20 recorded 3.87%. That year includes early COVID effects and the final week's lockdown. Comparing the main pandemic decline with an ordinary UPA year would be unfair; UPA's financial-crisis period must remain visible too.

Verdict: COVID materially weakens any simple claim that NDA's lower decade-average growth proves worse economic management. It does not justify removing the recession, ignoring pre-COVID slowdown or giving the recovery to one leader alone.

GDP calculations describe national output. They do not measure all lost work, learning, health, or the distribution of hardship. Sources: 11, 10, 03. References on pages 30-33.

11 / COVID AND HUMAN LIVES

A pandemic record cannot end with GDP.

Deaths, care, migration and vaccination also count.

WHO's 2022 modelling estimated 4.7 million excess deaths in India during 2020-21, with an interval of 3.31 to 6.48 million. In Indian units, the central estimate is 47 lakh. This is a disputed estimate of deaths above an expected baseline, including direct and indirect effects. It is not a verified list of 47 lakh deaths all medically recorded as COVID.

The Indian government objected to WHO's modelling and the use of selected data. This report does not independently resolve that dispute. Uncertainty about the total cannot turn the pandemic's human cost into zero, or justify assigning every excess death to one government's action.

The Supreme Court's May 2021 oxygen proceedings and its National Task Force show that oxygen assessment and allocation required urgent attention. NHRC's migrant-worker intervention similarly records serious hardship after the lockdown. These concerns belong alongside the recovery story.

The vaccination programme delivered more than 220 crore doses by 6 January 2023. That was a major logistics achievement. Doses are not unique people: the same person could receive more than one. The achievement also depended on scientists, manufacturers, health workers and state delivery.

There is no observed UPA-managed COVID pandemic against which to test a winner. Any statement that Congress definitely would have done better or worse is an untested claim.

My verdict on NDA's pandemic response is mixed: large vaccination and relief delivery, alongside serious problems in emergency care and protection of vulnerable workers. COVID is an important qualification in the overall verdict, and a major human outcome in its own right.

WHO figure refers to a 2022 estimate for January 2020-December 2021, not the latest all-period registered COVID death total. No claim is made about an individual death's cause. Sources: 13, 12, 11. References on pages 30-33.

12 / TRANSPORT AND POWER

NDA has its strongest case here.

Network expansion is substantial. Earlier work was real too.

Infrastructure measure	Earlier	Later
National-highway stock	65,569 km, March 2004	91,287 km, March 2014
Same designated NH network	91,287 km, March 2014	1,46,572 km, February 2026
Four-lane-and-above NH	18,371 km, 2014	45,516 km, June 2026
Rail electrification, retrospective series	21,801 route km, 2014	69,873 route km, March 2026
Operating metro network	248 km, 2014	1,155 km, March 2026

Highway stock rose about 25,718 km in 2004-14, or 2,572 km a year. It then rose 55,285 km over roughly twelve years, or about 4,607 km a year. This is network-stock change, which includes designation of existing roads; it is not a new-road construction speed.

The broader later expansion supports NDA's delivery case. Rail electrification and metro growth add to it. Inherited projects, state governments, private contractors and users remain part of the story.

The record also has limits. Railway passenger journeys were about 839.7 crore in FY2013-14 and 741 crore in FY2025-26, while freight loading increased. More infrastructure did not mean a higher figure for every usage measure.

Verdict: NDA has the stronger case on transport-network expansion and execution in the evidence assembled. The precise efficiency of each rupee, and the separate government contribution to each kilometre, are not established.

The two NH stock-change speeds use approximately 10 and 12 years. Detailed category and commissioning qualifications remain in Part 2. Sources: 14, 15, 16, 17. References on pages 30-33.

13 / EVERYDAY PUBLIC SERVICES

More connections can change a day.

The next test is whether the service works and is affordable.

Rural tap-water coverage reported under Jal Jeevan Mission rose from 16.72% in August 2019 to 82.24% in August 2026. That is a large later-period reach improvement. The starting date is 2019, not a Congress-era 2014 baseline.

A recorded tap connection is not proof of safe water at reliable pressure every day. Maintenance, source quality, local capacity and drought resilience determine the service a household actually receives.

The NFHS household measure of improved sanitation rose from 48.5% in 2015-16 to 70.2% in 2019-21. This is more informative about household conditions than treating the administrative declaration of universal open-defecation-free status as an identical survey measure.

Power networks, generation equipment and cooking-gas connections expanded. They can make life easier, but equipment capacity differs from dependable electricity, and a gas connection differs from being able to afford regular refills. I retain these distinctions when awarding delivery credit.

UPA and earlier governments also built rural roads, electricity systems and service foundations. NDA continued and enlarged many of them. A government deserves credit for useful expansion even when it inherited the starting system; inheritance does not make execution automatic.

Verdict: NDA has a strong case on wider basic-service reach. Confidence is lower on uniform service quality and affordability. Those limits matter because the intended result is usable daily access, rather than a completed administrative target alone.

Tap and sanitation observations mostly fall within the NDA period. They show improvement, but do not create matched UPA-era rates of improvement where those measurements are missing. Sources: 19, 20, 16. References on pages 30-33.

14 / BANKING AND DIGITAL LIFE

Foundations under UPA. Scale under NDA.

A useful system can have more than one builder.

Milestone or outcome	What the dates show
NPCI incorporated	2008, during UPA.
UIDAI began; first Aadhaar issued	2009 and 2010, during UPA.
Jan Dhan launched	August 2014, during NDA.
UPI pilot launched	April 2016, during NDA.
Adults aged 15+ with an account, Findex	53.1% in 2014 to 89.0% in 2024.

The account-ownership increase is 35.9 percentage points. Imagine 100 adults: roughly 53 had an account in the earlier survey and 89 in the later one. The 2014 survey is a handover-year observation, not a clean measurement taken immediately before the new government.

UPA's digital institutions and identity groundwork deserve recognition. NDA's account-opening drive, UPI-era expansion and integration into services also deserve recognition. Banks, RBI, NPCI, private firms, cheaper technology and users contributed.

Access must be distinguished from control and use. An account may be dormant; a person may rely on someone else's phone; a payment can fail. Authentication trouble and fraud can impose new costs. Large transaction totals are not the same as new national income.

Verdict: shared foundational credit, with NDA having the stronger case for the later scale and financial-inclusion delivery. Saying digital India began from nothing in 2014 would erase documented earlier work.

The Findex dates are survey years; the latest cited ownership observation is 2024, published in the 2025 database. Sources: 21, 22. References on pages 30-33.

15 / POVERTY AND FOOD SECURITY

Poverty fell in both periods.

Do not change the poverty line halfway through the race.

Measure and observed dates	Earlier -> later
Tendulkar monetary poverty, 2004-05 -> 2011-12	37.2% -> 21.9%
World Bank \$3/day, 2021 PPP, 2011-12 -> 2023-24	27.1% -> 2.6%
World Bank \$4.20/day, same PPP and dates	57.7% -> 16.1%
NITI multidimensional poverty, 2015-16 -> 2019-21	24.85% -> 14.96%

The first row shows substantial UPA-era improvement. The later rows show substantial improvement mostly during NDA, although the World Bank starting year precedes 2014. The Tendulkar and World Bank rates use different lines and methods, so subtracting across their rows would be wrong.

Multidimensional poverty counts several disadvantages, such as health, education and living conditions. It differs from a money-based poverty line. Survey redesign also requires care in the later consumption comparison.

The National Food Security Act of 2013 created a major UPA-era entitlement. NDA provided additional pandemic food support and made existing NFSA grain entitlements free from January 2023. The later free entitlement is not the same as continuing the earlier pandemic's additional quantity.

Verdict: strong poverty reduction and food-security contributions in both eras. NDA has a strong later delivery case, but the available comparisons do not establish a clean winner on the poverty-reduction rate from precisely 2014. Moving just above a poverty line also does not guarantee financial security.

The national Tendulkar baseline differs from the later international PPP lines. NITI's extrapolated 2013-14 estimates are not substituted for an observed survey at the handover. Sources: 24, 25, 26, 23. References on pages 30-33.

16 / HEALTH

Health improved before and after 2014.

Long-running progress, more capacity, and unfinished access.

Health measure	Earlier progression	Later progression
Infant deaths per 1,000 live births	60 in 2003 -> 40 in 2013	40 in 2013 -> 24 in 2024
Maternal deaths per 1,00,000 live births	254 in 2004-06 -> 167 in 2011-13	167 in 2011-13 -> 87 in 2022-24
Government share of total health spending	28.6% in 2013-14	43.7% in 2022-23
Direct household share of health spending	64.2% in 2013-14	43.4% in 2022-23

The infant-death decline was 20 points over ten years before the handover and 16 points over eleven years afterward. Proportional declines were about 33% and 40%. A lower starting death rate makes later reductions a different task. Maternal estimates average three-year windows rather than single years. Neither comparison isolates a government's exact effect.

The spending shares show a larger public role and a smaller household-payment share. They do not prove that every family pays less. The direct-payment share rose from 39.4% in 2021-22 to 43.4% in 2022-23; progress was not continuous.

States supplied about 63.7% of government health spending in 2022-23. Medical colleges and training seats expanded after 2014, but approved AIIMS projects differ in operational stage. More seats do not instantly become doctors available in every village.

Verdict: both periods made meaningful health progress. NDA has a stronger later capacity-and-coverage case; the mortality evidence does not support awarding all health improvement to one government. COVID and continuing household costs limit a sweeping victory claim.

Earlier SRS national rates excluded some small-state coverage; the IMR comparison is indicative, not perfectly identical coverage. Health spending includes states. Detailed definitions and stages are in Part 3. Sources: 27, 28, 29, 20, 30. References on pages 30-33.

17 / EDUCATION AND NUTRITION

A school place is not the same as learning.

Pandemic damage and recovery must both remain visible.

ASER: rural children, all school types	2014	2018	2022	2024
Class III reading a Class II text	23.6%	27.3%	20.5%	27.1%
Class V reading a Class II text	48.0%	50.5%	42.8%	48.8%
Class III doing subtraction	25.4%	28.2%	25.9%	33.7%
Class V doing division	26.1%	27.9%	25.6%	30.7%

Reading improved before COVID, fell sharply in 2022 and recovered by 2024. Class V reading remained slightly below its 2018 level. Arithmetic improved more clearly in the latest observation. ASER measures rural children; it is not an urban-and-rural national census.

Children's nutrition also improved unevenly. Stunting fell from 35.5% in NFHS-5, surveyed in 2019-21, to 29.3% in NFHS-6, surveyed in 2023-24. Underweight changed much less, from 32.1% to 31.8%. One better nutrition figure does not make all nutrition problems solved.

Schools, teachers, families, state policy, income, food access and health all influence these outcomes. The pandemic caused an exceptional interruption, but the learning gap was already large before it.

Verdict: credit NDA-period recovery, arithmetic gains and newer nutrition improvement. The assembled evidence does not establish superior overall learning performance against the full UPA decade. Human development needs better outcomes as well as buildings, seats and enrolment.

Percentages refer to the stated skill, not an examination pass rate or all forms of learning. NFHS-6 was released in May 2026; its survey period was 2023-24. Sources: 31, 20. References on pages 30-33.

18 / JOBS AND DISTRIBUTION

Low unemployment is not the whole answer.

People need enough paid, dependable work.

PLFS 2025 reports usual-status unemployment of 3.1% among people aged 15 and above, and 9.9% among people aged 15-29. The youth figure is a separate age group. The denominator is people in the labour force, rather than the entire population.

In the same survey, 56.2% of employed people were self-employed, 23.6% had regular wage or salaried work and 20.2% were casual workers. Self-employment includes very different situations, from a successful business to poorly paid work or unpaid help in a household enterprise.

Survey design changed in 2025. Earlier NSS employment surveys and later PLFS results also require care. I do not create a clean 2004-2026 jobs series by joining different methods, or count every payroll registration as a newly created job.

The registered-factory survey shows more persons engaged after 2014, a real positive within that sector. It does not cover every informal worker or tell us whether the increase would have happened without the policies adopted.

Average income growth was close across the equal decades. Research estimates also show substantial concentration of income and wealth. These are reasons to ask about pay, days worked and who received the gains, rather than assume the rising national total was shared evenly.

Verdict: the evidence does not establish a decisive UPA-versus-NDA winner on good jobs and ordinary workers' buying power. NDA's delivery advantage cannot be treated as proof that secure employment is solved. UPA's faster GDP growth is not proof that every worker benefited either.

Usual status summarises work over a longer reference period; it is not the same as unemployment during one week. The report makes no invented estimate of unique net jobs created. Sources: 32, 33, 38, 04, 34. References on pages 30-33.

19 / PRICES, BANKS AND PUBLIC MONEY

Later stability has a stronger case.

The case is clearest for bank health; other measures need caution.

Late UPA had persistently high inflation and financial vulnerabilities. Later inflation moderated, helped by monetary and supply policy as well as favourable commodity conditions. Inflation of 4.82% in August 2026 cannot be directly compared as a whole-era average with FY2013-14's annual 9.5%; the dates and CPI framework differ.

Lower inflation means prices rise more slowly. It does not mean groceries or rent return to old prices. A government's price-stability record must therefore be read alongside wages, affordability and food-price volatility.

Scheduled commercial banks' gross bad-loan ratio fell from about 4.1% in March 2014 to 1.8% in March 2026. Between those dates, recognition of stressed loans first increased, including RBI's 2015 Asset Quality Review. Later recovery, restructuring, write-offs and loan-book growth all affected the ratio.

Recognising inherited problems and improving bank balance sheets deserve credit. A write-off is not the same as recovering all the money, cancelling every borrower obligation or proving corruption disappeared.

Central capital expenditure rose from Rs 1.88 lakh crore in FY2013-14 to Rs 10.69 lakh crore in FY2025-26 provisional accounts. That is a nominal change. Interest payments also consumed about 37.6% of central revenue receipts in the later year. Higher investment and continuing fiscal pressure coexist.

Verdict: NDA has a stronger case on bank cleanup and later macroeconomic stabilisation than late UPA. I do not extend this to a proven full-decade inflation win, uniformly cheap living, or complete debt sustainability.

RBI, banks and market conditions share responsibility. Budget GDP vintages and central-versus-all-government definitions are retained; forecasts are not treated as completed outcomes. Sources: 06, 07, 35, 36, 37. References on pages 30-33.

20 / INDUSTRY AND PRODUCTION

India produces more. Judge the type of gain.

Factory activity and useful capacity expanded; quality of work still matters.

Registered-factory survey	FY2013-14	FY2024-25
Persons engaged	1,35,38,114	2,09,96,913
Operating factories	1,85,690	2,18,543
Gross value added, current prices	Rs 10.65 lakh crore	Rs 26.94 lakh crore

Persons engaged increased about 55%, or 74.59 lakh. This is a difference between two survey estimates, not a list of unique people who received a new permanent job. The sector is registered manufacturing, rather than every workshop or informal producer.

Gross value added is production value after subtracting bought-in inputs. Its rupee increase includes inflation. It cannot be called a 153% increase in physical goods without an appropriate price adjustment.

Steel capacity rose from 102.26 million tonnes in FY2013-14 to more than 220 million tonnes in June 2026. Capacity differs from actual annual production. Startups, patents, electronics and defence achievements in Part 4 add evidence of industrial and technological expansion, but their registration and money-value definitions must remain attached.

The latest Global Innovation Index ranks India 38th of 139 economies, compared with 66th of 142 in 2013. It supports a better relative innovation position under changing models, rather than a precise measurement of government-caused innovation.

Verdict: NDA has a positive later production-and-capacity record. Without matched full UPA-period baselines for every sector, I do not call this proof of faster industrial transformation across the whole economy or better employment for every worker.

ASI 2024-25 was released 30 September 2026. Index rank, installed capacity, annual production and administrative recognition are different measures. Sources: 38, 39, 53. References on pages 30-33.

21 / FARMING, RESEARCH AND SPACE

A larger harvest is not a richer farmer.

Shared scientific work deserves more than a party label.

Foodgrain production rose from 265.05 million tonnes for crop year 2013-14 to an estimated 376.563 million tonnes for crop year 2025-26. This is about 42% more physical food. The later number is a third advance estimate, so it remains revisable.

The farmer's result also depends on prices received, inputs, debt, land size, weather and days of work. A national harvest total does not demonstrate doubled real farm-household income. The available household surveys are not a clean 2014-to-today comparison using one unchanged definition.

R&D; spending rose substantially in rupees. Part 4 records a GDP share of 0.71% in 2013-14 and 0.84% in 2023-24, while explaining the different GDP-base treatment. Projected later spending is not completed research. More patents or papers also need questions about quality and use.

India launched Chandrayaan-1 in 2008. The Mars Orbiter Mission launched in November 2013 and entered Mars orbit in September 2014. Chandrayaan-3's successful landing came in August 2023. Scientists and institutions carried knowledge across the political handover.

These dates show why a mission's arrival year cannot allocate all its credit. Earlier preparation, continuing budgets, testing and final execution matter. The same principle applies to freight corridors and medical institutions.

Verdict: NDA's later farming-output and scientific achievements are substantial. UPA's earlier missions and foundations also matter. A clean winner on farmer prosperity or the entire science system is not established by the assembled comparisons.

Foodgrain quantity is not farm income. R&D; ratios retain their stated denominator vintage; mission history is not a calculation of political credit. Sources: 40, 41, 42. References on pages 30-33.

22 / RIGHTS AND ACCOUNTABILITY

Here, UPA has the stronger case.

Material delivery does not cancel the need to question power.

Freedom House assessed India as Free in its 2013 edition. Its 2026 country assessment rates India Partly Free, with a score of 62 out of 100. These are the publisher's judgments under its framework, rather than an official Indian government classification. Kashmir is assessed separately by that publisher.

Reporters Without Borders places India 157th of 180 in 2026, compared with 140th of 179 in 2013. Its method changed in 2022, including the direction of its score. I do not calculate a deterioration percentage by splicing those scores. The recent 2025-to-2026 score also declined within the newer framework.

These assessments use choices about indicators, expert views and evidence. They can be challenged and should be read in detail. Their concerns still deserve consideration; improved infrastructure does not answer a question about press freedom or civil rights.

UPA's Right to Information Act of 2005 created an important accountability framework. Later central-authority rejection rates fell, but fewer recorded rejections do not automatically mean fuller answers, shorter delays or better accountability across every state.

My verdict on the evidence examined: UPA has a stronger case on institutional freedom. This is more qualified than declaring every institution healthier in 2004-14. India's earlier record also had serious shortcomings, and the indicators do not isolate one party's contribution.

This is a substantial debit in NDA's overall assessment. A delivery-first conclusion can favour NDA while still treating rights as an independent public good. A reader who gives institutional freedom the greatest weight may reasonably choose UPA overall.

Civil-rights assessments and administrative RTI disposal statistics measure different things. Freedom House's old ratings are not converted into an invented historical score out of 100. Sources: 43, 44, 45. References on pages 30-33.

23 / SAFETY AND THE ENVIRONMENT

The weaker results remain in the record.

Progress in one area does not erase harm elsewhere.

Recorded measure	Earlier	Later
Murder cases and rate per lakh population	33,201; rate 2.7, 2013	27,049; rate 1.9, 2024
Road deaths, ministry series	1,37,572, 2013	1,77,175, 2024
Suicides and rate per lakh population	1,34,799; rate 11.0, 2013	1,70,746; rate 12.2, 2024

The murder decline is a positive recorded outcome. Higher road deaths and the higher suicide rate are serious adverse outcomes. Reporting, population and exposure matter, and policing is largely a state responsibility. These figures do not isolate Union-government performance.

The ST-crime chart illustrates how averages can mislead. National recorded cases fell by 2,994 in 2024; Manipur's fall alone was 3,110. Other places together rose by 116. This does not establish causes, but it prevents a simple nationwide improvement story from that one total.

Clean-air progress remains uneven. Under the later NCAP comparison, many monitored cities improved against FY2017-18, but only 14 met the stated Indian annual PM10 standard. That starting year is not 2014, and PM10 improvement does not establish safe PM2.5 everywhere.

Renewable capacity and environmental programmes are meaningful achievements. Heat and changing weather also reflect a global climate problem. Governments remain responsible for local emissions control, safe transport, adaptation and enforcement.

Verdict: no clean overall era winner on safety and environment from this evidence. These unresolved and adverse outcomes reduce the strength of NDA's overall lead, while missing matched UPA baselines prevent a blanket alternative claim.

Registered cases are not all incidents. Road-death counts are not distance-adjusted risk. Suicide records do not prove the cause of an individual death. Sources: 46, 47, 48, 49, 50. References on pages 30-33.

24 / INHERITANCE AND STATES

Credit crosses the handover.

A national result usually has several contributors.

Example	Fair credit
Freight corridors	DFCCIL incorporated in 2006; major commissioning came later. Earlier preparation and later delivery both matter.
Aadhaar, NPCI, Jan Dhan and UPI	UPA-era foundations; NDA-era launches and expansion; continuing RBI, bank and private-sector work.
Food security	UPA's 2013 law; NDA's pandemic support and later free-entitlement policy; state delivery.
GST	Work spanned the earlier NDA, UPA and later NDA. Final enactment and administration still deserve scrutiny.
Mars Orbiter Mission	Launch in 2013; arrival in 2014; continuing scientific work across governments.

States run much of health, education, policing and local delivery. Kerala and Bihar do not start from the same conditions; their outcomes cannot be explained entirely by the government at the Centre. The state tables in Part 6 show why the national average leaves important differences hidden.

Inheritance works in both directions. NDA inherited institutions and projects that helped it deliver. It also inherited financial stress and unfinished work. UPA inherited an expanding economy and systems built by still earlier governments.

Verdict: NDA deserves credit for execution after the handover, without receiving ownership of all earlier preparation. UPA deserves credit for groundwork and its own results, without being excused from weaknesses left behind.

The report does not attempt to assign a numerical percentage of each project to a party. Funding, planning, construction and operation may have different timelines. Sources: 18, 21, 23, 09, 42, 26. References on pages 30-33.

25 / WHAT THE RANKINGS ADD

The rankings give a mixed picture.

Scores, dates and methods matter more than a league-table headline.

Publisher measure	Finding retained from Part 6
UNDP human development	Revised comparable HDI: 0.615 in 2013 to 0.685 in 2023. Higher is better.
World Bank logistics	Score 3.08 in 2012 to 3.40 in 2023; rank 46/155 to 38/139.
WEF gender gap	Overall score 65.5% in 2013 to 64.5% in 2026. Different dimensions moved differently.
Global Hunger Index	Within the 2025 model: 29.3 for 2016 to 25.8 for 2025; lower is better. Original 2013 score cannot be spliced.
World Happiness Report	Life evaluation: 4.772 for 2010-12 to 4.536 for 2023-25. Different survey periods, not single-year results.
Perceived corruption	CPI score 36 in 2013 to 39 in 2025. This is not a corruption-free percentage.
Environmental Performance Index	2026 rank 176/177; model and country coverage changes prevent a simple cross-edition deterioration claim.

Human development and logistics strengthen the case for progress. Gender, life evaluation, rights and environmental findings prevent an all-round success claim. Each index uses its own definition; no country rank supplies a direct party-performance score.

Verdict: the rankings support a mixed national record. They do not overturn the delivery evidence or justify treating every social concern as solved. Governments can influence these outcomes without being their only cause.

The full original-versus-recomputed comparisons and publisher-method caveats are in Part 6. Ranking position changes when other countries or coverage change too. Sources: 51, 54, 52, 55, 56, 57, 58. References on pages 30-33.

26 / DOMAIN VERDICTS

What each area can support.

These judgments are not added as equal points.

Area	My reading of the evidence
Observed equal-decade real GDP growth	UPA leads: 6.80% versus 6.06%. COVID substantially qualifies NDA's result.
Real average income per person	Close across equal decades: 4.78% versus 4.72% annual growth.
Networks and basic-service reach	NDA has the stronger later delivery case; use and quality need separate checks.
Digital access and financial inclusion	Shared foundations; NDA leads on later scale and reach.
Poverty and food security	Strong gains in both; no clean precisely-2014 poverty-rate winner.
Health outcomes and capacity	Progress in both; later capacity expansion favours NDA's delivery case.
Jobs, wages and learning	Mixed or insufficient matched evidence for a decisive era winner.
Banks and later stabilisation	NDA has the stronger case compared with late UPA, with shared RBI responsibility.
Rights and institutional freedom	UPA has the stronger case in the independent assessments examined.
Safety and environment	Mixed outcomes; no clean overall era winner established.

Transport, taps, accounts and digital scale are related delivery outcomes. Their appearance in several rows does not give NDA several automatic votes. Growth, rights and human outcomes can outweigh them if a reader assigns those areas greater importance.

The domain judgments narrow the claim. They distinguish strong evidence of improvement from weaker evidence about who caused it. They also show why a universal 'better on everything' verdict cannot survive the full report.

Sectoral evidence and qualifications appear on the preceding pages and in Parts 1-6. No equal-weight points total is calculated. Sources: 03, 04, 16, 22, 25, 28, 32, 43. References on pages 30-33.

27 / MY OVERALL VERDICT

My choice is NDA, with limits.

The deciding priority is useful delivery to more people.

If I must choose one government under the priorities I set for this report, **I choose the BJP-led NDA after 2014.** I give the greatest weight to expansion of useful public networks, basic-service reach and financial access. The assembled evidence shows enough substantial delivery in that broad group to give NDA a qualified overall advantage.

This choice also recognises bank cleanup, later stabilisation and meaningful production and capacity gains. Inheritance and favourable outside conditions reduce exclusive credit, but do not make the later execution disappear.

The strongest case against my choice is serious. UPA's observed ten-year real GDP growth was faster. Income per person grew at almost the same pace across the equal decades. Independent freedom assessments favour the earlier period. Jobs, learning, clean air and safety do not supply a decisive NDA victory.

COVID narrows the growth-based criticism of NDA, because it was an exceptional outside shock. The government also remains answerable for its response. The vaccination achievement and the documented hardship in emergency care and migrant support belong in the same judgment.

I cannot prove that my priority order is the only correct one. A growth-and-rights-first reader may choose UPA; someone asking only about networks and service reach has a stronger NDA answer. Those are differences about what matters most, as well as about how to interpret the evidence.

My final verdict is a qualified NDA lead for material delivery, not an unconditional finding that India was better governed in every respect after 2014. UPA's growth, poverty reduction, legislation and institutional foundations remain major parts of India's progress.

Overall verdict: the author's stated interpretation. The source data do not establish a statistically unique winner across all aspects of national life. Sources: 03, 04, 16, 36, 43, 12, 11. References on pages 30-33.

28 / WHAT WOULD CHANGE THE ANSWER

The verdict should stay open to evidence.

A useful conclusion can be clear without pretending to be final forever.

A fuller comparison of real household income, dependable paid work and service quality could strengthen or weaken the delivery-first judgment. Matched UPA and NDA baselines across more sectors would also make the pace comparison more reliable.

A consistent historical back series under the new GDP framework could change the numerical growth comparison. That is why this report names the old published snapshot and never treats its calculations as immune to revision.

Better evidence on pandemic outcomes and policy effects could change the assessment of the response. So could a more detailed examination of accountability, court access, minority rights and press conditions. Those issues deserve their own evidence, rather than a residual place after economic totals.

The Matrix charts were a starting point. Their unsupported pairs, mixed baselines and forecasts are not used to manufacture a winner here. A 2031 projection, a target, an approval or a cumulative registration is not an achievement already delivered.

For a reader who wants the shortest faithful statement: **NDA delivered more widely in the areas this report gives greatest weight; UPA's observed decade grew faster, and its freedom assessment was stronger. Both contributed; neither has a complete success record.** That is the conclusion I can defend from the evidence assembled.

I want this last volume to make disagreement easier to understand. You can disagree with my priority order and still use the same corrected numbers. India is better served when a claim remains open to a date, a definition and a source.

The next pages list clickable primary sources and original-publisher assessments. The six earlier volumes contain the extended numerical report card. Sources: 03, 05, 59, 43. References on pages 30-33.

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

01 MisterLove / Lovepreet Singh: Public profile and editorial theme

Byline and public interests; checked 3 October 2026.

02 Prime Minister's Office: Prime ministers and comparison periods

UPA: 22 May 2004-26 May 2014. Modi: prime minister from 2014; third term began June 2024. Dates only, not profile endorsements.

Modi profile

03 NSO / Economic Survey 2025-26: Real GDP: Statistical Appendix, Table 1.7

January 2026 snapshot, 2011-12 series. Annual rates, equal-decade comparisons and shock sensitivity are calculations from the GDP column.

Official back-series release, November 2018

04 NSO / Economic Survey 2025-26: Per capita net national income: Table 1.1

Constant-price column: 2003-04, 2013-14, 2023-24 and 2024-25. Growth calculations are by the author.

05 MoSPI: New GDP series, base year 2022-23

27 February 2026. Keep the new framework separate from the retained historical comparison series.

Latest quarter, August 2026

06 Finance Ministry / IMF: Global financial crisis and late-UPA vulnerabilities

2009 survey: crisis response. IMF February 2014: domestic constraints, inflation and external pressures. Older growth vintages are not used in the comparison table.

IMF 2014 assessment

07 IMF: 2016 Article IV: oil prices, policy and recovery

March 2016. Lower oil prices helped; monetary and supply measures also mattered. A separate IMF working paper debates the size of the oil contribution.

Research on disinflation

08 IMF: 2017 Article IV discussion of demonetisation

February 2017: cash shortage and a temporary adverse demand shock. Do not treat that forecast as today's revised annual GDP figure.

Staff report and reform chronology

09 CBIC: The journey to GST

Official chronology: 2000 groundwork; 2006 announcement; 2011 bill; 2016 amendment; implementation on 1 July 2017.

10 IMF: India: 2021 Article IV consultation

October 2021. Slowing activity before COVID, two waves, support measures and recovery risks.

2022 assessment: Ukraine and inflation risks

11 Prime Minister's Office / NHRC: March 2020 lockdown and migrant distress

21-day national lockdown announced 24 March. NHRC June 2020 sought protections for stranded migrant workers.

NHRC intervention

12 Supreme Court / Finance Ministry: Oxygen response and vaccination delivery

6 May 2021 order constituted a National Task Force. Vaccine total: more than 220 crore doses by 6 January 2023.

Doses are not unique people.

Vaccination programme record

13 WHO / Health Ministry: Excess mortality: estimate and official objection

WHO 2022 estimate for 2020-21: 4.7 million, interval 3.31-6.48 million. India objected to the model. An estimate, not a verified death-by-death register.

Government response, 5 May 2022

SOURCES AND READING NOTES

Follow the numbers back.

Click a title to open the source. Dates refer to releases or survey periods as stated.

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